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How one idea brought three biz needs together



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Brands weigh returns on festive influencer spending



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Musk: Ukraine misused Starlink to kill people



BENGALURU, MONDAY, OCTOBER 26, 2026

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IN THE NEWS

ECONOMY | PAGE 2

FIRMS GET MORE TIME FOR FY26 ANNUAL FILINGS



THE MINISTRY OF Corporate Affairs has extended FY26 annual filing deadlines, allowing firms to submit financial statements by December 31, 2026, and returns by January 31, 2027, reports **Manu Kaushik**

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KANNADIGA BIAS: SHIVAKUMAR WARNS IT FIRMS



KARNATAKA CM DK Shivakumar on Sunday warned IT firms of action if found discriminating against Kannadigas in hiring, reigniting a politically sensitive debate shelved by the state government two years ago.

OPINION | PAGE 8

FPI FLOWS: FROM IGNORANCE TO DISMAY, WRITES **AJIT DAYAL**

Govt shoulders half the risk of deep-sea drilling

THE GOVERNMENT will fund up to half the cost of exploratory wells under its ₹84,084-crore Samudra Manthan scheme, sharing losses from unsuccessful drilling, reports **Saurav Anand**. Companies striking commercially viable oil or gas must repay the support received. ■ PAGE 2

Tata Motors faces final hurdle in Iveco takeover



TATA MOTORS' €3.9-BILLION acquisition of Iveco faces a crucial shareholder participation test on Monday, as it seeks full ownership and delisting of the Italian truckmaker. Its final €14.40-per-share offer closes Oct 26, with success hinging on investors tendering enough shares, reports **Akbar Merchant**. ■ PAGE 4

THE HUMAN FACTOR

THE ONE JOB AI CAN'T FAKE PAGE 8

GROUP OPEN TO EITHER SHARE BUYBACK OR LISTING

SP Group seeks fair value for its Tata Sons holding

Mistry family neutral on Tata dispute

RAGHAVENDRA KAMATH
Mumbai , October 25

THE SHAPOORJI PALLONJI (SP) Group, which owns 18.4% of Tata Sons, is seeking a fair valuation for a partial or complete exit from the holding company and is open to either a share buyback or a listing, according to people familiar with the Mistry family's thinking.

The family is not taking sides in the dispute between Tata Trusts and Tata Sons over Chairman N Chandrasekaran's reappointment and the holding company's potential listing, the people said. Its priority is an early resolution that would allow it to unlock value from its investment and reduce debt.

"The family wants a fair solution. It is comfortable with either a listing or a buyback by Tata Sons," one person said. The SP Group remains "equidistant" from the two sides and does not wish to become involved in their differences, the person added.

The comments come after a proposal for Tata Sons to buy back shares worth ₹25,000 crore was raised at the company's September board meeting. Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata, who is married to Aloo Mistry, sister of SP Group Chairman Shapoor Mistry, put forward the proposal, according to the people cited.

Under the proposal, SP Group would sell about 2-3% of Tata Sons' equity. At a 3% stake sale, the proposed consideration would imply a valuation of roughly ₹8.3 lakh crore for the holding company. The group expects the proceeds to be paid over 18 months, the people said. The valuation would differ if the percentage sold were lower.

Continued on Page 11

UNLOCKING VALUE

- SP Group, which holds **18.4%** stake in Tata Sons, seeks a partial or full exit from Tata Sons
- Proposed buyback would spread payments over 18 months
- A 3% stake sale implies a valuation of about **₹8.3 lakh crore**



Proposed **₹25,000-crore** buyback could help SP Group monetise **2-3%** stake

₹55,000-60,000 crore estimated debt of SP Group, which makes stake monetisation a priority

₹21,500 cr refinancing and **₹3,500 cr** bond repayment eased the pressure

- SP Group faces no repayment deadlines in Oct-Nov, offering near-term relief
- A Tata Sons listing offers a market-based valuation and alternative exit route for SP



Festive rush fails to boost gig jobs, pay remains flat

ANEES HUSSAIN
Bengaluru, October 25

THE FESTIVE SHOPPING rush is proving an uneven windfall for the workers who keep the e-commerce and quick-commerce platforms running. While softer online sales have prompted e-commerce companies to cut seasonal hiring, the shift towards quick commerce is doing little to lift delivery partners' earnings, with per-order payouts largely unchanged despite rising demand.

Horizontal e-commerce platforms have hired 20-30% fewer seasonal workers than planned at the start of the year, while increasingly linking warehouse workers' daily earnings to order volumes, according to staffing firms *FE* spoke to. Quick commerce, meanwhile, is seeing faster growth in demand for gig workers, but platforms are relying on attendance and performance-linked incentives rather than raising base payouts.

The contrasting trends reflect an uneven festive season for workers. Delivery dispatches during the first 10 days of Amazon's Great Indian Festival and Flipkart's Big Billion Days, which began in early October, fell 10-12% year-on-year, while gross merchandise value declined 7-10%, according to Datum Intelligence. In contrast, quick commerce is gaining ground in grocery, which is expected to account for 9.5% of festive sales, up 2.5 percentage points from last year. Quick commerce is forecast to contribute 77% of grocery sales.

Demand for gig workers in quick commerce is growing 18% this festive season, compared with 12% in e-commerce, according to Deepesh Gupta, director and head of general staffing at Adecco India. However, the increase in demand has not translated into proportionately higher earnings.

For warehouse pickers, packers and loaders, base wages have remained largely unchanged from last year, apart from revisions in state wage structures. Average monthly earnings, including incentives and festive bonuses, have also stayed flat, with fixed pay accounting for 80-85% of earnings, Balasubramanian Anantha Narayanan, senior vice-president at TeamLease Services, said.

Overall warehouse headcount has risen 12% year-on-year, largely due to new facilities and expansion into more cities, rather than seasonal hiring.

Continued on Page 12

UNEVEN TREND

- E-commerce firms have hired **20-30%** fewer seasonal workers than planned
- Quick-commerce gig worker demand grows **18%** this festive season, against **12%** in e-commerce
- E-commerce delivery payouts drop to **₹12-15** per shipment from **₹25-28** last year
- Companies are increasingly relying on attendance and performance-linked incentives rather than raising base payouts
- Quick-commerce per-order payouts remain broadly flat at **₹20-30**, with peak-period additions of **₹8-15**



Must shield banks from cyber terrorists: PM

SUJIT BISOYI
Bhubaneswar, October 25

WARNING THAT MODERN wars are not fought with weapons alone but also by targeting economies, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday underlined the need to protect India's banking system from "cyber terrorists". He was speaking at the inauguration of the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) Data Centre and Cybersecurity Training Institute here.

"We all know that nowadays, wars are not fought with weapons alone. A country can also be weakened by targeting its economy. As India grows stronger economically, safeguarding our banking system against cyber criminals and cyber terrorists has become essential," he said.

Modi said the nature of cyber threats is evolving rapidly and cannot be tackled with outdated systems, traditional training methods and tools. "We need modern infrastructure and a skilled workforce to meet these challenges effectively. The role of the new Cybersecurity Training Institute is significant in this context," he said.

Modi said that while the past decade was about extending banking services to those who didn't have access before, the coming decade would be about making banking more efficient and trustworthy. "This requires robust data centres and powerful computing systems," he said, emphasising the need to secure the digital infrastructure.

Continued on Page 12



PM Narendra Modi at the inauguration of RBI's data centre in Bhubaneswar on Sunday. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra are also seen PTI

»INSIDE«
SBI TARGETS DORMANT ACCOUNTS TO CURB FRAUD
PAGE 6

Cancer drug prices can rise despite margin cap

MANU KAUSHIK
New Delhi, October 25

PATIENTS BUYING CANCER medicines may not get lasting relief from the government's latest price control measures as drugmakers remain eligible for annual price increases even after revising prices under the new order. The National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) has clarified that companies can still claim these annual increases under the Drug Prices Control Order, (DPCO) 2013.

Through an October 17 order, the NPPA capped trade margins at 30% of the maximum retail price (MRP) for non-scheduled cancer medicines.

Under Paragraph 20(1) of DPCO 2013, manufacturers of non-scheduled medicines can raise prices by up to 10% over a 12-month period. Unlike scheduled drugs, whose ceiling prices are revised annually from April 1 based on changes in the wholesale price index (WPI), non-scheduled medicines do not have a common annual price revision date.

Continued on Page 12

AI revenue surges, but IT growth still subdued in Q2

RESULTS REVIEW

POULOMI CHATTERJEE
Bengaluru, October 25

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (AI) IS emerging as a significant revenue stream for Indian IT services firms, but its rapid growth is yet to translate into a meaningful acceleration in overall revenue as automation threatens to erode the traditional services business.

The challenge for the industry is to generate enough new AI-led business to offset the revenue lost as clients seek greater productivity and lower costs.

Among large-cap IT companies, HCLTech reported the highest sequential revenue growth in constant currency terms at 2.3% in the September quarter, followed by Infosys at 1.2%. Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) grew 0.5%, while Wipro reported flat growth. The modest performance came despite companies reporting strong growth in their AI-related businesses, highlighting the widening gap between the emerging opportunity and the pressures on their core operations.

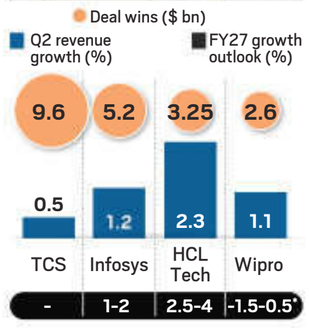
Infosys said AI now accounts for 10.5% of its revenue, with the business growing 29% sequentially. TCS reported an annualised AI revenue run rate of $3.1 billion, crossing 10% of total revenue for the first time. HCLTech's Advanced AI revenue, which includes intellectual property and platform components, rose 28% sequentially and contributed 6% of total revenue. The business also contributed 32 basis points to HCLTech's operating margin of 18.6%.

However, the expansion of AI-related business is not yet translating into comparable growth in overall revenue. According to Achyuta Ghosh, research and advisory lead for India at HfS Research, part of the explanation lies in clients' increasing expectations of AI-led productivity gains. Companies are demanding measurable returns from technology spending while remaining cautious about discretionary expenditure, putting pressure on traditional contract values.

Continued on Page 12

SCORE CARD





*Q3

- Pricing pressure and automation of traditional services offset gains from new business
- Infosys cuts FY27 growth guidance; Wipro flags seasonal weakness for December quarter

IndiGo, AI blink on NMIA flights

AKBAR MERCHANT
Mumbai, October 25

INDIGO WILL SHIFT 12 daily international departures from Mumbai airport to the new Navi Mumbai International Airport (NMIA) between February and July 2027, while Air India Express will move selected domestic and West Asia services from December, as the Adani group prepares to redevelop Mumbai airport's Terminal 1. Global airlines, however, continue to oppose the proposed reallocation of air traffic to the new terminal.

The phased transition, announced jointly by the airlines and Adani Airport Holdings on Sunday, will redistribute traffic between the two airports serving the Mumbai metropolitan region. The move is intended to ease capacity constraints at the Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport (CSMIA) and create room for the redevelopment of Terminal 1, which is expected to require a reduction in capacity by 2030.

IndiGo plans to begin international operations from NMIA in February 2027, progressively shifting existing services to Bahrain, Riyadh, Dammam, Jeddah, Madinah, Kuwait, Ras Al Khaimah, Fujairah, Muscat, Dhaka and Jakarta. It will also introduce Kathmandu as a new destination. The airline will move the domestic services required to feed passengers into these international flights, enabling connections through Navi Mumbai.

The final dates for the transition will be announced after coordination with the airport operator and receipt of the necessary operating approvals. The shift will also free up capacity at Mumbai airport for IndiGo's international expansion in 2027, including services across Asia, Africa and Europe using its growing fleet of A320/A321 aircraft and A321XLRs. Any further adjustments to its operations at Terminal 1 will be accommodated at Terminal 2.

Continued on Page 11

PHASED TRANSITION

- IndiGo to shift 12 international departures between Feb & July 2027
- Air India Express to begin moving selected flight services from December



RISING ATTACKS PUSH UP COVER SIZES, BUT INDIA ACCOUNTS FOR LESS THAN 1% OF GLOBAL PREMIUMS

Cyber risks fuel insurance demand, but gaps persist

NARAYANAN V
Chennai, October 25

A SURGE IN cyberattacks targeting critical digital infrastructure and software vulnerabilities exposing millions of websites to hackers is driving demand for cyber insurance. Yet, many businesses continue to treat the cover as optional, leaving much of the potential market untapped.

"We are witnessing a clear increase in the size of cyber insurance covers being sought by businesses, although the quantum varies significantly by industry, scale and risk profile," says Ramit Goyal, chief distribution officer, Generali Central Insurance.

Gisha George, president – product & underwriting, commercial lines & reinsurance, Liberty General Insurance, said demand for cyber insurance has moved to the boardroom, driven by a sharp rise in ransomware attacks and data breaches, as well as regulatory requirements such as CERT-In's incident-reporting directions, the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) cyber-security framework and the Digital Personal Data Protection Act.

The cover sizes have also increased, with large Indian corporates and listed entities buying cyber insurance of $10–50 million or more, backed by reinsurance, compared with single-digit-million-dollar limits five years ago, she said.

Last week, websites worldwide faced millions of attempts to exploit a newly discovered vulnerability in PHP, the programming language underpinning about 70% of the world's websites. The vulnerability prompted some governments and companies to take their websites offline to avert potential attacks. In another instance, a cybersecurity researcher recently observed a Chinese-speaking hacker breaching websites belonging to more than 100 global companies by outsourcing the hacking entirely to artificial intelligence (AI) agents.

The incidents underscore the scale of the threat. In 2025 alone, the Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In) handled nearly 3 million cyber incidents.

However, rising threats alone may not translate into wider adoption. Amit Goel, director, Equirus Raghnall Insurance Broking, said, "Awareness, affordability and a better understanding of policy coverage will play an equally important role."

Insurers, meanwhile, are becoming more selective about the risks they underwrite. Businesses need to demonstrate reasonable security controls and understand the scope of their policies, particularly for ransomware, cyber fraud, business interruption and third-party incidents, Goel says.

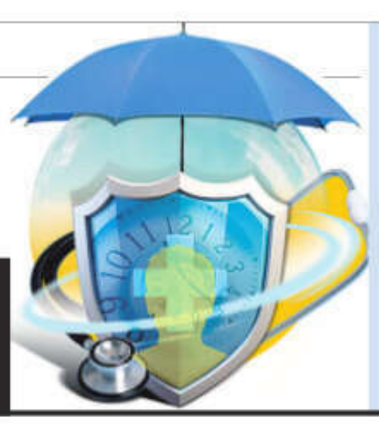
The banking, financial services and insurance (BFSI) sector is a particular concern. According to Amit Solanki, executive president-liability & special risks at Howden India, the sector experienced cyberattacks at approximately 1.6 times the global average, while reported incidents more than doubled between 2021 and 2025.

"Recent incidents and disclosures involving major financial institutions illustrate the scale of the challenge," Solanki says.

Continued on Page 12

DIGITAL DEFENCE

- Indian cyber insurance market has been growing at approximately **25–30%** annually
- **2.94 mn** cyber incidents were handled by CERT-In in 2025
- **₹900–1,100 crore** estimated cyber insurance premiums in FY26 against general insurance industry of over ₹3 lakh cr
- BFSI, technology, telecom, healthcare and e-commerce are among the biggest buyers of cyber insurance
- **$50–100 mn** cyber cover sought by banks in FY26



NHAI pivots towards InvITs

THE NATIONAL HIGHWAYS Authority of India (NHAI) is executing a major structural shift in its asset monetisation program, tilting heavily toward Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs) over the traditional Toll-Operate-Transfer (ToT) route. PAGE 2

5 IPOs to raise ₹2.6K cr this wk

FIVE COMPANIES, INCLUDING EAAA India Alternatives, SFC Environmental Technologies, and M K Sons Fine Jewels, are set to launch their initial public offerings next week, seeking to raise close to ₹2,600 crore from the primary market. PAGE 6

Economy

MONDAY, OCTOBER 26, 2026

IN THE NEWS

INDIA, ROTTERDAM PORT ENGAGED TO DIGITALISE CARGO SYSTEMS: GOYAL



INDIAN AND ROTTERDAM port authorities are working to digitalise processes in India to speed up cargo evacuation and reduce ship turnaround times, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Sunday. "The customs authorities in India and the authorities at the Port of Rotterdam are engaged to see how we can digitalise in India to bring in modern standards, faster evacuation of cargo, and speed up the turnaround time of ships," he told reporters in Rotterdam.

NMDC scouts for mining assets across 4 continents

FROM SOUTH AMERICA in the west to Australia in the east, state-owned iron ore giant NMDC is scouting mining assets, including critical minerals, in four continents to meet the future needs of industries such as automotive, renewable energy, electronics, and steel, according to industry sources. **AGENCIES**

CENTRE TO BANKROLL UP TO HALF OF DEEPWATER DRILLING COSTS

Samudra Manthan: Govt to bear losses on dry oil wells

SAURAV ANAND
New Delhi, October 25

THE GOVERNMENT IS offering oil and gas explorers a new financial arrangement to encourage drilling in India's deep seas: it will pay up to half the cost of an exploratory well and bear its share of the loss if no commercially viable oil or gas is found.

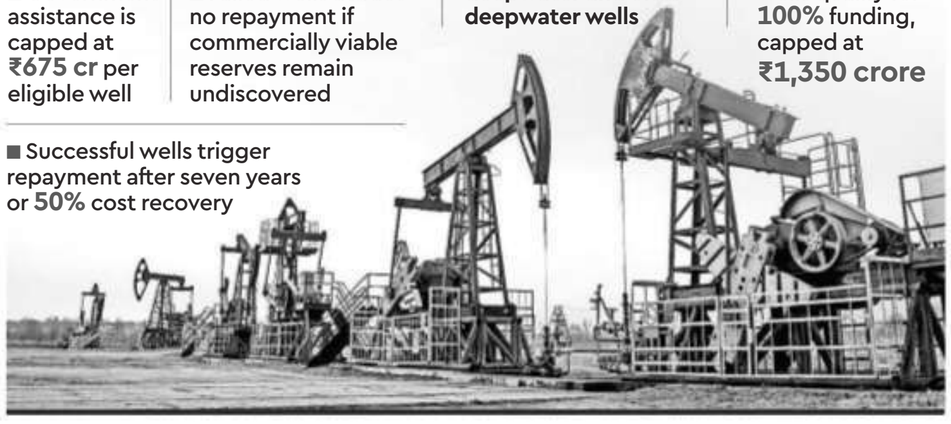
However, companies making profitable discoveries will have to repay the money, under the Centre's ₹84,084-crore Samudra Manthan scheme.

The move is aimed at tackling one of the biggest hurdles in offshore exploration: companies must spend hundreds of crores searching for oil and gas without any guarantee of a discovery. Under the new arrangement, the government will share that financial risk, while companies will remain responsible for drilling operations and the remaining expenditure.

According to the petroleum ministry's operational guidelines, the Centre will fund up to 50% of the actual drilling cost, subject to a ceiling of ₹675 crore per well. If drilling fails to find oil or gas, or discovers reserves that cannot be commercially produced, the government will not recover its contribution.

RISK SHARING

- Government assistance is capped at ₹675 cr per eligible well
- Failed wells attract no repayment if commercially viable reserves remain undiscovered
- Scheme allocates ₹43,200 crore for 60 deepwater and ultra-deepwater wells
- Four seabed rock-study wells qualify for 100% funding, capped at ₹1,350 crore
- Successful wells trigger repayment after seven years or 50% cost recovery



For successful wells, repayment will begin after seven years of commercial production or when the company has recovered 50% of its exploration and development costs, whichever happens earlier. The money will be recovered through annual installments from company revenue, without any adjustment for inflation or the time value of money.

The arrangement means companies will not have to repay government assistance merely because oil or gas has been discovered. Recovery is linked to the discovery becoming commercially viable and entering regular production.

Petroleum Secretary Neeraj Mittal described Samudra Manthan as a "structural break in India's approach to offshore exploration", saying it addresses the financial difficulties that earlier policy reforms could not resolve.

The scheme comes against the backdrop of India's heavy dependence on imported crude oil. The country's annual oil import bill is around $144 billion, or ₹13 lakh crore, according to government estimates.

Deepwater exploration is particularly expensive. Drilling a single exploratory well costs around $125-150 million, while developing an exploration block into a commercially producing field typically takes five to ten years.

Of the scheme's total outlay, ₹43,200 crore has been allocated for drilling 60 deepwater and ultra-deepwater wells. Of these, 56 wells will qualify for funding of up to 50% of drilling costs.

The remaining four wells, intended to study rock formations beneath the seabed, can receive full funding, capped at ₹1,350 crore each. Only central public sector companies or consortiums led by them can seek assistance for these wells.

NHAI tilts monetisation of highways towards InvITs

MUKESH JAGOTA
New Delhi, October 25

THE NATIONAL HIGHWAYS Authority of India (NHAI) is executing a major structural shift in its asset monetisation programme, tilting heavily towards Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs) over the traditional Toll-Operate-Transfer (ToT) route.

Under its roadmap, the highway authority has allocated nearly 75% of this financial year's monetisation pipeline to the two Investment Trusts it sponsors.

Out of a total pool of 17 operational highway stretches spanning 1,692 km earmarked for monetisation through ToT and InvIT structures this financial year, NHAI has now decided to route 1,260 km through the InvIT platform. The policy preference was initially signalled by the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) in February 2025, but the operational pivot has now materialised on the ground.

Meanwhile, execution via the ToT model continues on a secondary track. In July, NHAI completed its first ToT transaction of the current financial year, monetising 184.5 km of highways in Tamil Nadu under ToT Bundle 19 for ₹2,259 crore. Bidding processes remain open for Bundles 20, 21, and 22 as NHAI progresses towards its annual asset monetisation target of ₹30,000 crore.

Proceeds from the monetisation of highways through InvITs are used exclusively for debt repayment. This year, NHAI also plans to aggressively reduce its outstanding debt which now stands at below ₹2 lakh crore, down from a high of ₹3.42 lakh crore at the end of 2022-23.

The newly launched public InvIT, Raajmarg Infra Investment Trust (RIIT) has been offered 10 stretches of 910 km length by the NHAI as part of this financial year's monetisation plan. The RIIT made its debut last year when it acquired 260km of roads for ₹9,500 crore.

The rest has been offered to National Highway Infra Trust (NHIT). In its sixth round of acquisition of highway assets, NHIT has been offered 450km of roads. Last year, the NHIT acquired 11 km highways after paying ₹6,550 crore.

Though NHAI is a sponsor of NHIT, it has brought down its share of the number of units held to 10%. In RIIT, its share of total number of units is 15%. As RIIT is a public InvIT, its units are open to subscription from retail investors while NHIT's units holders are Indian and overseas investment funds.

The NHAI has prepared its asset monetisation strategy document for the next three years to meet the ₹4.42 lakh crore monetisation targets for the roads sector in the next five years.

The second National Monetisation Pipeline has an overall target of Rs 16.32 lakh crore by 2029-30 of which the share of the highways sector is 26%. The funding by the private sector in Public Private Partnership (PPP) projects has been made part of the target.

SLASHING DEBT



Monetisation through InvIT	Length (km)	Value realised (₹ crore)
2021-22	389	7,350
2022-23	247	2,850
2023-24	890	15,700
2024-25	821	17,738
2025-26	570*	15,866

*311 km through NHIT, 260 km through RIIT

MCA relaxes FY26 filing deadlines for companies

MANU KAUSHIK
New Delhi, October 25



FOR LISTED AND unlisted firms racing to meet their annual reporting requirements, the ministry of corporate affairs (MCA) has offered some breathing room by extending the deadlines for annual filings.

The ministry has now allowed companies to file their financial statements for FY26 by December 31, 2026, and annual returns by January 31 next year, without paying additional fees.

In a circular, the MCA said it had received requests from stakeholders seeking more time to file annual statutory forms for FY26.

"In view of the representations received and to enable companies to complete their annual statutory filings, it has been decided that companies will be allowed to file," the ministry said.

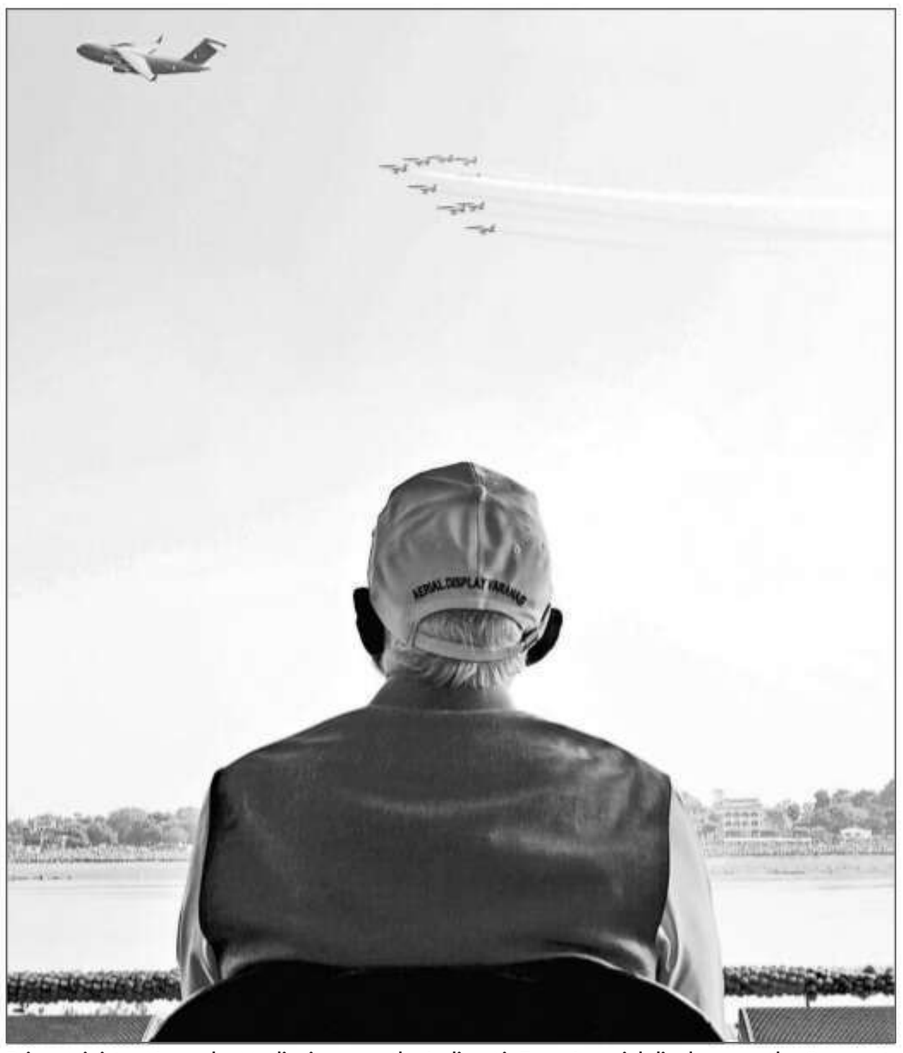
Before the extension, the deadlines were October 31 for financial statements and November 30 for annual returns.

The extension covers forms used by companies to file consolidated financial statements, report financial data in XBRL format, and submit financial statements under Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS) applicable to non-banking financial companies (NBFCs).

The fresh relief also includes annual returns (MGT-7 and MGT-7A), which require companies to report details such as their shareholding and management. The deadline for filing these returns has been extended to January 31 next year.

This is the second consecutive financial year in which the MCA has extended filing deadlines. In October 2025, it gave companies until December 31 to file FY25 financial statements and annual returns, before extending the deadline to January 31 this year.

MADE IN INDIA, FLYING HIGH



Prime Minister Narendra Modi witnesses the Indian Air Force's aerial display over the Ganga at Namo Ghat in Varanasi on Sunday. The IAF flew nearly 100 aircraft from 12 bases, including the Sukhoi-30 MKI, indigenous Tejas and LCH Prachand, to mark its 94th anniversary PTI

Pulses import surges 67% in Apr-Aug amid El Nino fears

- Disruption in Russia may slow down imports

SANDIP DAS
New Delhi, October 25

IMPORTS OF PULSES surged 67% to 2.06 million tonne (MT) in the April-August period of FY27, amid concerns over a dip in domestic output due to the El Nino threat, trade sources said.

In terms of value, imports rose 38% to $1.18 billion, indicating that global prices remain relatively subdued despite higher demand from India.

However, traders said that imports in the next few months would slow down as prices of yellow peas and lentils sourced from Canada have increased in the last month because supplies from Russia have been disrupted due to its conflict with Ukraine.

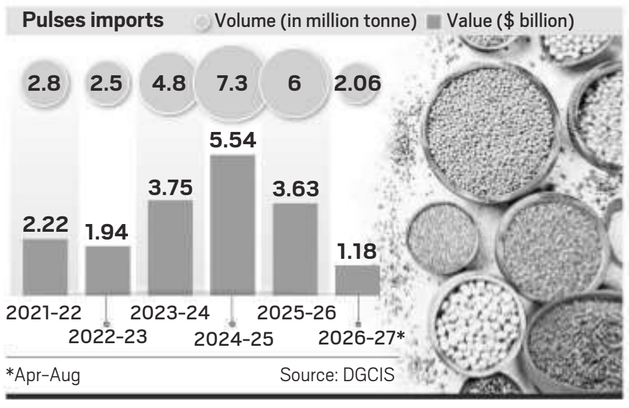
In terms of varieties, masur and yellow peas imports in the April-August period of FY27 surged 200% and 114% to 0.64 MT and 0.62 MT, respectively, compared to the same period last year.

Tur imports increased by 10% to 0.35 MT in the first five months of the current fiscal year. Urad imports declined by 3% to 0.27 MT during the same period.

Sowing of kharif pulses has been completed, and the area sown this season is 11.84 million hectares, an increase of 1.42% year-on-year. The crop has been hit because of deficient rainfall in several key growing regions of Maharashtra and Karnataka. The rainfall and temperature pattern in winter months would impact the sowing of chana and masur (lentil), key rabi variants of pulses.

India's pulses imports dropped sharply by 34% to $3.63 billion in FY26 year-on-year.

BRIDGING SUPPLY DEFICIT



TANAY DALAL, SENIOR VICE PRESIDENT — BUSINESS & ECONOMIC RESEARCH, AXIS BANK

'Domestic consumption isn't as strong as it might appear'

India has a shortage of domestic investable assets, as the country is not creating enough fairly priced assets for savers to invest in, according to **Tanay Dalal**, *senior vice president — business & economic research at Axis Bank.*

This shortage is contributing to capital outflows. As per Axis Bank's research, India's financeable current account deficit, has declined to 0% of GDP from around 2% earlier, which is the more fundamental challenge, Dalal tells **Shubham Rana** *in an interview. Excerpts:*

Where do you see GDP growth in FY27?

We forecast GDP growth at 7.3% in FY27, up from 7.1% earlier. Part of the upward revision reflects the support being provided by the public sector, which is helping cushion the impact of prevailing economic challenges.

However, as this support is gradually withdrawn, it could weigh on growth going forward. Accordingly, our FY28 GDP growth forecast stands at 7.1%, compared with our earlier estimate of 7.2%.

What is your view on India's investment and consumption situation?

I would hazard a guess that domestic consumption isn't as strong as it might appear. If you look at indicators such as the Retailers Association of India's retail sales data, much of the growth appears to be driven by price effects. Air traffic trends are not particularly strong either. Petrol consumption, which is a useful indicator for household transport activity, is also not showing robust growth. UPI transactions growth has slowed, while GST collections, which provide an indication of final consumption demand, have also moderated. One of the biggest concerns is that consumer credit is rising very rapidly.

A key factor supporting consumption at present is public sector support. Based on our estimates, if one combines spending by the Centre, states, and PSUs, support since the war began, amounts to around 1.7% of GDP. The IMF defines these as indirect subsidies.

Private sector capex has been rising but is restricted to a few sectors such as power, roads and data centres. The broader areas of the economy don't seem to have equal participation.

The IMF offers one explanation for this. If you look at last year's Article IV consultation report, it suggests that the MSME sector has adequate access to subsidised credit. The sector also benefits from incentive structures that may discourage firms from scaling up into large enterprises. As a result, growth capital may not be an imperative for many of these businesses. This is not a new issue and has been highlighted by both the World Bank and IMF over the years.

Do you mean perverse incentives exist for MSMEs stunting their own growth?

Incentives available to MSMEs are significant. As firms scale up and transition into larger enterprises, they may lose access to a number of sector-specific benefits, including government guarantees and tax incentives. As a result, the incentive to expand beyond a particular size may not always be as strong as policymakers would like.

But such policies have, in recent years, been progressively disbanded.

To an extent. As of last year, around 75% of Indian manufacturing firms had fewer than five employees, according to the IMF. There is still a long way to go, and the transition may not be happening fast enough.

A deeper issue is the shortage of domestic investable assets, which is contributing to capital moving overseas. Our research suggests that the financeable CAD, which was previously around 2% of GDP, has now declined to 0% of GDP. That, in our view, is the more fundamental challenge.

We have more savings than the stock of investable assets currently being created. As a result, a portion of those savings is finding its way overseas. India is not creating enough fairly priced assets for savers to invest in, which is one reason domestic valuations remain elevated relative to global peers.

If capex were to increase and those assets became more accessible to households, part of this imbalance could be addressed. However, that would likely require asset valuations to moderate.

Domestic savings rate has been declining in years and still remains at a very low level, despite a recent marginal improvement.

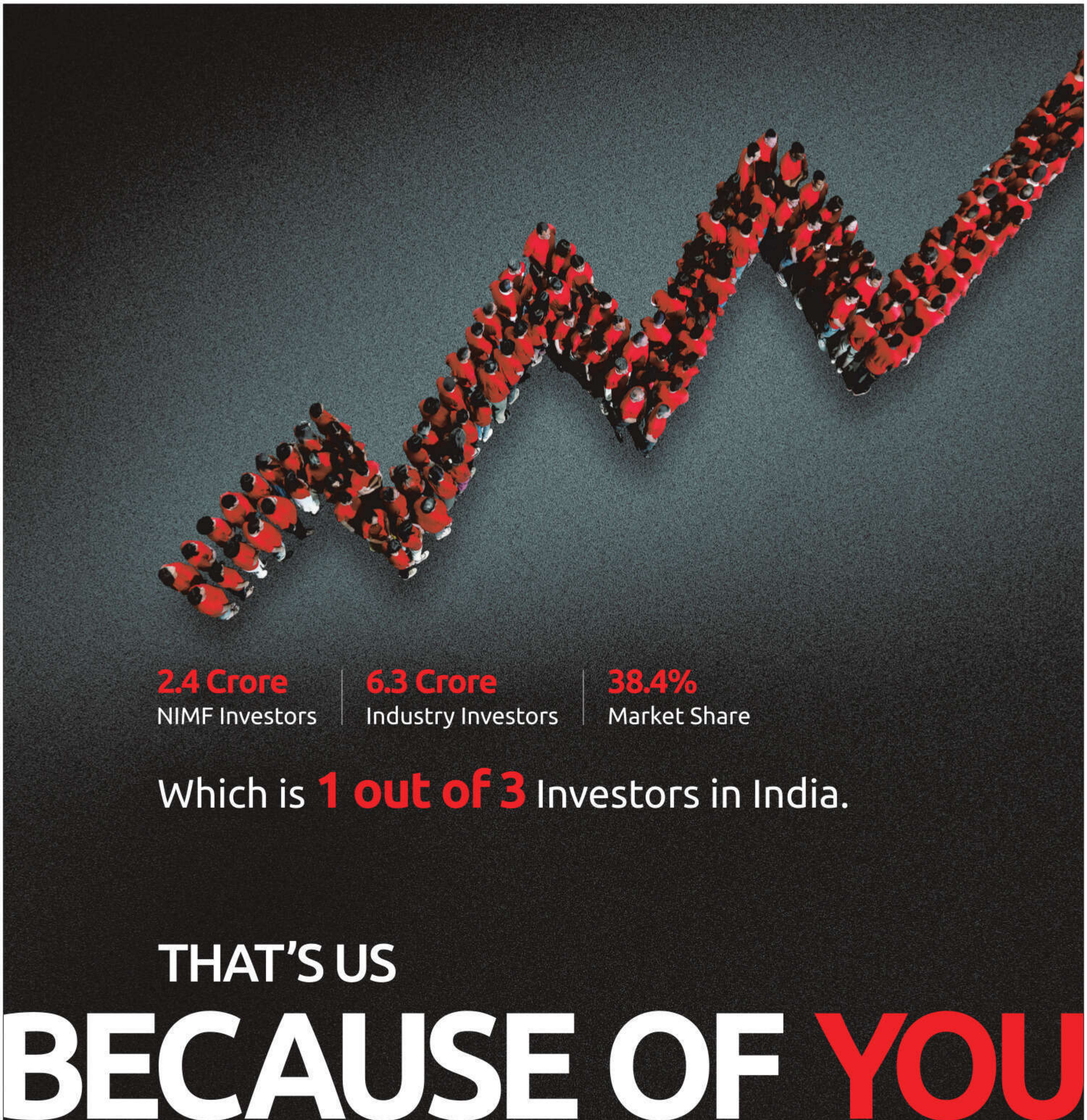
Let's examine that assumption. The current account deficit is the difference between domestic investments and domestic savings. Over the past three years, the current account deficit has averaged only around 0.5-0.6% of GDP.

That raises the question of whether India is truly capital scarce. We appear to have adequate capital available. Even with the outflows we are seeing, the economy is not facing significant capital constraints. In fact, the cost of capital India is currently lower than in many other markets.

(Read full interview on www.financialexpress.com)



"EVEN WITH THE OUTFLOWS WE ARE SEEING, THE ECONOMY IS NOT FACING CAPITAL CONSTRAINTS



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The Unique Investors count for Mutual Fund industry as on 30 September 2026 is 6,33,46,572#, and that for Nippon India Mutual Fund is 2,43,02,546. Market Share: 38.4%. Hence, the phrase '1 out of every 3' investors is used.
*Monday to Saturday, 8 AM to 9 PM. Call charges applicable. #Source: AMFI.

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Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

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Companies

MONDAY, OCTOBER 26, 2026

IN THE NEWS

REINVENTION IS KEY IN AI ERA, SAYS HCLTECH CEO



AS AI reshapes the technology industry, HCL Technologies CEO and MD C Vijayakumar has said the sector has reached another "inflection point" with AI, and the future belongs not necessarily to the largest, but those willing to keep reinventing themselves.

AIRLINES CAN CLAIM GST BACK ON VOID TICKETS



GST PAID ON cancelled airline tickets can be claimed as a refund if the airline has returned both the fare and GST to the passengers and has supporting documents to prove it, a GST Appellate Tribunal has ruled. It directed the revenue department to process the refund claim of the airline within two weeks.

Microtek invests ₹400 crore in new solar panel plant

MICROTEK HAS ANNOUNCED an investment of over ₹400 crore to accelerate the growth of its solar business. As part of its expansion plans, the firm is setting up a new solar panel manufacturing plant in Jaipur.

Senco Gold buys 68% in Melorra for ₹68 crore

SENCO GOLD ON Sunday said it has signed agreements to acquire a 68% stake in August Jewellery, which operates the 'Melorra' brand, for ₹68 crore. The investment will be made in multiple tranches, with completion targeted by February 2027, subject to fulfilment of specified conditions, the company said in a regulatory filing.

Godrej Properties pre-sales may rise 22% in FY27

REALTY FIRM GODREJ Properties' sales bookings is expected to rise 22% this fiscal to a record ₹41,500 crore, beating annual guidance on strong demand for its housing properties, according to its Chairperson Pirojsha Godrej.

—Agencies

● **JAYANT ACHARYA,** JOINT MANAGING DIRECTOR & CEO, JSW STEEL

'We see steel consumption to reach 177 MT in FY27'

JSW Steel expects domestic steel consumption to reach 177 million tonne in FY27, supported by infrastructure spending, improving private investment and demand from automobiles and manufacturing. ***Jayant Acharya,*** *joint managing director and CEO, in an interview with* ***Urvi Malvania,*** *discusses demand, margins, input costs and expansion plans. Excerpts:*

Steel consumption grew 7.5% to 85 million tonne in H1. Is demand recovery sustainable?

Demand remained resilient despite geopolitical challenges. Q2 production and sales improved, including liquidation of over 210,000 tonne of inventory built up in Q1. We expect consumption to reach 92 million tonne in H2. Our volumes will also benefit from the ramp-up of blast furnace 3 at Vijayanagar, which crossed 90% utilisation in September.

Revenue and absolute Ebitda have improved, but Ebitda per tonne declined sequentially. Why?

Long steel prices fell sharply in June and July due to seasonal weakness before recovering in August and September. Our net realisation declined by slightly over ₹500 per tonne in Q2, while costs rose by more than ₹1,300 per tonne, creating a margin impact of about ₹1,850 per tonne between the two quarters. Price recovery and operating efficiencies should help offset these pressures.

Can recent steel price increases be sustained?

The price increases in September and October will be fully reflected in the October-December quarter. This should help offset higher input costs. Coking coal costs rose by $10 against our guidance of $12-15, while other inputs also remained under pressure.

Is demand still dependent on government capital expenditure?

Public capex in the first five months was ₹5.1 lakh crore, up 18%. Private investment is also improving. Our institutional sales grew 15%, automotive sales 36%, appliance sales 28% and renewables sales 14%. Demand is broad-based, and we expect consumption-led growth to strengthen over the medium term.

What is the progress on captive mines and scrap recycling?

Three Karnataka mines awaiting clearances are expected to start by Q4, taking our captive mining capacity in the state to about 15 million tonnes. One of our four Goa mines is operational, with the others expected to start progressively. We aim to secure at least 50% of raw material requirements through captive resources, while bidding prudently as iron ore premiums rise.

We have also commissioned part of a 0.5-million-tonne scrap processing facility near Dolvi, with the balance expected by December. Another similar facility is planned in Chennai.



How are imports affecting the domestic steel industry?

Finished steel imports increased in H1, particularly from China and free trade agreement countries, and need close monitoring. Safeguard measures are helping, and the government is likely to act against dumping. China's declining steel consumption could create opportunities for Indian producers, particularly as domestic demand and engineering exports grow.

What is the outlook for your US operations and green steel business?

Operational Ebitda in the US grew 55% to $19 million in Q2. Upgrades at Ohio are complete, while modernisation at Baytown will be completed in October, supporting higher H2 volumes. Our low-carbon steel is being marketed in the US and Europe, where customers may pay a premium for certified products.

What are the key priorities for H2 and the medium term?

Blast furnace 3 will raise output to 4.5-5 million tonnes, improving fixed-cost absorption and productivity. A slurry pipeline, expected by March-April 2027, should further reduce costs. We have 1,000 MW of renewable energy operational and plan another 1,500 MW. Expansion projects remain on track, with the Salav low-carbon steel facility targeted for commissioning by 2032.

> "FINISHED STEEL IMPORTS INCREASED IN H1, PARTICULARLY FROM CHINA AND FREE TRADE AGREEMENT COUNTRIES

Tata Motors faces final hurdle in Iveco takeover

AKBAR MERCHANT
Mumbai, October 25

TATA MOTORS' €3.9-billion acquisition of Iveco faces a crucial test on Monday, with the company needing a sharp increase in shareholder participation to secure full ownership of the Italian commercial vehicle maker and pursue its planned delisting.

With its €14.40-per-share offer declared final, the outcome will depend on whether Tata Motors can persuade enough investors to tender their shares before the offer closes on October 26.

Acceptance stood at 35%, according to Girish Wagh, managing director and CEO of Tata Motors, while investors had tendered 31.19% of Iveco's shares by October 19.

The company expects participation to rise as the deadline approaches. However, opposition from investors who consider the offer inadequate has emerged as a key hurdle in its bid to take full control of Iveco.

Tata Motors needs acceptance from 80% of Iveco's current shareholders to pursue full ownership and delisting. Petrus Advisers, which holds a 3.8% stake, has opposed the offer, arguing that it undervalues the company.

ACQUISITION TEST

- Tata Motors' **€3.9 bn** Iveco acquisition faces a crucial Oct 26 deadline to secure shareholder support



- Acceptance stood at **35%**, while **31.19%** of Iveco shares had been tendered by Oct 19
- The combined business is expected to generate **€21 bn** in annual revenue and sell over **590,000** vehicles

Hedge funds Syquant Capital and Davidson Kempner have also yet to tender their shares. Together, the three investors hold around 20.4% of Iveco's common shares, making their decisions important to the outcome.

Tata Motors raised its offer from €14.10 to €14.40 per share in October, describing the revised proposal as its best and final offer. Wagh has reiterated that the company will not increase the price further, despite the resistance. The investors' position reflects a disagreement over Iveco's valuation and the extent to which shareholders should benefit from the potential gains of combining the two commercial vehicle businesses.

The outcome will also determine the ownership structure under which Tata Motors begins integrating Iveco. If acceptance crosses 66.67% but falls short of 80%, the company could proceed with the shares tendered, subject to the offer terms, but Iveco would remain listed with minority shareholders. This could complicate the planned delisting and restructuring, even if Tata Motors obtains a controlling stake. The strategic rationale for the acquisition is substantial. The combined business is expected to generate annual revenue of around €21 billion and sell more than 590,000 vehicles.

Hero resets premium bike plan to capture market share

VIKRAM CHAUDHARY
New Delhi, October 25

HERO MOTOCORP IS STEPPING up efforts to revive its premium motorcycle business, combining new product launches with an expansion of its dedicated retail network as it looks to gain ground in segments dominated by rivals Bajaj Auto and TVS Motor Company.

The move comes after the company's premium retail initiative, Premia, faced headwinds, prompting a rethink of its expansion strategy. In an exclusive interaction with *Financial Express*, Anuj Dua, chief business officer, Premium Segment, Hero MotoCorp, said the company was seeing renewed momentum in dealer uptake during the ongoing festive season. The network has crossed 150 outlets, with Hero focusing on improving product availability and creating more exclusive, experience-led retail spaces.

The challenge, however, goes beyond retail. While Hero commands a dominant position in the entry-level motorcycle market, it has struggled to replicate that success in higher-displacement segments, where buyers increasingly seek differentiated styling, performance and technology.

According to Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers data, Hero had a 59.7% share of the 100-125cc segment in the first half of FY27, selling 2.91 million motorcycles out of total sales of 4.87 million units.

Its presence in larger motorcycles is considerably weaker. Hero accounted for just 3.51% of the 150-200cc segment, selling around 28,000 units out of 796,721, while its share of the 200-250cc category stood at 1.13%, with sales of 1,805 units out of 158,655. The figures underline the scale of the task facing the manufacturer as it seeks to establish a stronger foothold in premium motorcycles.

"There is strong demand for heavy bridal jewellery, particularly for weddings and special occasions, as the preference is for pieces that bring together heritage, versatility and modern sensibilities," Kataria said.

Higher gold prices are also influencing product choices. Sen expects continued demand for lightweight, everyday-wear jewellery, while old-gold exchanges account for more than 50% of Senco's total business. Exchanges allow customers to use the value of existing jewellery towards new purchases, helping them manage the upfront cost of fresh gold.

However, the shift towards smaller, versatile pieces is not universal. Bridal jewellery remains an important category, while design-conscious buyers are seeking distinctive pieces that can be worn beyond the festive season.

For affluent consumers, purchases are also becoming less dependent on the festive calendar. Renu Oberoi, founder and creative director of Renu Oberoi, said high-net-worth individuals increasingly buy jewellery throughout the year, guided by personal preferences and spending priorities rather than Dhanteras alone.

For retailers, the challenge is to convert advance bookings into sales while catering to households managing affordability and wedding budgets, as well as affluent consumers prioritising design and craftsmanship.

RETAIL PUSH



- Premia network crosses **150** outlets, with a renewed focus on exclusive showrooms
- New Xtreme 160R 4V and refreshed Xtreme 250R target premium buyers
- Hero's strong **59.7%** share in 100–125cc contrasts with just 3.51% in 150–200cc

Hero is banking on the all-new Xtreme 160R 4V, priced between ₹1.27 lakh and ₹1.41 lakh, and the refreshed Xtreme 250R, priced at ₹1.98 lakh, to improve its position. Deliveries of the latter will begin on November 1. The 160R 4V comes with features such as ride-by-wire, multiple riding modes and cruise control, while the 250R is powered by a 30 PS liquid-cooled engine and gets a bi-directional quickshifter.

Dua said the company was not expecting an overnight shift in its market position but remained confident that the launches, backed by a renewed focus on premium products, would help it build scale. Hero expects the new Xtreme 160R 4V to contribute around 30% of the overall Xtreme portfolio. Strong demand for the Xtreme 125R had earlier led to a tapering of production of the older 160cc model, he said.

The Premia network will retail motorcycles above 150cc, including the Xtreme and Xpulse ranges, the Karizma XMR, the Xoom 160, Harley-Davidson X440 models and the Vida V2 Plus electric scooter.

Hero is also looking to make these outlets destinations for younger riders rather than conventional sales points, with initiatives such as engagement with gaming communities.

Hyundai banks on Bayon to regain mid-size SUV ground

NITIN KUMAR
New Delhi, October 25

HYUNDAI MOTOR INDIA is set to launch the Bayon on Monday as it looks to regain ground in the mid-size SUV segment, where Maruti Suzuki has strengthened its position with the Victoris, while sales of Hyundai's Creta have come under pressure.

The Bayon is expected to expand Hyundai's presence beyond the Creta, slotting between the sub-four-metre Venue and the Creta. It is aimed at buyers seeking a larger vehicle than the Venue without stretching their budgets to the Creta's price point.

The stakes are high for Hyundai, with the mid-size SUV segment accounting for 35% of its total sales in FY26. The company sold 201,921 vehicles in the segment out of total sales of 584,906 units, highlighting the importance of the category to its business.

Industry experts believe the Bayon, despite arriving late to the market, could help Hyundai arrest the decline in its mid-size SUV sales in the second half of FY27. Hyundai currently has only one model, the Creta, in the segment, while Maruti Suzuki has expanded its portfolio with the Grand Vitara and Victoris, alongside the Ertiga, which competes for buyers in the broader utility vehicle market.

According to model-wise data from the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM), Creta sales fell 9.7% year-on-year to 89,727 units in April-September FY27, from 99,345 units in the corresponding period a year earlier. Maruti Suzuki sold 72,012 units of the Victoris during the period.

MARKET BATTLE

- Hyundai Motor will launch the Bayon on Monday, positioning it between the Venue and Creta
- Maruti's Victoris sales reached 72,012 units in the first half of FY27, narrowing the gap with Creta
- Creta sales fell 9.7% year-on-year to **89,727** units in April-September FY27



Carlsberg India FY26 revenue slips, profit surges

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 25

IPO-BOUND BREWER CARLSBERG India has reported a 2.2% decline in its revenue to ₹8,708.8 crore for FY26. However, its profit rose 22% to ₹534.51 crore.

The company's total income, including other income, declined 2.25% to ₹8,814.96 crore in the financial year ended March 2026, according to financial data accessed through business intelligence platform Tofler.

Carlsberg India, part of Danish brewing major Carlsberg Group, had reported revenue from operations of ₹8,906.50 crore and a profit of ₹437.94 crore in FY25.

The company in July 2026 filed confidential papers with SEBI for a proposed initial public offering (IPO).

Jewellers bet on Dhanteras as buyers lock gold rates amid price volatility

VIVEAT SUSAN PINTO
Mumbai, October 25

WITH GOLD PRICES at elevated levels and the wedding season approaching, jewellers are seeing renewed interest in advance bookings ahead of Dhanteras on November 6. Price-protection schemes, a recent correction in bullion rates and the proximity of the winter wedding season are prompting consumers to plan purchases early rather than wait for the traditional festive rush.

The uptick comes after months of cautious spending. Suvankar Sen, MD and CEO of Senco Gold & Diamonds, said pre-orders were on a par with last year, but customer sentiment, footfall and purchase intent had improved over the past three to four months. The company expects festive-season growth of more than 20% over last year.

"The Dhanteras market has been positive in terms of value and marginally positive in terms of volume. Pre-orders have been similar to last year. However, with the ongoing auspicious festive season and the upcoming wedding season, we expect consumers to be robust when it comes to purchase of gold and diamond jewellery," Sen said.

Jewellers are using advance-booking offers to encourage purchases despite volatile bullion prices. "Since we have been running the Pure price offer for Dhanteras and Diwali, pre-bookings are above expectations," said a senior executive with a top jewellery chain, adding that customers had paid advances and locked in prices. The retailer expects Dhanteras sales to recover some of the shortfall in Dussehra sales.

Such offers allow buyers to manage the risk of subsequent price increases, subject to the schemes' terms and conditions. Kalyan Jewellers' rate-protection offer and Joyalukkas' advance-booking option are among the initiatives aimed at consumers concerned about further price volatility. Jewellers are also preparing for redemptions under monthly savings schemes, as customers who have contributed instalments over several months become eligible to use their accumulated amounts towards purchases.

24-carat gold is now trading at around ₹1.42–1.44 lakh per 10 grams, while silver stood at approximately ₹1.95–1.96 lakh per kg, according to bullion market sources. The near-term price trajectory remains uncertain. Global instability, central-bank buying and currency movements could support prices, but a further increase by Dhanteras is not guaranteed. Advance bookings offer consumers a way to manage this uncertainty rather than rely on a particular price forecast.

Mehul Jain, founder of Ekaraa Jewellery, said consumer sentiment ahead of Dhanteras was encouraging, with preferences extending beyond conventional designs. "Dhanteras continues to hold strong cultural and emotional significance for Indian consumers. Preferences are evolving beyond conventional designs, with growing interest in polki, rose-cut diamonds, coloured diamonds, distinctive diamond cuts and innovative finishes such as ceramic and coloured rhodium," Jain said.

FESTIVE GLITTER

- Jewellers report stronger advance bookings ahead of Dhanteras on Nov 6
- Senco Gold expects festive-season growth of over 20% year-on-year
- Price-locking offers are prompting consumers to book jewellery early despite fluctuating gold prices.



- 24-carat gold trades at **₹1.42–1.44 lakh/10** grams, while silver is around **₹1.95–1.96 lakh/kg**
- High prices are boosting demand for lightweight jewellery and old-gold exchanges

Weddings add to festive demand

The calendar is providing jewellers with another demand driver. With a shift in the Diwali season to November, bringing Dhanteras closer to the winter wedding period, retailers are seeing interest in both traditional auspicious purchases, including coins and smaller gold and silver items, and higher-value bridal orders.

Yash Kataria, CEO of Kataria Jewellers, expects sales this Dhanteras to grow 35-40% from 2025. Antique and heritage designs in 22-carat gold are witnessing strong demand, while the company's Indore showroom is seeing greater interest in polki and diamond jewellery than its Ratlam outlet in Madhya Pradesh.

Adani Energy eyes ₹1,300 cr tariff boost from new projects

RAGHAVENDRA KAMATH
Mumbai , October 25

TRANSMISSION GROWTH

- Projects are WRSR Transmission, Halvad Transmission, Khavda IV-A Transmission, Navinal Transmission



- The company won two projects — the ₹4,700-cr Satara Transmission project and ₹8,500-cr Vizag Transmission project
- Remains on track to invest ₹6,000 cr in transmission capital expenditure in the 2nd half of FY27

ADANI ENERGY SOLUTIONS (AESL) expects to commission three to four transmission projects in the second half of the current financial year, adding around ₹1,300 crore to its annualised transmission tariff, CEO Kandarp Patel told analysts during a post-results call.

The projects are WRSR Transmission, Halvad Transmission, Khavda IV-A Transmission and Navinal Transmission, according to the company's investor presentation.

AESL has 15 transmission projects under construction, with a combined capital outlay of ₹ 87,000 crore. During the quarter, the company won two projects — the ₹4,700-crore Satara Transmission project and the ₹8,500-crore Vizag Transmission project.

The company remains on track to invest ₹6,000 crore in transmission capital expenditure in the second half of FY27, over and above the ₹5,500 crore invested in the first half, Patel said. On the proposed acquisition of smart metering company IntelliSmart Infrastructure, Patel said AESL expects to receive approval from the Competition Commission of India (CCI) within a month. The company would then begin integrating the business into its operations. The company announced the acquisition of IntelliSmart Infrastructure for ₹3,050 crore in June.

"They (CCI) wanted some additional information, which we have provided and expect their final approval in the next one month. All other approvals including from Intellismart's lenders and discoms with whom Intellismart has concessionaire agreements are already received," he said.

Patel said the quarter also demonstrated the growing maturity of AESL's Energy Solutions Platform, which houses subsidiary Powerpulse Trading Solutions (PTSL). The platform provides customised energy solutions to commercial and industrial (C&I) customers.

PTSL reported operating revenue of ₹2,197 crore during the quarter, compared with Rs 201 crore in the corresponding period last year.

Over the next couple of years, PTSL aims to secure 7-8 GW of power supply from a mix of sources, including thermal power, renewables and battery storage, while building a nearly equivalent customer base for the offtake of power.

"Our preference is to tie up more and more of our merchant capacity with long term PPAs. We want stability rather than volatility-based on market prices," Patel said.

During the quarter, PTSL entered into a 25-year power purchase agreement (PPA) with Maharashtra State Electricity Distribution Company for the supply of 2,500 MW of round-the-clock power. The first tranche is scheduled to begin supply in February 2027.

CCPA fines walkie-talkie seller Hogar Technologies

THE CENTRAL CONSUMER Protection Authority (CCPA) has imposed a penalty of ₹1 lakh on Hogar Technologies and Innovations LLP for misleading advertisements and product listings of walkie-talkies that did not disclose operating frequencies and licensing requirements.

The order, passed under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019, was issued by the CCPA headed by Chief Commissioner Nidhi Khare and Commissioner Anupam Mishra. The authority found that listings on the company's website did not clearly state the frequencies at which the devices operate, the licences needed to use them, or their regulatory approvals, an official statement said. This, it said, could lead consumers to believe the devices could be used legally without any authorisation.

PTI

New safety norms may push up car prices

AKBAR MERCHANT
Mumbai, October 25

NEW CAR PRICES are expected to rise from April 2027 as stricter vehicle safety standards covering crash protection, pedestrian safety and anti-theft systems are rolled out in phases.

According to a recent circular, a separate rear-impact requirement, effective April 2029, will require vehicles to prevent fuel leakage or battery damage in rear-end collisions, potentially increasing manufacturing costs.



The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) has staggered the implementation timelines to give manufacturers time to incorporate the changes.

"Automakers will have to reassess vehicle structures and safety equipment to comply with the new requirements. Any additional material, engineering or validation costs could push up prices by at least ₹10,000 for an entry-level hatchback," said an industry executive familiar with vehicle development.

Under the rear-impact requirement, all new cars manufactured in India from April 2029 must pass a crash test demonstrating that petrol and diesel models do not suffer fuel leakage, while electric vehicles must avoid battery damage.

Manufacturers have traditionally prioritised high-strength steel (HSS) in vehicle front structures, given the prevalence of frontal collisions. Its use in rear sections has generally been lower across several models.

Compliance could require additional HSS at critical structural points, along with reinforcement around fuel tanks in internal-combustion engine vehicles and battery packs in electric cars. These changes could increase vehicle weight and production costs, potentially pushing up ex-showroom prices.

JK TYRE & INDUSTRIES LTD.

Bolder Vision, Bigger Presence, Stronger Execution

CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND HALF YEAR ENDED 30TH SEPTEMBER, 2026

(₹ in Crores)

Sl. No.	PARTICULARS	Quarter Ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Half Year Ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter Ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)
1	Revenue from Operations	4,840.73	8,786.97	4,011.31
2	Operating Profit (PBIDT)	343.14	610.78	535.68
3	Net Profit before Tax and Exceptional items	105.88	148.79	311.56
4	Net Profit before Tax but after Exceptional items	93.57	147.33	304.08
5	Net Profit after Tax and Exceptional items	65.07	109.16	226.86
6	Total Comprehensive Income [comprising Profit for the period (after Tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after Tax)]	45.99	120.26	260.71
7	Equity Share Capital	57.66	57.66	54.80
8	Other Equity excluding Revaluation Reserve as shown in Audited Balance Sheet		6,003.16	
9	Earnings Per Share (of ₹ 2/- each)			
	- Basic / Diluted (₹)	2.29	3.83	7.96

Notes:

* Standalone financial information of the Company, pursuant to regulation 47(1)(b): (₹ in Crores)

PARTICULARS	Quarter Ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Half Year Ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter Ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)
Turnover	4,460.85	8,393.97	3,530.06
Operating Profit (PBIDT)	314.45	607.48	492.25
Profit before Tax	82.08	179.60	285.02
Profit after Tax	60.68	133.22	211.95

* The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulation, 2015 (SEBI LODR). The full format of the Standalone and Consolidated Quarterly Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange websites (URL- **www.bseindia.com** and **www.nseindia.com**) and on website of the Company at **https://jktyre.com/investor/quarterly-results**. The same can also be accessed by scanning the QR code provided below.

JK Tyre secured highest rating "ESG 1+" from CareEdge for the 3rd year in a row

New Delhi
23rd October, 2026

DESH KA TYRE : JK TYRE

For JK Tyre & Industries Limited
Raghupati Singhania
Chairman & Managing Director

JK MEMBER J.K. ORGANISATION

JK TYRE TORNEL

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ADVERTORIAL

LORD'S MARK INDUSTRIES LTD. becomes ASIA'S FIRST COMPANY to secure multiple US FDA Registrations at once for 200+ Surgical products.



Lord's Mark Industries Limited has become, Asia's first company to secure US FDA registration for over 200 surgical, medical-care and hygiene products. The company plans to commence US exports in December 2026, marking a key milestone in its global expansion. With its Silvassa manufacturing capacity expansion completed ahead of schedule, Lord's Mark Industries is strengthening production readiness for international markets. Its diversified portfolio spans orthopaedic supports, rehabilitation aids, mobility solutions and hygiene essentials, while the company explores South American markets, subject to applicable regulatory requirements.

The product portfolio includes Lords Activeguard cervical-thoracic braces, soft cervical collars, cervical and lumbar supports, abdominal belts, rib belts, chest binders, clavicle braces, shoulder immobilisers, arm slings, wrist and forearm splints, finger splints, thumb spica splints, elbow supports, tennis elbow braces, knee caps, knee immobilisers, hinged knee braces, patellar supports, ankle braces, ankle binders, foot-drop splints and bunion correctors. The range further includes compression stockings, varicose-vein stockings, hernia belts, scrotal supports, pregnancy supports, pelvic binders, cervical traction kits, traction belts, walking sticks, walkers, wheelchairs, commode chairs, orthopaedic cushions, heel cups, silicone insoles and posture correctors.

The hygiene and medical-care range includes Lord's Joywipes disinfectant and cleansing wipes, Lords Magic Elastic Adhesive Bandages, IV Cannula Fixator Elastic Adhesive Bandages, Lords Wonder Cotton Crepe Bandages, Lords Confidence adult diapers and Safelite sanitary napkins. The portfolio also features disposable hot and cold gel packs and medical tourniquets. Together, these products provide a diversified base across orthopaedic support, rehabilitation, mobility, hygiene and medical-care essentials.

The expansion positions the company to explore opportunities in a substantial global healthcare market. According to Mordor Intelligence, **the United States general surgical devices market is projected to grow from US$6.69 billion in 2025 to US$9.67 billion by 2031**, registering a CAGR of 6.35%. The South American general surgical devices market is projected to increase from US$1.37 billion in 2025 to US$2.19 billion by 2031, at a CAGR of 8.20%. These broader market estimates highlight the potential opportunity, although the addressable market for the company will depend on individual product categories and applicable regulatory requirements.

Commenting on the development, **Dr. Sachidanand Upadhyay, Founder, Managing Director and CEO of Lord's Mark Industries Limited**, said, *"This certification proves the strong hold of our regulatory compliance team, our product quality and our vision to make India globally recognised. With over 200 products listed with the US FDA, we are strengthening our global presence. Early completion of our Silvassa expansion enhances export readiness, advancing our vision to position India as a globally recognised healthcare manufacturing hub through quality and regulatory compliance."*

The company plans to leverage its expanded manufacturing capabilities to pursue partnerships with international distributors, healthcare suppliers and institutional buyers. While the United States will be the immediate export priority, South America offers a potential avenue for further expansion. Entry into individual markets will be subject to the applicable product-specific registration, import and distribution requirements.

Lord's hamesha aapke saath!™

www.lordsmark.com



EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND HALF YEAR ENDED 30 SEPTEMBER 2026

(₹ in crores, except per share data)

S. No	Particulars	Quarter ended			Half Year ended		Year ended
		30 September 2026	30 June 2026	30 September 2025	30 September 2026	30 September 2025	31 March 2026
		(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)
1	Income						
	a) Revenue from operations	1,468.26	1,328.08	1,186.01	2,796.34	2,288.75	4,830.36
	b) Other income	15.76	17.14	15.47	32.90	28.71	52.86
2	Profit before share of profit from joint venture, exceptional items and tax	253.99	230.28	181.25	484.27	332.52	725.84
3	Net Profit for the period from continuing operations (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	256.60	231.40	181.74	488.00	333.91	726.86
4	Net Profit for the period before Tax from continuing operations (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	255.05	231.40	181.74	486.45	333.91	682.84
5	Profit for the period/ year from continuing operations	190.83	171.08	134.55	361.91	247.11	490.06
6	Net Profit/(loss) from discontinued operations	(0.11)	(0.05)	(0.57)	(0.16)	(2.82)	(3.06)
7	Net Profit for the period (Continuing and discontinued operations)	190.72	171.03	133.98	361.75	244.29	487.00
8	Total comprehensive income for the period [Comprising Profit for the period (after tax), Other comprehensive income (after tax) and after non controlling interest]	189.39	169.36	132.45	358.75	241.54	494.96
9	Equity share capital (Face value of ₹1/- per share)	15.71	15.93	15.93	15.71	15.93	15.93
10	Other equity (excluding revaluation reserve) as shown in the audited balance sheet of the previous year						3,049.65
11	Earnings per equity share (EPS): (face value : ₹1 per share) (EPS for the quarters/periods is not annualised) For Continuing and discontinued operations						
	a) Basic (₹):	12.02	10.64	8.35	22.66	15.19	30.48
	b) Diluted (₹):	11.99	10.63	8.33	22.62	15.17	30.44

Notes:

(1) The above consolidated financial results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at their respective meetings held on 24 October 2026 and the statutory auditors have expressed an unmodified audit opinion on these results.

(2) The above results have been prepared in accordance with the Indian Accounting Standards ('Ind-AS') as notified under the Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules, 2015 (as amended), specified under section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013.

(3) The Board of Directors have declared an interim dividend of ₹12/- per equity share of face value of ₹1/- each for the financial year 2026-27.

(4) Additional information on standalone financial results is as follows: (₹ in crores)

S. No	Particulars	Quarter ended			Half Year ended		Year ended
		30 September 2026	30 June 2026	30 September 2025	30 September 2026	30 September 2025	31 March 2026
		(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)
1	Income						
	a) Revenue from operations	1,331.90	1,190.08	1,079.09	2,521.98	2,086.41	4,374.31
	b) Other income	23.37	22.31	21.82	45.68	40.46	79.29
2	Net Profit before tax	224.32	209.40	162.64	433.72	296.70	625.80
3	Net Profit after tax	166.28	155.77	120.72	322.05	220.39	456.77
4	Total comprehensive income for the period	166.51	155.99	120.87	322.50	220.69	466.89

(5) The above is an extract of the detailed format of Financial Results for the quarter and half year ended 30 September 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015. The full format of the Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results are available on the website of BSE and NSE at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com respectively and on the Company's website at https://www.kajariaceramics.com/storage/pdf/q2-26-27.pdf and can also be accessed by scanning the Quick Response Code given below.

For and on behalf of the Board

Place: New Delhi
Date: 24 October 2026

Ashok Kajaria
Chairman

KAJARIA CERAMICS LIMITED

Regd Office: SF-11, Second Floor, JMD Regent Plaza, Mehrauli-Gurgaon Road, Village Sikanderpur Ghosi, Gurugram -122001 (Haryana)
Corporate Office: J-1/B-1 (Extn), Mohan Co-operative Industrial Estate, Mathura Road New Delhi-110044, **Ph:** 91-11-26946409, **Fax:** 91-11-26949544, 91-11-26946407
CIN: L26924HR1985PLC056150, **E-mail:** investors@kajariaceramics.com **Website:** www.kajariaceramics.com

Markets

MONDAY, OCTOBER 26, 2026

LENDER STEPS UP CHECKS AS INACTIVE ACCOUNTS EMERGE AS A CYBER FRAUD RISK

SBI moves to shut idle accounts

ABHIJIT LELE
Mumbai, October 25

STATE BANK OF India (SBI), the country's largest lender, plans to close inoperative savings accounts with zero balances to curb cyber frauds and prevent their misuse as mule accounts for routing illicit funds.

The move comes amid growing concerns over fraudsters using dormant bank accounts as mule accounts to receive, transfer and conceal money stolen through cybercrime.

SBI has informed customers that inoperative savings accounts carrying nil balances for more than a year will be closed after a month's notice if their Know Your Customer (KYC) details are not updated during the notice period. No further intimation will be issued before closure.

Under banking regulations, an account is classified as inoperative if there are no customer-initiated transactions for more than two years. Customers seeking to reactivate such accounts can visit any SBI branch with the necessary KYC documents or update their details through digital channels such as YONO.

CUTTING FRAUD ROUTES

- Inoperative savings accounts with nil balances for over a year will be closed after a month's notice if their KYC details are not updated
- No further intimation will be issued before closure



- An account is classified as inoperative if there are no customer-initiated transactions for more than two years
- SBI developed a dashboard that tracks non-funded accounts and reactivates dormant accounts above ₹10,000

A senior SBI executive said the exercise is driven by two considerations — safeguarding customers against potential fraud and reducing the cost of maintaining dormant accounts.

"Inoperative accounts pose risks to both customers and banks as they can be misused. There is also a cost involved in maintaining these accounts. The objective is to manage these risks and costs without inconveniencing genuine customers," the executive said.

The bank has already developed a dashboard to monitor non-funded savings accounts and facilitate the reactivation of inoperative accounts with balances exceeding ₹10,000.

Dormant accounts have increasingly emerged as a vulnerability in the banking system. Fraudsters often exploit such accounts as conduits for moving stolen money, making it difficult for investigating agencies to trace the ultimate beneficiaries.

According to government data released by the Press Information Bureau, the Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre (I4C) has shared details of 2.64 million first-layer mule accounts with banks and enforcement agencies.

Separately, investigations such as the Central Bureau of Investigation's (CBI) Operation Chakra-V have uncovered an extensive network of suspected mule accounts. The operation identified around 850,000 accounts spread across more than 700 bank branches.

SBI's move also comes at a time when the lender disclosed a data breach involving customer information. In a stock exchange filing on October 21, SBI said it had identified 3,897 customer records containing personal information among data exposed on the dark web.

The bank had received alerts about the suspected exposure on October 16 from its threat intelligence service provider, the Defence Cyber Agency and the Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In).

The compromised information reportedly included customer names, registered mobile numbers, dates of birth, email addresses, residential addresses, gender, customer identification numbers (CIF) and lead IDs.

Following the alerts, SBI activated its cyber incident response and containment protocols. It also appointed an independent cybersecurity agency empanelled by CERT-In to investigate the incident and determine the nature and extent of the suspected compromise.

The bank has maintained that the incident has had no material impact on its core operations, financial performance or business continuity.

Insurance reform feedback deadline extended to Oct 31

FE BUREAU
Chennai, October 25

THE INSURANCE REGULATORY and Development Authority of India (Irdai) has extended the deadline for submitting comments on its consultation paper on insurance distribution reforms to October 31 from October 25. The extension follows an encouraging response to the consultation, with the regulator receiving more than 650 comments so far.

"The consultation has received an encouraging response, with over 650 comments received so far. In view of the significant interest and to facilitate wider participation, the last date for submission of comments has been extended till 31st October 2026," the insurance regulator said in a release late on Saturday.

Last month, Irdai released a two-part consultation paper titled 'Recalibrating Economics of Insurance Distribution', inviting feedback from the public, policyholders, insurers, intermediaries and other stakeholders. The paper proposes a major overhaul of insurance distribution by reintroducing hard caps on insurance commissions based on the segment, line of business, distribution channel, product complexity, and the effort involved in selling and servicing policies. It also proposes lowering expense of management (EoM) limits for insurers.

Speaking at the FE Modern BFSI Summit 2026 in Mumbai last week, Irdai Chairman Ajay Seth said the consultation paper, issued ahead of the draft regulations, was intended to give stakeholders another opportunity to provide feedback and facilitate an orderly transition.

In an earlier interaction with *FE*, Seth also said the regulator was open to all kinds of suggestions and feedback, including on the pace of convergence and its impact across different types of entities.

Five IPOs to mobilise ₹2,600 cr this week

FIVE COMPANIES, INCLUDING EAAA India Alternatives, SFC Environmental Technologies, and M K Sons Fine Jewels, are set to launch their initial public offerings (IPOs) next week, seeking to raise close to ₹2,600 crore from the primary market.

BLS Polymers and Bombay Coated and Special Steels would also float their maiden public offerings during the week.

Separately, several other companies, including Gujarat Victory Forging, Milestone Gears, Avaada Electro, Swara Baby Products, Integris Medtech and AGS Health, are in the pipeline for IPO, according to merchant bankers.

These companies are expected to announce price band declarations and launch plans by November 5, ahead of the extended Diwali holiday period in Gujarat, where markets and business activity are likely to be affected by the post-Diwali observance of Labh Pancham from November 6 to 15, they added.

The upcoming issues follow a busy month for the primary market, which saw Jio Platforms launch the country's biggest-ever public issue worth ₹30,213 crore.

The five upcoming IPOs will open for subscription between October 26 and October 29. —PTI

● V VAIDYANATHAN, MD & CEO, IDFC FIRST BANK

'Margins expected to recover to 5.8% by Q4'

IDFC FIRST Bank expects credit and deposit growth to remain around 20% in the near term, says MD & CEO **V Vaidyanathan**. *He tells* **Christina Titus** *that the impact of the proposed changes in insurance commission norms will be largely offset by savings from FCNR(B) funding and the benefits of higher interest rates. Excerpts:*

The bank reported a 196.5% year-on-year increase in net profit in Q2. What were the key drivers?

Our growth has been steady, with the core loan book and deposits expanding by around 20-22%. More importantly, operating expenses are growing about 500 basis points slower than income, reflecting tighter cost controls. This has helped operating profit grow 39%. At the same time, credit costs, or provisions, have declined 27% y-o-y as portfolio quality improves. Higher operating profit, coupled with lower provisions, is driving profitability.

Do you expect credit and deposit growth to sustain at these levels?

We believe growth of around 20% in both loans and deposits is sustainable for the foreseeable future, given the demand environment. We are still a relatively young bank with a smaller base, making growth of around 20% quite comfortable for us.

How have FCNR(B) deposits affected margins? What is your outlook for net interest margins?

The decline in net interest margin (NIM) is partly optical. We raised loans worth $2.5 billion through our international banking unit to lend to NRI customers, enabling them to place FCNR(B) deposits with the bank. This expanded the denominator without a corresponding increase in net interest income.

However, the larger denominator also proportionately benefits the operating expense and credit cost ratios. Looking at NIM alone does not capture the full picture, which becomes evident at the return-on-assets (RoA) level.

We expect margins to recover to around 5.8% by Q4 FY27 as the excess liquidity from FCNR(B) deposits is deployed. These inflows have been hugely positive for the bank, providing substantial structural liquidity for three to five years.

Have deficient monsoons and drought-like conditions in some states affected your loan portfolio?

Based on what we see today, we remain comfortable with our credit cost outlook for Q3 and Q4. However, the situation is evolving, and we are monitoring developments very closely.

> WE BELIEVE GROWTH OF AROUND 20% IN BOTH LOANS AND DEPOSITS IS SUSTAINABLE FOR THE FORESEEABLE FUTURE



How do you see rural lending evolving amid these risks? Could weak monsoons and rising inflation hurt rural consumption and credit growth?

Rural financing is an integral part of the country's economic ecosystem, and credit must continue to flow to these segments. We will continue expanding our rural loan portfolio across microfinance, tractor loans, Kisan Credit Cards, dairy loans, rural SME loans and micro-enterprise lending.

I do not necessarily expect rural consumption to slow. The impact of the monsoon has not been uniform across the country, and several regions have received normal rainfall.

What impact do you expect from the insurance regulator's proposed commission norms? How will the bank absorb the potential hit to fee income?

We should assume the draft regulations are implemented in their current form and factor in the impact. However, there are offsets.

The ₹35,000 crore raised through FCNR(B) deposits has come at a cost roughly 1 percentage point lower than comparable domestic funding. This translates into significant savings on funding costs.

Further, if interest rates rise in line with our house view, our floating-rate loan book will reprice faster, while deposit rates will adjust with a lag. These benefits should largely offset the impact of the proposed commission norms, allowing the bank to broadly meet its profitability targets for FY28.

Explainer

● What is NPS Central?

IT IS A unified digital platform launched by Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) which will enable subscribers of National Pension System (NPS) to enrol, invest and manage their account. It is jointly managed by the three central recordkeeping agencies (CRA) under NPS—Protean, KFintech, and CAMS. Each CRA will continue maintaining its own subscriber records, while NPS Central will access the information required to provide a consolidated experience. They will securely share relevant data with NPS Central through standardised interfaces, enabling interoperability while retaining accountability for their respective records. "The objective is to unify access and service delivery, rather than necessarily merge all three CRAs into one database," says Vishwajeet Goel, head, Pensionbazaar. A useful parallel is MF Central, which brings together mutual fund investments across participating registrars, fund houses and distributors through a common interface. NPS Central has the potential to deliver a similar level of consolidation for NPS investments across CRAs, PoPs, pension fund managers and the employers.

PENSION PORTAL



How NPS Central could be a game-changer for subscribers

The pension fund regulator has launched NPS Central which provides a unified digital experience for subscribers of National Pension System (NPS). ***Saikat Neogi*** explains how the portal can simplify the NPS lifecycle—from onboarding and contributions to investment decisions, portability, and retirement disbursal

₹17,40,514 cr
AUM OF NPS WITH 23,142,622 SUBSCRIBERS AS ON SEP 30, 2026

ALL THREE CENTRAL RECORDKEEPING AGENCIES —PROTEAN, KFINTECH, AND CAMS— WILL SHARE THEIR DATA WITH NPS CENTRAL ENABLING INTEROPERABILITY

● How will this help subscribers?

FOR NEW CUSTOMERS, the unified platform will make onboarding easier. It will help them understand available NPS options before registering, explore scheme features, charges and historical returns before investing. They can resolve queries without navigating multiple service-provider portals.

For existing subscribers, it will simplify access to contributions, profile updates, statements and grievance services. Employees under corporate NPS can monitor contributions and verification of employer remittances.

As the disbursal stage is the most critical part of an NPS subscriber's journey, experts say the portal should enable features that will help subscribers navigate premature and final withdrawals, explore the Retirement Income Scheme, select the annuity option and the provider and the associated documentation and processes. As these functionalities are already available through CRA platforms, bringing them into NPS Central would be the logical next step.

● Will it address the need for portability?

THE PLATFORM COULD be a game-changer for corporate NPS subscribers who change jobs multiple times and need to move their accounts from one CRA to another, and help make portability a reality. At present, a subscriber has to submit an inter-CRA subscriber shifting request to change the CRA. Corporate NPS subscribers have grown 2.3 times from 1.4 million in FY22 to 3.2 million in FY27 (till September 30). As more young employees join NPS to build a tax-efficient nest egg, experts say CRA switching should become part of the platform. "An employer may use a different CRA from the one maintaining the employee's existing NPS account. Simplifying this transition would make corporate NPS easier to manage for employees and employers," says Amit H L, founder and CEO, Floatr Wealth. In fact, prior to the introduction of the Universal Account Number by the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation, subscribers there faced difficulties managing multiple accounts whenever they changed jobs.

● How can an NPS subscriber access these services?

A SUBSCRIBER CAN log in to NPS Central (www.npscentral.in) with mobile number and date of birth and authenticate it with a one-time password. The subscriber need not remember his PRAN number and will not have to manage separate logins across different CRAs. At present, the account holder has to either log in to their point-of-presence (PoP) interface or CRA interface to manage their NPS account, check their balance, get a statement or switch fund houses. For an employee who has changed jobs multiple times and has a corporate NPS account, the unified platform will make it easier for him to access pension services, irrespective of which CRA maintains the account.

The unified digital platform will also facilitate registration for NPS Swasthya, a health-focused pension initiative introduced by the pension fund regulator recently.

● How can this be improved further?

IN JULY, THE regulator had launched a digital toolkit — The Pension Fund Returns for Informed Decision & Empowerment (PRIDE-DISHA) to make better-informed retirement planning decisions. It enables investors to decide whether to remain in a higher-equity active choice strategy, move to an auto choice option for automatic age-based rebalancing, or switch between them as they approach retirement in order to optimise long-term risk-adjusted returns. Integrating this with NPS Central would be a logical step towards creating a comprehensive, single-point platform for NPS subscribers. PRIDE-DISHA could provide the analytical capabilities for comparing historical returns and investment outcomes, while NPS Central could serve as the common interface through which subscribers review their options and act on informed decisions. This integration would eliminate the need to navigate separate platforms to compare pension funds and then return to the account portal to act on that information.

Personal Finance

MONDAY, OCTOBER 26, 2026

RETIREMENT SOLUTIONS
Vikas Gupta, chief product officer, ICICI Life Insurance

Rising living expenses and changing financial priorities make it crucial to have retirement solutions that provide stability.

Contra funds hold up, see recovery potential

THE CONTRA ADVANTAGE EMERGES BEYOND THREE YEARS & IS DECISIVE BEYOND FIVE

SAIKAT NEOGI

AT A TIME when equities are down, contra funds have held up better than the benchmark. These funds seek mispriced opportunities in out-of-favour segments, but possess strong long-term earnings potential. Fund houses such as ICICI Prudential, Bandhan and Motilal Oswal have recently launched contra funds that can cash in when cycles reverse.

Contra funds are suitable for those who can stay invested for three to five years and live with long stretches of poor returns. Beginners, or anyone needing steady short-term gains, should stay away. On a trailing three-year CAGR basis, the contra category has averaged around 12% with a median closer to 13.2%. In contrast, the large-cap category has averaged around 9.3% with a median in the same range.

What makes this gap more meaningful is the dispersion within each category. In large-cap, the spread between the best and worst performer is much wider — the highest return is at 13% while the lowest is 6.5%. In contra funds, the range is narrower — lowest return is 9.7% while highest is 13.2% which suggests the contrarian style has benefitted from a structural tailwind.

A key reason for this outperformance is that contra funds have the flexibility to invest across market capitalisations. The mandate allows fund managers to go wherever the contrarian opportunity sits, which is a structural advantage over a large-cap fund that must stay within a defined universe. "When you look at existing contra fund portfolios, they hold a mix of well-known large-caps alongside lesser-followed mid and small-cap names," says Nirav R Karkera, head of research, W by Groww.

However, on a one-year trailing basis, contra funds are currently sitting at around - 8%, which is in line with large-cap drawdowns. So, in the short term, you get similar pain without the perceived safety of an index-hugging portfolio.

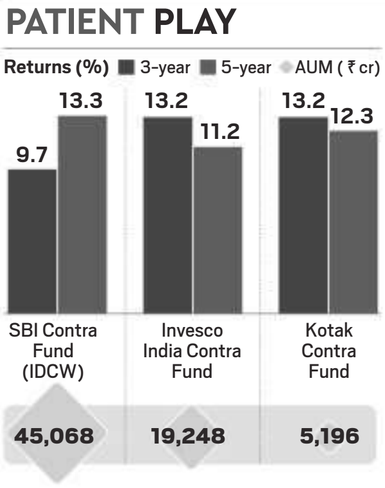
Patience matters

Contra investing needs patience as the market may need years to recognise the value a manager sees in an unfavoured company. A contra manager buys stocks the market dislikes, so the portfolio will often look wrong for a year or two before it looks right. If you check your contra fund every quarter against the Nifty, you will likely exit at the worst time.

"Pick a horizon long enough to cover a full market cycle, and judge the fund against its contra peers rather than just the index," says Shashank Udupa, founder, Vayu Capital. Where the contra advantage emerges is beyond three years, and it becomes decisive beyond five. The category average at five years is nearly double that of large-cap funds, a sign that the mean-reversion cycle needs time to play out.

"For most investors it works best as a satellite around a diversified core of index or active funds, not a replacement," says Gurmeet Singh Chawla, managing director, Master Portfolio Services.

PATIENT PLAY



Growth option; direct plan
Source: Accord, W Research



- Contra investing needs patience as the market may need years to recognise the value in an unfavoured company
- The category average at five years is nearly double that of large-cap funds, indicating that the mean-reversion cycle needs time to play out
- These funds seek mispriced opportunities in out-of-favour segments
- Contra funds have the flexibility to invest across market capitalisations

TAX TALK

Returning to India? Your residential status matters



NEERAJ AGARWALA

FOR INDIANS RETURNING from Dubai or other tax-free or low-tax jurisdictions, the date of relocation can be more than a logistical decision. It can determine how overseas income and investments are taxed in India. The opportunity lies in understanding the transition from non-resident (NR) to Resident but Not Ordinarily Resident (RNOR), and eventually Resident and Ordinarily Resident (ROR).

A NR is taxed in India on income received or deemed to be received in India, and income accruing or deemed to accrue in India. An RNOR is taxed on Indian income and on foreign income derived from a business or profession controlled in India. Other foreign income generally remains outside the Indian tax net. An ROR, however, is taxable on global income, regardless of where it is earned or received.



Under the general residential-status tests, an individual who spends 182 days or more in India during a tax year becomes resident, subject to the other applicable provisions. However, in case of individuals that are citizens of India, not liable to tax in any other country and total income in India exceeds ₹15 lakh then such individuals are deemed to be RNOR irrespective of their duration of stay in India. Three decisions deserve particular attention during this transition.

Repatriate money from foreign bank account

Consider a returning professional who has accumulated ₹3 crore in a Dubai bank account from salary earned during years of overseas employment. Suppose the funds remain in a Dubai deposit earning interest. While the individual is RNOR, interest accruing and received outside India remain outside India's tax net. However, once the individual becomes ROR, interest accruing on the deposit is taxable in India, even if it continues to be credited to the Dubai account.

Sell overseas property before becoming ROR

Capital gains from selling foreign property becomes taxable in India once the seller is ROR, even if the property and sale proceeds remain abroad. If the sale takes place while the seller is RNOR, the gain may fall outside India's tax net where it is foreign-source income and the proceeds are received outside India. However, the tax treatment in the UAE, transaction costs and commercial rationale for the sale should also be considered before deciding whether to dispose of the property.

Retain foreign investments

An individual holding a portfolio of overseas shares may consider whether to retain the investments or realise gains while still RNOR. A sale during RNOR may produce a different Indian tax outcome from a sale after becoming ROR. Returning Indians should review their foreign deposits, property and investment portfolios before their residential status changes. RNOR is not a blanket tax holiday, but it can offer a limited period to make informed decisions.

The writer is senior partner, Nangia & Company. Inputs from Neetu Brahma

LOAN METRICS

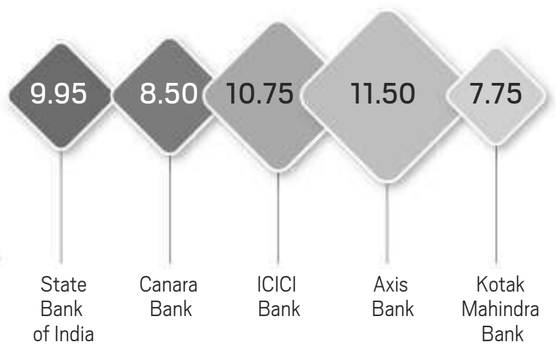
LOAN AGAINST SECURITIES

Finding the funds

Pledge your shares or mutual funds as collateral to raise money from a bank or NBFC at a lower rate as compared to a personal loan



Interest rates (%)



Rates as advertised on respective banks' website as on October 22, 2026; Actual rates may vary based on lender's policies and eligibility; Compiled by BankBazaar.com

SMART MONEY

MUTUAL FUND

Multi asset FoF from Motilal Oswal

MOTILAL OSWAL MUTUAL Fund has launched Motilal Oswal Multi Asset-Omni Fund of Funds, an open-ended fund of funds investing in equity-oriented schemes, debt-oriented schemes, and gold and silver ETFs. The fund seeks to provide investors with exposure to multiple asset classes through a single product, with an active asset allocation approach. The fund follows an asset allocation framework based on macro parameters, valuation and momentum indicators. Subscription to the new fund offer will close on November 4, 2026.

CREDIT CARD

Airline miles offer on Bobcard Etihad cards

BOBCARD HAS ANNOUNCED a limited-period Welcome Miles offer on the BOBCARD Etihad Guest Credit Card and BOBCARD Etihad Guest Premium Credit Card. New cardholders can earn up to 7,500 bonus Etihad Guest Miles on the entry variant and up to 15,000 miles on the premium variant within the first 65 days of card issuance. The offer is valid until November 15, 2026. The joining fee for the entry card is ₹2,500 and for the premium card it is ₹5,000.

Education

THE 2026 SHIFT

A year when India's study-abroad aspirants chose new locations

DATA SHOWS INDIAN STUDENTS DIVERSIFYING AWAY FROM TRADITIONAL BIG FOUR

VIKRAM CHAUDHARY

FOR YEARS, the Big Four study-abroad locations — the US, the UK, Canada, and Australia — were a favourite among Indian students. But as visa walls went higher and post-study work windows were shortened — especially after Donald Trump assumed office for his second term as the US President on January 20, 2025 — this year is marking a turning point.

Rob Grimshaw, CEO of global student mobility platform Studyin, said that this behavioural shift runs deep and fundamentally alters how students view foreign education. "In the past, it was all about the Big Four... students are very prestige-orientated, but the new generation is much more open-minded. The word today isn't prestige; it's practicality," Grimshaw said.

He noted students are increasingly asking where they can find an affordable course that supports real career aspirations and guarantees a future, regardless of traditional destination country boundaries. "This practicality is supported by the rapid democratisation of English-medium instruction across non-traditional countries — from Germany and France to even China's top-ranked Tsinghua University — allowing students to bypass local language barriers," Grimshaw said.

While official figures from the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) indicate that cumulative Indian student outflows were more than 1 million globally, education experts point out that the geographical distribution is shifting towards alternative places in Europe and Asia.

Countries like New Zealand are working to capture the interest of Indian applicants. Adrian Hirst, Education New Zealand's (ENZ) regional director for India and South Asia, noted during an interaction that ENZ is building a sustainable, long-term appeal for Indian students rather than banking on temporary spillovers from the Big Four. Latest full-year data shows international student enrolments in New Zealand hitting 92,580 — an 11% growth — with Indian students targeting high-demand sectors like agri-tech, engineering, healthcare, and education.

Germany has similarly emerged as a major choice for Indian STEM aspirants. Data from the German Federal Statistical Office shows that Indian student enrolment reached a record high of 69,816 students for the winter semester 2025-26, representing a 17.5% increase from the previous year. Indians account for 13.5% of all foreign students in Germany, aided by most public universities being tuition-free (requiring only administrative charges of around 1,500 euros for a two-year course), combined with an 18-month job-seeking visa and opportunities in Europe's largest economy battling tech labour shortages.

Geographic closeness and cost-efficiency also drove many students towards the Middle East, especially the UAE. Arnav Kumar, co-founder of study-abroad platform Leap, highlighted that the mindset of Indian applicants has evolved. "Over 85% of applicants now prioritise post-study career advancement over academic credentials alone — such as the global ranking and brand of the host institution — and 68% of students cite affordability as their top concern," Kumar said.

As the full year mobility data starts to come in from government bodies and education companies, one thing is clear that the modern Indian student is focusing on return on investment, and is exploring new corridors across Europe and Asia.



NEW CORRIDORS

- Indian student enrolment in Germany reached a record 69,816 for the 2025-26 semester
- International student enrolments in New Zealand hit 92,580, marking 11% growth
- Over 85% Indian students prioritise post-study career advancement over prestige
- Almost 70% of Indian students cite affordability as their top primary concern

Bringing the factory into the classroom

BECAUSE RAW ACCESS TO SOFTWARE ISN'T ENOUGH

VIKRAM CHAUDHARY



Deepak NG, MD, Dassault Systèmes India

INDIA PRODUCES LAKHS of engineering graduates each year, yet corporates keep asking: How to bridge the industry-academia divide? Dassault Systèmes believes the answer lies in bringing the entire industrial ecosystem into the classroom, virtually.

In an exclusive interaction, Deepak NG, the managing director of Dassault Systèmes India, shared that the French software MNC has been working on solving this divide ever since it set up its first Centre of Excellence with the Karnataka government back in 2016.

He added that, today, more than 2,000 academic institutions across India rely on Dassault's suites — including SolidWorks, Catia, and Simulia — for product design and simulation. Alongside partnerships with state governments of Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, and Assam, the company has been embedding industrial tech into campuses.

But Deepak said that raw access to software is no longer enough.

French software MNC Dassault Systèmes is bringing the virtual twin of an organisation into the classroom

Simulating the entire ecosystem

The missing link is context. An engineering student might master designing a car's component on a screen, but understanding how that part is important for the entire automotive ecosystem needs a thorough knowledge of manufacturing, supply chain, and the market.

To solve this, Dassault is bringing the virtual twin of an organisation into the classroom. Unlike static 3D models, a virtual twin creates a digital replica of a product, process, or even a system, letting students simulate real world.

Deepak added that, under such a framework, mechanical engineering, computer science, and even management students could collaborate on a single unified project. "While a mechanical student designs a chassis, a computer science major codes its software, and management students simulate the shop-floor assembly line, replicating how real corporate departments operate," he said.

Scaling beyond metros

This model is shifting away from urban India. "Cloud-based deployment is opening doors for institutions in tier-2 and tier-3 places — thanks to widespread internet — with initiatives like the Guwahati Centre of Excellence serving as a blueprint for wider rural access," he said. "The goal isn't just teaching students how to use software tools, but teaching them how the modern industry works."

Beyond education, Dassault is looking at how these immersive environments tie into its broader enterprise strategy. For instance, at its recent 20th 3DExperience Forum India in Mumbai, the company rolled out virtual companions like Aura, Leo, and Marie to anchor engineering and business operations.

Opinion

MONDAY, OCTOBER 26, 2026



COMBATING CRISIS

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar

"The case for reformed multilateralism gets stronger by the day. Large parts of the world cannot be left out from decision-making. The UN must show leadership, not be a spectator to global crisis

Defying tariff odds

India's latest trade numbers indicate the need for diversification and more FTAs

THE LATEST TRADE data for this fiscal till September underscore the challenges India faces in its most important markets, notably the US and China that account for a quarter of its overall trade. India's shipments to the US were up by 11.1% year-on-year largely due to the frontloading of shipments in September to avert the threat of levies up to 100% for buying Russian oil under the Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act. The biggest challenge in the US market is coping with the tariff disruption of the Trump administration. In contrast, export growth to China appears impressive at 36.1% but it is from a much smaller base. Stepping up shipments is far from easy as it is a difficult market to penetrate. The dragon's "persistent non-tariff barriers", for instance, have been restricting our exports, according to India's Finance Minister, Nirmala Sitharaman.

The US President has threatened India with tariffs from 10% to 100% over the past year. Even if some of these only remained threats, the uncertainty impacted exporters of seafood, gems and jewellery, textiles, drugs, and engineering goods. According to a five-part series in *FE*, the US remains the most important destination but exporters sustained volumes by diversifying. Seafood exports took a big hit last fiscal but this was offset by shipments to the European Union (EU) and China. Gems and jewellery is feebly recovering with shipments redirected to West Asia. As tariffs swung between 10%, 25%, and 50% complicating sourcing decisions for US buyers, diversification was imperative also for textile exporters. The threat of extending a 100% levy on branded medicines impacted prospective exports of high-value nutraceutical products. Only engineering goods bucked the trend as both buyers and suppliers absorbed US tariff costs.

Unfortunately, the prospect of exporting more to China is equally challenging. While recent gains include seafood products, naphtha, and printed circuit boards, cracking that market has proved elusive. Seafood exporters, however, confront the reality that the dragon absorbs large volumes but squeezes prices. Market access is being denied for shipments of generic drugs, bovine meat, and agricultural produce despite significant demand potential. While there have been discussions for a reverse-trade model for drugs—India imports bulk drugs from the dragon, converts them to finished dosage forms, and exports these back to China—there has so far been no discernible progress. As for non-tariff barriers, China has banned 10 Indian rice exporters by revoking their registrations and rejected over 70 non-basmati shipments as they allegedly contained genetically modified (GM) organisms although India does not grow GM food crops.

Looking ahead, India's exporters must diversify to boost their overall performance. Trade diversification through free trade agreements (FTAs) is certainly efficacious in this regard. India's exports to the UK and Oman, where our trade agreements have become operational, have done well. Our FTA with New Zealand has also come into force recently. The trade deal with the EU is also expected to become operational in early 2027. All of this can boost our merchandise shipments manifold. India must prioritise concluding an agreement with its biggest export destination, the US, so that exporters benefit from a stable tariff architecture. In this regard, there are welcome indications from the US that this deal is imminent. There is also no alternative but to keep engaging with China so that our trading relationship is less one-sided and has more balance.

INVESTMENT SLOWDOWN

FPIs' IRRITATION WITH INDIA LED BY LOCAL FACTORS; IT'S TIME TO BE HUMBLE AND TAKE STEPS TO RESPECT THEM

From ignorance to dismay



AJIT DAYAL

Founder, Quantum Advisors

HAVING STARTED QUANTUM Advisors in 1990 to encourage foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) to invest in India, I have never seen such dismay and irritation with India. The level of inquisitiveness, as indicated in the number of registered FPIs, has surged 24x from 500 to 12,000 in the past 25 years. Though FPIs own listed stocks worth $800 billion, the feeling of dismay is widespread.

In 1990, India was a closed and insular economy. The market cap of publicly listed stocks was $60 billion and our GDP was $350 billion. Reforms by successive governments have led to India's market cap surging over 70 times in 36 years to $4 trillion while GDP has surged 12x to $4 trillion. The BSE-30 Index has delivered an astounding growth of 150x in INR and—after adjusting for the nearly 80% decline in the value of the Indian rupee since 1991—that is still a dollar increase of 25x in 36 years. Governments—be it under the Congress or the Bharatiya Janata Party, single-party or coalition-run—have contributed to this mind-boggling success. Yet, despite all the bonhomie at well-curated conferences, "dismay" and "irritation" reflect the present mood of FPIs towards India. Worryingly, this is not all due to cyclical factors such as "the lack of an AI story", "higher oil prices", or "rising global interest rates": all factors beyond India's control.

In the past, India's fortunes were linked to emerging market flows but the country emerged from every global crisis with more capital and more positivity. In 1991, India was a novelty—a large economy had declared its willingness to accept foreign capital. Most FPIs were ignorant about India and they invested in an "act of faith" as described by Manmohan Singh, the finance minister who led India's reforms. We weathered many external storms—the tequila crisis in 1994; Asian crisis in July 1997; bankruptcy of Long-Term Capital Management in 1998; bursting of the tech bubble in February 2000; the 9/11 attacks on the US in 2001; SARS pandemic in 2003; rupturing of the 2005 BRIC madness; and bankruptcy of Lehman Brothers in 2008; the "twist" by the US central bank to increase interest rates in 2013; and the Covid pandemic in 2020. After every panic, FPI flows into India marched upward. This feels different: the dismay, disinterest, and irritation with India is led by local, home-grown factors.

FPIs deserve a Return on Effort which is not decapacitated by a capital gains tax or an ancient mindset of forcibly weakening the Indian rupee to shelter exports

The India Shining, Incredible India, Resurgent India, and "China+1" pitches made by 10 successive governments since the 1990s suggested that India is a must-own gem for FPI and foreign direct investment (FDI). While it is true that India is an exciting economy with a great potential for decades to come, we need to be welcoming. Policies based on extraction by way of taxation of capital gains or on the outdated mentality of boosting exports by depreciating the currency (which is a tax on the total capital that an FPI or FDI invests in India) has hurt the required rate of return for FPI and FDI. Entities such as pension funds and endowments have no tax in their home country: taxes on capital gains paid in India cannot be offset precisely because they are tax-free entities in their home countries. Furthermore, when pension funds move their India allocation from, say, a pool of capital investing in "international markets" to a pool of capital investing in an "emerging market bucket", the tax man is quick to treat this as a sale and gleefully demands a capital gains tax. The draconian policy of imposing retrospective taxes puts the FPI in an awkward position where a current investor is footing the tax bill on a beneficiary who has already redeemed.

AI, oil, and governance

Today, the passion for the AI trade is a significant factor in deciding allocations from the providers of capital. While the lack of an AI story in India is worrisome, the increasing focus on questionable governance in India is a further hurdle. Over the past 25 years, the GDP of China has grown twice that of India but the returns from Indian stock markets have been 2x that of China. This was largely due to poor governance in China at the policy level (supporting cronies and nationalistic policies) and at the company level (founders and managements stealing from minority investors). FPIs are now witnessing uncertain governance in India. Just as the tech giants have many Indian-origin CEOs, so do the FPIs. At a personal level, the Indian diaspora experienced India's wheels of corruption when they seek to close bank accounts and distribute assets of their deceased parents—or hear sordid tales from family members who own businesses in India. The India story moves from "ease of doing business" to the "grease of doing business".

These negatives are not new and are not attributable to any one government or political party. Across the political spectrum, the disrespect for consistency of rules, the tampering of laws, and the arrogance that breeds from an assumption that India has a TINA (there is no alternative) factor. Rather than seeing inflows of $100 billion a year, we see redemptions of $25 billion. And it is not due to the AI we read about, but due to the other AI we don't write about: Arrogant India. It is time to be humble and take steps to respect our FPI guests. FPIs make an effort to study, analyse, and invest in India: they deserve a Return on Effort which is not decapacitated by a capital gains tax or an ancient mindset of forcibly weakening the Indian rupee to shelter exports. India needs to commit to an ecosystem to attract capital flows, without the punishment of capital blows.

FROM PLATE TO PLOUGH

Fertiliser imbalance costing us by the day



ASHOK GULATI
RITIKA JUNEJA

Respectively Distinguished Professor and Senior Fellow at ICRIER

Simple economics has ensured reform meant to fix disparity has made it worse; the question is whether the govt will bite the bullet before the soils give way

ON OCTOBER 22, Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan launched his "*Khet Bachao Abhiyan*" (Save the Farm Campaign) for the rabi season in Karnal, Haryana. His focus is on correcting the disproportionate use of chemical fertilisers, which is harming the soil and underground water and polluting air. He is appealing to farmers to use chemical fertilisers in line with the doses recommended by state agricultural universities for major crops. He is well aware of the problem, but the question is whether the farmers will heed his advice, especially when the pricing policy on urea, diammonium phosphate (DAP), and muriate of potash (MOP) is sending them the wrong signals. Sixteen years after the Nutrient-Based Subsidy (NBS) scheme was introduced in 2010, the imbalance in the use of nitrogen (N), phosphate (P), and potash (K) has gotten worse.

Crops, like humans, need a balanced meal. A recent ICRIER policy brief, "Repurposing India's Fertiliser Policy towards Nutrient Optimisation", by Chand et al compares actual nutrient use in 20 major states with crop- and irrigation-specific norms in the triennium ending 2009-10 and 2024-25, neatly bracketing the NBS reform of 2010.

The results are sobering. The national nitrogen use has shot up from 7% below its recommended dose to 6% above it. The phosphorus deficit has narrowed only from 29 to 22%, while the potassium deficit has deepened from 48 to 72%: farmers apply 9 kg of potash per hectare against a need of 32 kg. The NPK ratio stands at 10.5:4.1:1, against a derived normative 2.8:1.5:1. Eleven of the 20 major states overuse nitrogen, led by Jharkhand (72%) and Punjab (65%). Every state underuses potash—Haryana and Jharkhand utilise barely a tenth of what their crops need.

Why has a reform meant to fix the imbalance made it worse? Simple economics. The NBS let the prices of phosphatic and potassic fertilisers float with world markets, but kept urea out at a fixed price. Between 2010-11 and 2024-25, DAP prices nearly trebled to ₹54/kg and MOP rose six-fold to ₹52/kg, while the price of nitrogen in urea rose by just 1%. Farmers respond to relative prices. Nitrogen also makes the crop look green, while the damage from missing potash shows up later, and quietly. So, nitrogen's share in NPK use is back to about 67%, where it was in 1970-71.

PM-PRANAM was supposed to reward states for cutting total fertiliser use, regardless of which nutrient. But so far nothing was disbursed in 3 years

The damage runs from the soil to the plate. Of the 96 lakh samples tested under the Soil Health Card scheme in 2025-26, 72% were low in nitrogen, 52% in organic carbon, 42% in boron, and 37% in zinc. Low nitrogen, despite its overuse, is no paradox: carbon-starved soils cannot hold what is poured on them, and crops take up only 30-40% of the nitrogen applied. A part of the rest escapes into the air as nitrous oxide, a greenhouse gas 273 times as potent as carbon dioxide; Punjab's fertiliser-related emissions are nearly double the national average. A portion leaches into groundwater: nitrate above safe limits has been found in parts of 502 districts, carrying the risk of "blue baby syndrome" in infants and chronic illness in adults.

Next, the crops. Potassium deficiency weakens resistance to drought and disease and lowers grain quality; phosphorus shortage delays flowering. A crop that looks lush green on urea may be weak within. Then, our health: soils short of zinc and other micronutrients produce grain short of them too, feeding the hidden hunger that afflicts millions.

All this comes at a steep fiscal price. Against a subsidy of ₹1.71 lakh crore budgeted for 2026-27, the disruption in the Strait of Hormuz could push the subsidy bill to anywhere between ₹2.5 lakh crore to ₹3 lakh crore, with urea accounting for about two-thirds. The benefits are skewed too: Punjab gets about ₹25,700 of nitrogen subsidy per hectare, ten times what Kerala gets. Add MSP-based procurement and subsidised power, and the rice-wheat rotation gets locked in, whatever it does to the aquifers.

What then is the way out? Four steps can improve the situation.

One, move from input price subsidy to a direct benefit transfer on per hectare basis, neutral across nutrients and crops, so that farmers face the market price of each nutrient and urea loses its artificial edge. AgriStack is creating digital farmer IDs linked to land records and crops sown, and the Framework for Fertiliser Sale ties each purchase at the point of sale to that identity. But identifying tenants remains a challenge. If this seems too abrupt, bring urea under the NBS while lowering DAP and MOP prices in step, keeping the overall subsidy budget at around ₹2 lakh crore.

Two, reward balance where decisions are made. The PM-PRANAM was supposed to reward states for cutting total fertiliser use, regardless of which nutrient. But so far nothing was disbursed in three years. This scheme needs to be fixed and implemented.

Three, plough the savings in fertiliser subsidy back into drip irrigation, fertigation, and back-product innovation: customised and coated fertilisers, triple super phosphate in place of DAP, biofertilisers, nano fertilisers, and gene-edited seeds using nitrogen more efficiently.

Four, follow the 4Rs—right source, right rate, right time, and right place—with plot-level advice based on soil tests. Rotating cereals with pulses can cut the next crop's nitrogen need by 20-30%. But none of this will stick in Punjab and Haryana unless power pricing and procurement are reformed alongside.

The yardstick of success must change from total fertilisers used to balanced nutrients. India's soils have been quietly underwriting our food security for decades; that account is now overdrawn. The real question is whether the government will bite the bullet before the soils give way. The cost of waiting is rising with every season.

Views are personal

THE HUMAN FACTOR

The one job AI can't fake

THERE WAS A time when calling someone a storyteller was not a compliment. It meant they were fibbing, or at least embellishing, like a colleague recounting how they single-handedly saved the quarterly numbers. Now it is a job title, and an increasingly well-paid one.

Last year, according to *The Wall Street Journal*, the share of LinkedIn job postings in the US mentioning "storyteller" doubled. Executives used the word on earnings calls about 30% more often than the year before. Google has advertised storytelling roles paying up to $274,000. Somewhere, a novelist who has spent a decade earning less than a parking attendant is weeping.

My first instinct was to roll my eyes. Corporate life has a habit of taking a perfectly good word and draining the blood out of it. "Passion" now means turning up. "Journey" means a reorganisation. I assumed "storyteller" would go the same way, a fancy name for the person who writes the press release about the new logo.

Then I thought about Satya Nadella. When he took over Microsoft in 2014, the company had a culture so combative that its organisation chart had been lampooned as rival factions pointing guns at each other. Nadella did not fix this with a slide deck. He told a story: Microsoft had to stop being a company of know-it-alls and become one of learn-it-alls. It was a cheesy line. It also worked, because people could remember it, repeat it, and catch their bosses failing to live up to it.

His best story is personal. In *Hit Refresh*, he writes about his son Zain, born with severe cerebral palsy, and how fatherhood taught him empathy. I cannot recall a single Microsoft quarterly result. I remember Zain.

Ratan Tata understood this too. He liked to say the idea for the Nano came from watching a family of four on a scooter in the rain. As a business case, the Nano was a disappointment. As a story, it was unbeatable; people who have never sat in one can still tell you why it was built.



SHYAMAL MAJUMDAR

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Jeff Bezos went further and banned PowerPoint from Amazon's senior meetings, replacing it with six-page narrative memos read in silence before anyone spoke. Bullet points, he argued, let you hide sloppy thinking; a narrative forces you to explain how one thing leads to another. It sounds like an English teacher's punishment. Amazon seems to have survived it.

Why the sudden rush? I suspect artificial intelligence. Machines can now produce a serviceable press release, blog post, or CEO letter in seconds. The results are grammatical, upbeat, and forgettable, like a hotel breakfast. When everyone can generate competent prose for nothing, competent prose is worth nothing. What becomes scarce is the thing the machine cannot fake: a story that is true, specific, and told by someone who has something to lose.

AI is a brilliant mimic. It knows what a story sounds like on average, but good stories avoid averages. They turn on an odd detail, an admitted failure, an embarrassment the teller would rather forget. A chatbot has never been embarrassed, never waited to be fired, never sat by a sick child's bed. It can describe these things. It cannot have lived them, and audiences can tell.

There is a catch. Companies hiring storytellers often want the stories without the truth. They want the hero's journey minus the bit where the hero falters. That is not storytelling; it is marketing, and staff see through it instantly. Nadella's line worked because it admitted Microsoft had been insufferable. By all means hire a storyteller, but give them something true to tell. No machine can supply that, and nor can a $274,000 salary.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Securing digital trust

Apropos of "Guarding digital trust" (*FE*, October 24), India's growing dependence on digital services makes cybersecurity a matter of public trust, not just a technical issue. Data breaches, weak security systems, and delayed disclosure can expose citizens to financial fraud and identity theft. Government agencies and private firms must take responsibility for protecting the information entrusted to them. Regular security audits, prompt reporting of breaches, stronger data protection standards, and strict penalties for negligence are essential. Organisations should have clear procedures to inform users and help them limit the damage. As digital services expand, security cannot be treated as an afterthought or left to tech providers. Public confidence will depend on how well institutions protect personal data and respond when things go wrong.
—Vinod Johri, New Delhi

Enhance education infrastructure

"Where will young India live?" (*FE*, October 24) must compel governments to expand education infrastructure in tier-II and -III cities from where lakhs of students migrate to metropolitan cities and state capitals for want of classroom, hostel, and overall infrastructure. It excessively burdens students and their families, besides concern for their safety. The Union and state governments are lagging behind implementation of National Education Policy, 2020, and the budgetary allocation is hardly 2%. Education has not grabbed the attention of political parties, although they tend to exploit the angst of youths. Governments should address the expansion of education infrastructure in all cities.
—Vinod Johri, New Delhi

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BrandWagon

MONDAY, OCTOBER 26, 2026

NUMEROLOGY

$ 4.1 tn: Size of global logistics industry in 2025
$ 8.4 tn: Estimated size by 2033
10.1%: Expected CAGR between 2025 and 2033
— Grand View Research

In the right place, at the right time

HOW BRANDS CAN RECOUP THE ₹900 CRORE THEY PLAN TO SPEND ON INFLUENCERS THIS FESTIVE SEASON

KARTIKAY KASHYAP



AT A GLANCE

7,200 brands to activate creators this festive season, up 20% from last year

75% of creator participation came from nano & micro creators last festive season, & the trend is likely to hold this time as well

₹900 crore to be spent by brands on creator-led marketing this festive season, up 20% from last season

THE NUMBER OF brands looking to activate creators this festive season has risen to 7,200 from about 6,000 last season, according to creator network Qoruz. Industry experts say the number of branded creator content will run into millions.

Why? Because high-Intent shoppers are actively scouting for outfit inspiration, gift ideas and product reviews across categories like fashion, home decor and electronic items. And according to Kantar, influencer content holds viewer attention 2.2 times longer and skip it far less than traditional digital ads.

But that's half the story.

The overload of creator-led content means brands have quite a few hurdles to clear — including audience fatigue, loss of authenticity and difficulties with measurement — before they are heard.

There's a lot at stake for brands. Datum Intelligence estimates that consumers will spend about ₹1.50-1.55 lakh crore during the festive sale window of 2026. For many brands, the festive season turns in almost 30% of their annual revenue.

In such a scenario, it might be a good idea to junk the old playbook. "Every festive season, audiences see a familiar pattern of product launches, unboxing videos, discount-led reels and brand integrations. When too many campaigns follow the same playbook, even a well-funded campaign risks becoming just another piece of sponsored content," warns Vibhor Gulati, founder, Defodio Digital.

So what's the best way to stand out in the crowd and cut through the noise?

Way to go

Advertisers are relying heavily on nano (1,000-10,000 followers) and micro-influencers to gain high engagement, localised trust and volume at a low cost. The reason isn't far to seek. Around 60% of new online shoppers and sales come from smaller towns, where regional creators hold deep cultural resonance and drive local commerce. This category of influencers is expected to make up 75% of festive activations, compared with 5% for mega creators and A-listers.

Manoj Kumar, founder, Brandsadvert Media, says the firm's ongoing campaigns in the consumer tech and two-wheeler EV categories confirm this trend. "These creators understand their local audience better and can communicate in the language and dialect people use in their everyday lives," he says. For consumers in these markets, that local connect can make all the difference.

Gulati has a word of caution: A random small creator cannot compensate for a weak idea merely because his/her audience is niche. "The greater opportunity lies in giving creators different storytelling roles within the same campaign," he says. "One creator might make a product relevant through humour, another through practical demonstrations, and the next through regional or cultural context."

In other words, multi-format storytelling is the way to go. Rather than relying on a single commercial, brands could use creators to run multi-wave campaigns, early-purchase promo codes and last-minute urgency pushes on social platforms like Instagram and YouTube. The one thing to remember though is the generational divide even on social platforms. Older audiences (such as baby boomers) show high scepticism, with a significant chunk reporting that creator content feels annoying.

In any case, consumers — young and old — are smart enough to differentiate between organic content and branded ones. And hard selling cuts no ice with today's buyers. "So start building resonance before the festive window opens rather than treating it as the only window," says Kalyan Kumar, co-founder & CEO, KlugKlug. "Focus on content that reflects everyday behaviour rather than content that looks like it was briefed by a marketing department."

INTERVIEW: AKHIL SHRIVASTAVA, EVP & CFO, THE ESTÉE LAUDER COMPANIES

'It is early days for prestige beauty in India'

*For **Akhil Shrivastava**, executive vice-president and chief financial officer of The Estée Lauder Companies (ELC), India is more than a fast-growing beauty market; it is a long-term strategic opportunity. In this interview to **Viveat Susan Pinto**, Shrivastava discusses how it intends to bring more consumers into prestige beauty, and why disciplined investment will be key to unlocking the market's potential. Excerpts:*



WE WANT THE SCALE & EFFICIENCIES OF A GLOBAL COMPANY WHILE RETAINING THE AGILITY THAT ALLOW US TO RESPOND TO CONSUMERS QUICKLY

What are you doing to bring more Indian consumers into prestige beauty?
First, you have to build awareness. Consumers need to know your brands, understand what they stand for and discover what makes them distinctive. Second, that awareness has to be locally and culturally relevant. Beauty runs in the heartbeat of India.

The key is to tap into this cultural context. Take our recent MAC bridal campaign (Forever in MAC), for example, which reimagines the traditional wedding family portrait. It was shot in Mumbai by MAC's global creative director Nicola Formichetti, with the campaign celebrating individuality and self-expression. The third element is accessibility through our portfolio and price points. These are important ways of helping consumers experience our products for the first time.

Will you expand your portfolio beyond the 14 brands currently in India?
We use consumer insights to understand which products, franchises and experiences are relevant to the Indian market, and we have continued to expand the portfolio over the years. The Ordinary, for example, came to India only a few years ago. There are more brands to come. But I would emphasise that our opportunity is not just about adding brands. We are still scratching the surface of what our existing portfolio can achieve. It is early innings for prestige beauty in India. Every additional household that enters the category represents an opportunity to introduce consumers to a new experience.

How will you improve penetration?
In India, the consumer is increasingly digital, but physical retail remains extremely important in prestige beauty. We need to be present across both. We have strong partnerships with Nykaa, Tira, Shoppers Stop and Sephora, spanning online and offline formats. We have also expanded our presence on Amazon, with The Ordinary and Clinique. And we are entering quick commerce with select brands, having already established a presence on Zepto and moving forward with further opportunities in the channel, with Blinkit, for example. The important point is that we want to expand access without compromising the desirability of our brands. We work closely with our retail partners because their success and ours are interconnected. When these retailers were building their businesses, we brought our expertise and brands to the table. As they have evolved, we have evolved with them.

ELC has also spoken about its partnership with Accenture. What will this mean for the business, particularly in India?
Our enterprise business services partnership with Accenture is part of our broader One ELC strategy, which Stéphane (de La Faverie; president and CEO, ELC) and I have discussed along with our leadership team on several occasions. We are a company with more than 20 brands operating across many countries.

The opportunity is to use our scale to standardise processes, leverage technology and AI, and bring in best-in-class benchmarks. The objective is to free our people up to focus on what matters most to our business: creativity, innovation and brand-building. Alongside Accenture, we are working with Shopify, through which we have transformed the front end of our e-commerce operations. We are working with WPP on media. We want the scale and efficiencies of a global firm while retaining the agility and entrepreneurial spirit that allow us to respond to consumers quickly.

AFTER HOURS **SUNU MATHEW,** FOUNDER & MD, LEAP INDIA

The Job
As the founder of LEAP India, my role has evolved from being involved in almost everything to focusing on strategy, growth and building the right team. I still enjoy meeting customers and staying connected to what happens on the ground.

The Weekdays
Most days begin with a plan but rarely go exactly as planned. Between business reviews, customer meetings and discussions with my team, there's always something happening. I like staying connected to the business rather than relying only on reports. Fitness is also an important part of my routine.

The Weekend
A long drive with good music is one of my favourite ways to unwind. I'm particularly fond of Pancham Da (R.D. Burman) and can listen to his music endlessly. I also enjoy exploring different cuisines, such as Japanese, and trying new restaurants whenever I get the chance. I value spending time with family and friends.

The Toys
I've always been fascinated by technology, especially when it makes everyday life easier. I enjoy experimenting with gadgets and automating things around me, whether at home or at work. I love using my reMarkable for journalling, and I'm currently using WHOOP to track my fitness, sleep and recovery. I'm not necessarily interested in owning every new gadget, but if something is genuinely useful or makes life more efficient, I'm keen to explore it.



The Logos
Having worked with L'Oréal and CHEP, I've seen how strong brands are built in very different industries. I admire L'Oréal for its understanding of consumers and CHEP for turning a simple concept into a powerful global business. I also find brands like WHOOP interesting for how they integrate technology into everyday life. For me, a great brand isn't just about visibility or advertising. It's about knowing what you stand for and consistently delivering on that promise.

Motobahn

CAR REVIEW: TESLA MODEL Y L PREMIUM

Starlink waits, but a Tesla goes to rural India

PRICED WELL, SUPER-EFFICIENT, OVER 500 KM REAL-WORLD RANGE, BUT NOT A CAR TO DRIVE EVERYWHERE

VIKRAM CHAUDHARY

















While its cabin doesn't have the opulence of a Mercedes-Benz, it is tech-loaded, and Grok AI handles voice commands for most cabin settings



WHEN I FIRST test-drove the Tesla Model Y Premium, it felt like a futuristic smartphone on wheels — hyper-minimalist, and powered by Grok AI. Returning behind the wheel of the six-seater Model Y L Premium, I set off on a longer intercity trek from Gurgaon to Neemrana Fort Kesroli near Alwar.

The traffic test
In Gurgaon, thanks to its styling, most people pulled out phones to take photos. But with people, vehicles, and stray dogs coming close, its proximity sensor alerts rang almost non-stop.

On the Delhi-Mumbai Expressway, it truly shined, with its explosive acceleration, and high-speed stability.

Cabin comfort
The cabin shows limitations under harsh Indian sun. Taking a work break at an expressway rest area, I sat in the middle-row captain seats. While comfortable, the lack of sunshades meant sunlight flooded the cabin, forcing me to maximise laptop screen brightness.

In the third row, I found legroom tight. While headroom was good, the sloping panoramic glass roof directly above my head meant a lot of glare.

Navigating rural India
As I got near the Kesroli village, its low ground clearance and stiff suspension struggled with potholes. Crawling over speed bumps, the underbody scraped a few, accompanied by loud thuds. Driving through villages kicking up dust, I realised this Tesla isn't for every corner of India.

But superb value
Tesla India has nailed it when it comes to packaging and pricing. Starting at ₹61.99 lakh, the Model Y L Premium offers genuine value as a six-seater car. Packaging is stellar: it easily takes six midsize suitcases while carrying four adults and two children, complemented by a segment-leading front trunk (frunk) large enough for a suitcase. At 100% charge, my test car showed more than 550 km of real-world range, removing range anxiety.

While it doesn't have the opulence of a Mercedes-Benz, BMW, or Audi, it is tech-loaded. Grok AI handles voice commands for cabin settings, and you don't have to fiddle with the screen.

In the luxury EV bracket, rivals are the BMW iX1 LWD (₹54.7 lakh), which lacks a six-seat option, and Mercedes-Benz CLA Electric (₹56.5 lakh), which feels cramped. Mass-market three-row alternatives are the Mahindra XEV 9S (₹20.65-30.9 lakh), BYD eMax 7 (₹27.9-29.9 lakh), Kia Carens Clavis EV (₹18.5-25 lakh), and MG Hector Tomahawk EV (₹19.5-23.5 lakh). Yet for buyers wanting brand pull, 500-plus km range, and Grok AI integration, Tesla's latest offering hits a sweet spot for urban and highway driving.



Skoda eyes record sales by riding on Kylaq

VIKRAM CHAUDHARY

BUILDING ON A historic baseline in 2025 — when sales surged 107% year-on-year to 72,665 units — Skoda Auto India is looking at highest-ever volume growth in 2026, targeting at least an 8% increase over last year, driven by an aggressive product and pricing strategy.

In an exclusive interaction, Skoda Auto India's brand director Ashish Gupta said the sub-4-metre Kylaq SUV has crossed close to 75,000 sales since launch. Significantly, 40-45% of Kylaq buyers are first-time car buyers.

Addressing concerns regarding internal cannibalisation, Gupta dismissed claims that the Kylaq and the Kushaq midsize SUV are at cross-purposes. He noted that the Kylaq is priced from ₹7.59 lakh to ₹13.09 lakh, and the Kushaq from ₹10.69 lakh to ₹19.19 lakh. Even the new Kylaq Sportline variant (₹12.35 lakh) has avoided eating into Kushaq's volumes.

Also, in the Kushaq and Slavia, 1.0-litre engine contributes 60-65% of sales, while the 1.5-litre accounts for 30-35%. Meanwhile, automatic adoption stands at 70% for both the Kushaq and Slavia, and above 50% for the Kylaq. Gupta emphasised that offering a turbo engine paired with a six-speed torque converter is a deliberate strategy to provide a 'real automatic' in the entry segment.

eFE
MONDAY, OCTOBER 26, 2026



PROGRESS WITH PURPOSE
Demis Hassabis, co-founder, Google DeepMind

Advanced AI offers great potential for scientific discovery and human progress, but its risks require careful mitigation

Tech support for family office

DIVERSE INVESTMENTS MAKE WEALTH MANAGEMENT MORE CHALLENGING

SUDHIR CHOWDHARY



KEEPING TRACK

- Fragmented financial records remain a challenge as wealth and portfolios expand
- Family offices are adopting AI to streamline investment research, monitoring and reporting
- Assets under management are set to grow 1.5 times from their 2024 level of ₹70,000 crore
- Human judgment remains essential despite AI's growing role in wealth management

SUNIL K DALAL, FOUNDER & CHAIRMAN, UNIDEL GROUP

AI readiness begins with **consolidated, structured and updated financial data**



KC GANESH, PRESIDENT, PRAYOG ADVISORS

We are using AI agents for **research, deal evaluation, monitoring and reporting**



ANIMESH RAIZADA, MD AND COO, SPARK CAPITAL PWM

A clear view of wealth helps **families plan succession, manage risk and allocate assets**



INDIA'S FAMILY OFFICES are growing larger and more complex, with investments spread across asset classes, entities and geographies. As wealth expands, so does the challenge of maintaining accurate financial records and getting a real-time view of portfolios, risks and performance. For a growing number of family offices, artificial intelligence (AI) is emerging as part of the answer.

At Prayog Advisors, the family office of Infosys co-founder Kris Gopalakrishnan and his family, AI is being used across the investment workflow, from deal evaluation and research to document review, portfolio monitoring and investment committee dashboards. The idea is to move away from manually maintaining notes and working across spreadsheets and documents to workflows that can organise and retrieve information efficiently.

"We are using AI agents across the investment workflow," says KC Ganesh, president of Prayog Advisors. The immediate priority is to develop a reliable, automated quarterly view across investments and entities. But Ganesh says technology has its limits. When reading annual reports or management transcripts, what is left unsaid can be as important as the facts and commentary on the page. Such nuances still require human judgment.

The problem of fragmented financial data has long challenged family offices. Sunil K Dalal, founder and chairman of UNIDEL Group, encountered it at his family office, RM Capital, during the 2008 global financial crisis. Financial information was scattered across Excel spreadsheets, Tally and people's heads. What he needed was an ERP-like system that could bring investments, accounts and financial records together.

Unable to find a suitable solution, Dalal decided to build one himself. That effort led to Asset Vantage, an AI-led wealth technology platform he incubated more than a decade ago. Today, it serves over 400 families across 10 countries, helping them consolidate financial data, manage accounting & track investments.

As more family offices face similar challenges, the need for integrated systems is growing. The EY-Julius Baer report, Indian family office playbook: Now, next and beyond, projects that family office assets under management will grow 1.5 times from ₹70,000 crore in 2024, at a compound annual growth rate of 14% over three years. It highlights the role of technology in improving data accuracy, tracking portfolios and supporting investment decisions as wealth becomes more diversified.

For many families, investments are spread across personal accounts, trusts, Hindu Undivided Families (HUFs), limited liability partnerships and promoter entities. Add private equity, alternative investment funds, real estate and overseas holdings and building a consolidated picture of net worth can become a lengthy exercise.

AI can help with some of the routine work. Dalal says it can extract financial information from documents, classify transactions, reconcile accounts and flag missing or incorrectly recorded entries. With reliable data in place, it can also help answer practical questions: which investment strategy contributed most to returns or risk, and how much cash might become available for fresh investments in the coming quarter?

Technology used to be a back-office cost. Today it is part of governance

But the technology is only as useful as the information it works with. "AI is only as good as the data and context it has access to," Dalal says. Fragmented or inaccurate records can undermine even sophisticated analysis.

Animesh Raizada, managing director and chief operating officer of Spark Capital PWM, has seen how much the process of tracking family wealth has changed. A decade ago, consolidating holdings from spreadsheets and PDF statements could take weeks. By the time the figures were ready, they might already be out of date. Data feeds and API connections with banks, brokers, custodians and fund houses now reduce much of the manual effort. AI-assisted tools can read capital call notices, distribution statements and contract notes, map transactions to the right entity and flag discrepancies. Digital portals and mobile apps also give families access to their net worth, asset allocation and investment performance.

"The biggest shift is in mindset. Technology used to be a back-office cost. Today it is part of governance," says Raizada. A consolidated, auditable view of wealth can help families make better-informed decisions on risk, succession and allocation across generations.

There are still gaps. Private equity, alternative investment funds and private credit often provide information in inconsistent formats, while valuations can arrive with a delay. Real estate and unlisted businesses may sit outside formal reporting systems. Overseas holdings bring additional complications involving currencies, tax rules and regulatory requirements.

Raizada expects AI to help identify concentration risks, anticipate liquidity shortfalls around capital calls and flag deviations from a family's investment policy. It could also help families assess scenarios, such as how selling a business might affect future liquidity, and preserve records as wealth passes to the next generation.

For family offices, the immediate task is to get their financial data in order. AI can make that information easier to access and analyse, freeing advisers to spend less time assembling reports and more time helping families make decisions. How wealth should be invested, preserved and passed on, however, will continue to require human judgment.

Change is the only constant



UMA GANESH

INDIA PRODUCES OVER 1.5 million engineering graduates every year, while the number of engineering colleges nearly tripled between 2012-13 and 2023-24. Yet, approved intake in engineering programmes has declined by 25% over the past eight years, according to an AICTE report published in August 2026. In contrast, intake in higher education has grown by 49%.

For over a decade, parents, students and colleges have responded to strong employer demand for computer science talent. Many colleges, including some IITs, reduced seats in core engineering disciplines while expanding computer science programmes. Some even discontinued mechatronics and textile engineering to make room for computer science.

However, the employment landscape is changing. Entry-level salaries have stagnated, while hiring of freshers by IT firms has declined by 25%. The traditional pyramid-shaped workforce, built on fresh graduates performing coding, testing and maintenance tasks, is giving way to a diamond-shaped structure. Firms are reducing fresher recruitment and supervisory layers while adding experienced AI-skilled professionals to middle ranks. Despite these shifts, students and parents continue to favour computer science, drawn by its past job prospects and salary growth. This risks creating a mismatch between skills and available jobs.

Meanwhile, India is investing in semiconductor fabrication, defence manufacturing, renewable energy and EVs. These sectors need engineers specialising in electrical, mechanical and chemical engineering, materials science and metallurgy. Computer science and AI skills remain relevant, but strong foundations in core engineering are equally important.



Many colleges with weak academic capabilities are repackaging existing computer science courses as AI-focused programmes, misleading parents into believing that a new course title guarantees better career prospects. AICTE has advocated a hybrid approach combining core engineering with computing, but adoption remains uneven.

Approval for additional student intake should not rest on perceived demand alone. It should also reflect the placement opportunities colleges create each year. This would help parents make informed choices. Engineering graduate unemployment remains a serious concern. Many students pay substantial tuition fees and clear competitive selection processes, yet struggle to find suitable jobs.

Parents and students also need greater awareness of changing job patterns. Career choices should reflect industry demand, institutional quality and individual aptitude, rather than the popularity of a discipline.

Closer partnerships between academic institutions and semiconductor and defence industries can align curricula with workplace needs. These should include internships, practical training and clearer career pathways. Hindustan Aeronautics' tie-up with IIT Madras for an MTech programme, and arrangements giving some IT services firms the first right of refusal to offer jobs to students at partner colleges, offer useful models.

India will need a large pool of engineers. The priority must be to produce graduates with relevant skills, strong technical foundations and practical experience. Expanding capacity without addressing employability will only deepen the gap between education and industry.

The writer is chairperson, GTT Foundation

GADGETS

Features that fit the budget

TWO 5G PHONES, EACH WITH ITS OWN STRENGTHS

SUDHIR CHOWDHARY

CHOOSING A BUDGET smartphone means deciding which features matter most. The Lava Virat Curve emphasises display quality and design, while the Mivi One focuses on practical features for everyday use. Both offer 5G connectivity and large batteries but cater to different priorities. The Virat Curve features a 6.67-inch 3D curved AMOLED display, delivering rich colours, deeper blacks and better contrast than a conventional LCD panel. Its 120Hz refresh rate makes scrolling and navigation smoother.

MIVI ONE: ₹15,999



A MediaTek Dimensity 7100 processor, paired with 6GB RAM and 128GB storage, handles browsing, messaging and video streaming. The 50MP rear camera and 13MP front camera cover routine photography and video calls. A 6,000mAh battery, supported by 45W fast charging, promises extended usage and quicker top-ups.

Priced at ₹15,999, the Mivi One takes a functional approach. Its 6.75-inch HD+ LCD display provides ample screen space for browsing and watching videos. The Qualcomm Snapdragon 4 Gen 2 processor, along with 6GB RAM and 128GB storage, caters to routine smartphone use.

The 50MP rear camera handles photography, while the 8MP front camera supports selfies. ClearTalk noise-reduction technology improves voice clarity. Flip-to-silent mutes incoming calls when the phone is placed face down, while a camera-flash alert adds visual notifications. Its 6,000mAh battery and IP64 rating for dust and water splashes boost practicality.

LAVA VIRAT CURVE: ₹23,999

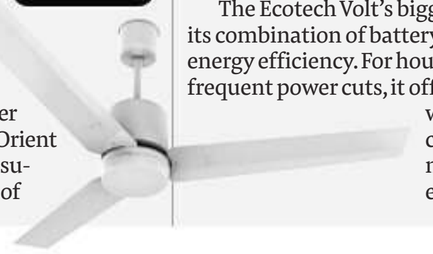


The budget 5G market remains competitive, with Redmi, Poco and Motorola strong alternatives. The Lava Virat Curve appeals to buyers seeking a better display and faster charging, while the Mivi One focuses on essential features at a lower price.

Cooling through the power cuts

A CEILING FAN that runs for upto 10 hours during a power cut, without an inverter, addresses a familiar problem in Indian homes. The Orient Electric Ecotech Volt offers this convenience through its built-in battery backup, useful during summer outages.

ESTIMATED PRICE: ₹6,799



The fan also promises lower electricity consumption. Its brushless direct current (BLDC) motor uses less power than conventional motors. Orient claims up to 50% lower consumption and annual savings of ₹7,000, though actual savings depend on usage and electricity tariffs.

A radio-frequency remote adds convenience, allowing users to adjust speeds, activate boost mode and set timers for two, four, six or eight hours. Its 350 RPM motor and air delivery of 230 cubic metres per minute promise strong airflow.

The Ecotech Volt's biggest advantage is its combination of battery backup and energy efficiency. For households facing frequent power cuts, it offers a practical way to maintain comfort while managing electricity bills.

WORLD VIEW

China's open AI strategy comes with a catch

CATHERINE THORBECKE



Beijing isn't shutting off the outflow of its AI right now

CHINA SPENT THE better part of two years getting the world hooked on its cheap, open AI models. Now, a surprise proposal for new export controls is stirring anxiety that Beijing may pull the plug on these tools that so many have come to depend on. The stakes could be enormous for the Chinese AI industry, and even more devastating for global startups and research institutions that have turned to its offerings as an alternative to Silicon Valley. China's open-weight models allow developers to download and customise them.

But there's little reason to panic - yet. There remains a near-religious devotion to open AI development from loud voices inside the country's tech industry. The current draft rules have plenty of carve outs. Technology in the public domain isn't affected and future open-weight releases would be eligible for automatic approvals, the government has said. The near-term impact on Chinese LLMs, open-source development and overseas commercialisation may be limited, says Morgan Stanley analysts.

OPEN MODELS MAKE AI CHEAPER TO INTEGRATE ACROSS THE ECONOMY

Still, the proposal should serve as a warning: Beijing isn't shutting off the outflow of its AI right now, but is making clear that it can. Many interpret the policy as an attempt to thread the needle between safety and openness, a valid concern as the technology becomes more powerful.

Alibaba's Qwen models have become the default foundation for global developers, as per Hugging Face. More than 150,000 derivatives have been built from Qwen, five times more than Meta's Llama. China boasts seven of top 12 models on Artificial Analysis' measure of intelligence for open systems. Inside the country's tech sector, support for open AI is often cloaked in philosophical language. It's seen as a way to keep the most consequential technology of our time from being controlled by just a few elite firms, unlike US tech giants that keep their systems closed. Yet for Chinese companies seeking an ever-elusive path to profitability, this was always a risky route. Whether AI will ever recoup the sky-high spending needed for development is a global conundrum, but peer pressure to give your tech away makes the calculus trickier. Chinese LLM makers are expected to remain deeply unprofitable in the near term.

The trade-off is that open models attract users and can help propel the entire industry forward. The US must invest in its own open-weight ecosystem. Open models can make AI cheaper to integrate across the economy. Perhaps the biggest lesson for US is that pointing at a race with China as an excuse for risky acceleration and light-touch regulation rings hollower than ever. Beijing still wants the world hooked on its AI, and wants to set the rules. The deeper that global dependence grows, the more it gets to do both.

—BLOOMBERG

SpaceX taps partners to expand Grok

SPACEX IS WORKING with Apollo Global Management, Nvidia and dozens of other firms on a new partnership programme to deploy and improve its Grok AI systems, to bolster business adoption of its AI offerings. More than 130 firms gained early access to the Super Intelligence Partner Network, SpaceX said, including tech firms like Snowflake and Databricks as well as consultancies such as Bain, and Booz Allen Hamilton.

Elon Musk's space, satellite communications and AI conglomerate—long viewed as far behind rivals OpenAI and Anthropic— surprised Wall Street by reporting a profit in its AI unit in the most recent quarter. Those results were mainly tied to the computing deals SpaceX has struck for its data centres in Memphis. But executives, including Musk, said that the adoption of Grok products—including its Grok Bot agent—has been on the rise. Grok Bot had more than 800,000 paid weekly users as of October, doubling from the prior month.

—BLOOMBERG



TECH BYTES



Google adds tools for MSMEs

GOOGLE HAS INTRODUCED a business hub in its Gemini app to help small businesses manage daily operations, analyse finances and create marketing content. The hub connects Gemini with Google services and apps such as Shopify, Canva, Zoho, Dropbox & Xero.

AI steps into produce sorting

AGROGRADE HAS DEPLOYED an AI-powered optical sorter for arecanut at Vikas Traders in Mangalore, Karnataka. The system uses computer vision to identify defects and separate rejected nuts, processing up to one tonne an hour. The company says, sorting accuracy has risen from 75% in initial trials to 89% with updates to its AI models.

Giving voice tech a multilingual push

US-BASED Girikon.AI, which has a development centre in Noida, has developed Koyal, a voice AI model designed for natural conversations across languages. It focuses on pronunciation, tone and conversational context, giving businesses more flexibility to build voice-based applications for customer service and support.

KERALA, MAHARASHTRA EXPLORE BATTERY STORAGE

Grid challenges mount as rooftop solar expands

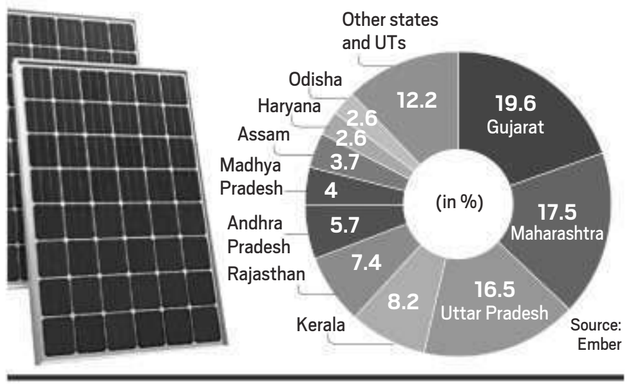
SAURAV ANAND
New Delhi, October 25

GROWING ROOFTOP SOLAR INSTALLATIONS are raising fresh challenges for electricity grid management, prompting Kerala and Maharashtra to explore battery storage systems, while Uttar Pradesh has issued a tender for similar installations on government buildings to help manage the gap between daytime solar generation and evening power demand.

The Central Electricity Authority (CEA) had also suggested that power distribution companies (discoms) could make two hours of battery storage mandatory alongside rooftop solar installations.

The challenge is that households with solar panels often generate more electricity than they need during the day and send the surplus to the grid. However, after sunset, when electricity demand rises and solar generation stops, these households again depend on power supplied by discoms. As installations increase, this gap becomes harder for the grid to manage.

The study identified Kerala, Gujarat and Maharashtra among the states more likely to face grid-balancing challenges as rooftop solar capacity increases.



Kerala's installed rooftop solar capacity reached 2.3 gigawatts (GW) in July 2026, equivalent to 35% of the state's highest recorded evening electricity demand of 6.48 GW during April-July. The corresponding share stood at 26% in Gujarat and 18% in Maharashtra, compared with the national average of 11%.

While these installations significantly reduce electricity drawn from the grid during the day, they cannot directly meet evening demand without storage, the report noted.

According to a report by energy think tank Ember, batteries could help households store unused solar electricity during the day and use it after sunset, reducing their dependence on the grid during evening hours. Adding a 5-kilowatt-hour battery to a typical 3-kW rooftop solar system could cut daytime electricity exports to the grid by 85-90%, shifting around 1,600-1,800 units annually towards evening consumption.

"India's rooftop solar boom is an opportunity to get ahead of the grid challenge, rather than wait for it to arrive. With more than 5 million households already adopting rooftop solar under PM Surya Ghar, we should be building storage alongside that capacity, not years later," said Ruchita Shah, energy analyst, Asia, at Ember.

Uttar Pradesh has emerged as the third-largest contributor to residential rooftop solar capacity under PM Surya Ghar, accounting for 16.5% of installations, behind Gujarat at 19.6% and Maharashtra at 17.5%. The study also found that households account for more than half of total rooftop solar capacity in Uttar Pradesh, Kerala and Andhra Pradesh. Nearly 88% of residential capacity installed under the scheme is concentrated in just 10 states.

India's rooftop solar capacity reached 30.7 GW by July 2026, accounting for 19% of the country's total installed solar capacity of 164.6 GW. Residential installations under PM Surya Ghar stood at 14.9 GW across five million households.

"The experience of markets like Australia and the US shows that as rooftop solar scales, its value increasingly depends on when its electricity is used, not just how much it generates," Shah said.

Agri laggard districts make headway under converged schemes

SANDIP DAS
New Delhi, October 25

SEVERAL DISTRICTS LAGGING in farm productivity, including Gadchiroli (Maharashtra), Dantewada (Chhattisgarh), Alluri Sitharaman Raju (Andhra Pradesh), and Banka (Bihar), have shown significant progress in expanding irrigation and crop diversification.

It has happened through the production of high-value horticultural crops and revival of agricultural land through the adoption of natural farming practices under the Prime Minister Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana (PMDDKY), according to government officials.

Naxal-affected Gadchiroli receives annual rainfall in the range of 1,200-1,400 millimetres, but due to hard rock terrain, much of the rainfall runs off without natural retention. "Due to a lack of water retention, farmers used to grow only Kharif paddy and millets, while rabi seasons remained fallow," Avishyanth Panda, collector of Gadchiroli, said at a review meeting for the central scheme.

Panda said that by pooling resources from eight central and state schemes across the departments of agriculture,



minor irrigation, water conservation, forest and mining, and irrigation, over 3,100 farm ponds, recharge shafts, and farm bunding works through bamboo plantation were completed in the last year.

This, according to the official, has led to improvement in post-harvest storage capacities and farmers adopting crop diversification to maize, ragi, vegetables and spices like turmeric.

The DDKY targets 100 aspirational agricultural districts and launched in July 2025 with a budget of ₹24,000 crore drawn from the convergence of 36 existing central sector schemes across 11 ministries along with state schemes. The private sector's CSR fund is also being used.

FROM THE FRONT PAGE

SP Group seeks fair value for its Tata Sons holding



SP Group's borrowing has made monetising part of its Tata Sons holding a pressing issue. Its total debt is estimated at ₹55,000-60,000 crore. The group has undertaken several transactions to ease the burden, including the sale of its stake in Odisha's Gopalpur port and the public offering of infrastructure subsidiary Afcons.

In July, SP Group completed a ₹21,500-crore refinancing exercise. It subsequently repaid about ₹3,500 crore to bondholders after a majority of existing lenders agreed to extend fresh financing. The arrangements helped the Mistry family meet a significant September repayment obligation and avoid a potential default.

There are no repayment deadlines in October or November, one of the people said, providing some near-term breathing room as discussions over the Tata Sons stake continue.

A buyback could offer SP Group liquidity without requiring an immediate listing of Tata Sons. A listing, meanwhile, could establish a market-based valuation and potentially provide another route to monetisation. Both options would require agreement on terms and the necessary corporate and regulatory approvals.

For now, the Mistry family's position is that it wants a timely, commercially acceptable outcome, irrespective of how the wider governance disagreement.

IndiGo, AI to shift flights...



Air India Express, meanwhile, plans to start with four daily domestic flights from Navi Mumbai in December, followed by existing services to Oman and planned flights to Kuwait from January 2027. The Kuwait transition is subject to regulatory approvals. The Air India group will subsequently move services to Jeddah, Riyadh, Dammam, Doha, Muscat and Sharjah, with the process expected to be completed by the Northern Summer 2027 aviation schedule.

The airline group said operating from both airports would allow it to preserve the historical nature of its existing slots at Mumbai airport while continuing to serve the market. It also expects the arrangement to offer passengers greater choice and convenience.

The shift marks a step towards establishing Navi Mumbai as a second aviation hub for the region, as the existing airport faces constraints on expansion. The redistribution is expected to give airlines greater clarity on capacity allocation and help minimise operational disruption during the transition.

The move follows consultations between the airlines and the airport operator on how to accommodate traffic as Terminal 1 undergoes redevelopment. Rather than a wholesale relocation, the plan involves transferring selected services in phases, with both airports continuing to handle airline operations

Average balance in PMJDY accounts hits record ₹5,438

FE BUREAU
New Delhi, October 25

THE AVERAGE BALANCE in no-frills bank accounts under the Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY) has hit a new high of ₹5,438 after fresh accretion of around ₹7,000 crore in less than two months.

These accounts now hold cumulative deposits of around ₹3.24 lakh crore as of October 14, up from ₹3.17 lakh crore on August 19, 2026. As a result, the average balance rose from ₹5,356 to a new record of ₹5,438. The average deposit has risen consistently — from ₹3,449 in March 2021.

The number of PMJDY accounts has also grown, reaching 595.9 million, up from 590.9 million about two months back.

Public sector banks continue to dominate the scheme, accounting for nearly 77% of beneficiaries and deposits.

Public sector banks had 458.4 million beneficiaries and deposits of ₹2.52 lakh crore. Regional rural banks (RRBs) accounted for another 111.8 million beneficiaries, with deposits of ₹61,311 crore. Private sector banks had 23.8 million beneficiaries and deposits of ₹10,265 crore, while rural cooperative banks accounted for 1.9 million beneficiaries.



The distribution of accounts underscores the importance of rural banking infrastructure in expanding access to formal financial services. Of the total beneficiaries, 462.7 million were associated with rural and semi-urban bank branches, compared with 133.2 million at urban and metropolitan branches. Rural and semi-urban beneficiaries thus accounted for around 78% of the total, reflecting the scheme's focus on extending banking access beyond major urban centres.

Women accounted for 332.3 million beneficiaries, or nearly 56% of the total. This points to the scheme's role in expanding women's access to formal banking and strengthening their participation in the financial system.

Banks had issued 417.9 million RuPay debit cards to beneficiaries, equivalent to around 70% of the total beneficiary base. The gap between beneficiary numbers and cards issued indicates scope to deepen the use of digital payment facilities and formal banking services.

The trinity of Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and mobile (JAM) has played a key role in enabling large-scale, technology-driven, real-time direct benefit transfers (DBTs), especially during the Covid-19 pandemic. Between FY15 and FY24, direct benefit transfers have generated cumulative savings of nearly ₹5.14 lakh crore.

PMJDY accounts require no minimum balance and offer interest on deposits, making them both accessible and appealing for low-income households.

These accounts are eligible for direct benefit transfer (DBT), Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana, Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana, Atal Pension Yojana, and Micro Units Development & Refinance Agency Bank (MUDRA) scheme.

3P LAND HOLDINGS LIMITED

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Statement of Standalone and Consolidated unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter and Half Year ended September 30, 2026

(₹ In lakhs unless stated otherwise)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Standalone Results						Consolidated Results					
		Quarter ended			Half Year Ended		Year ended	Quarter ended			Half Year Ended		Year ended
		30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	30.06.2026 (Unaudited)	30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)	30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	30.06.2026 (Unaudited)	30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)
1	Total Income from Operations	187	105	178	292	269	467	187	105	178	292	269	467
2	Profit/(loss) before exceptional item share of profit/(Loss) of Associate and tax	141	62	133	203	182	291	141	62	133	203	182	291
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after exceptional item, share of profit/(Loss) of Associate but before tax	141	62	133	203	182	291	141	62	133	203	182	291
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax	106	46	99	152	136	218	106	46	99	152	136	218
5	Other Comprehensive Income (net of tax)	1,663	2,215	325	3,878	2,639	(3,723)	1,663	2,215	325	3,878	2,639	(3,723)
6	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	1,769	2,261	424	4,030	2,775	(3,505)	1,769	2,261	424	4,030	2,775	(3,505)
7	Equity Share Capital (face value ₹.2/-per share)	360	360	360	360	360	360	360	360	360	360	360	360
8	Other equity (excluding revaluation reserve)						4,469						4,307
9	Earnings per share (of ₹.2/-each) Basic & Diluted.(₹.)	0.59	0.26	0.55	0.84	0.76	1.21	0.59	0.26	0.55	0.84	0.76	1.21

Notes:

1) The above results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at its meeting held on October 24, 2026.
2) The Limited Review under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulation, 2015 has been carried out by Statutory Auditor.
3) This statement has been prepared in accordance with the Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules, 2015 (as amended), prescribed under Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 (IndAS) and other recognised accounting practices and policies to the extent applicable.
4) The above is an extract of the detailed format of Financial Results for the Quarter and Half year ended 30th September, 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of SEBI (Listing Obligations And Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of these Financial Results is available on Stock Exchange website (www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com) and Company's website (www.3pland.com).
5) The consolidated financial results of 3P Land Holdings Limited, includes financial results of an Associate company - Biodegradable Products India Limited, accounted as per equity method as per Ind AS 28.
6) The financial results of M/s. Prime Mall Developers, which is an associate Firm of Biodegradable Products India Limited are not available till the signing of these result/Statement. Accordingly, the consolidated financial results of the Associate Company Biodegradable Products India Limited, as considered in the consolidated financial results of 3P Land Holdings Limited does not include the financial result of the associate Firm. On such omission, Management estimates no material impact in the consolidated financial results of 3P Land Holdings Limited.
7) Effective 1 April 2026, the Company adopted the amendments to Ind AS 109 regarding the derecognition of financial assets and financial liabilities. The Company applied the transition provisions without restating comparative periods, as permitted under Ind AS. Having regard to materiality, no adjustments were made to the opening cash and cash equivalents as of 1 April 2026. Accordingly, these settlements have not been re-presented again as cash flows in the current period's presentation.
8) Previous periods amounts have been regrouped wherever considered nesessary to conform to current period's presentation.

Place : Pune
Date : 24th October, 2026

On behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Gautam N.Jajodia
Chairman & Executive Director
DIN : 00064611

CESC LIMITED

CIN:L31901WB1978PLC031411

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

CESC Limited, Kolkata invites tenders for their requirement of 1-phase & 3-phase whole current meters and 33KV GIS panels.

Detailed terms & conditions of the NIT are available at 'Live Tenders/EOI' section under 'Vendors' of the official CESC website https://www.cesc.co.in

CENTURY EXTRUSIONS LIMITED

CIN: L27203WB1988PLC043705
Regd Office: 113, Park Street, 'N' Block, 2nd Floor, Kolkata - 700016
Website: www.centuryextrusions.com
E-mail: secretary@centuryextrusions.com

NOTICE OF SPECIAL WINDOW FOR RE-LODGEMENT OF TRANSFER AND DEMATERIALISATION OF PHYSICAL SHARES

Notice is hereby given that SEBI vide its Circular No. SEBI/HO/MIRSD/MIRSD-POD/P/CIR/2025/97 dated July 2, 2025, had earlier opened a special window for re-lodgement of transfer requests of physical shares originally submitted before April 01, 2019 for a period of six months from July 07,2025 till January 06, 2026.

Further with a view to facilitate the investors, SEBI vide its Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-POD/ I/3750/2026 dated 30th January, 2026 has opened another special window for transfer and dematerialisation ("demat") of physical shares which were sold/purchased prior to April 01, 2019. This special window shall remain open for a period of one year i.e. from February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027.

The said facility is also available for such transfer requests which were submitted earlier and were rejected/returned/not attended due to deficiency in the documents /process/ or otherwise.

During the period, eligible shareholders may re-lodge their earlier requests with the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent (RTA), **M/s. MUFG Intime India Private Limited, Operational Address:** Rasoi Court, 5th Floor,20, Sir R N Mukherjee Road, Kolkata - 700001, West Bengal, India, along with required documents rectifying the deficiencies, if any.

The detailed circular is also available on the website of the Company at www.centuryextrusions.com

For Century Extrusions Limited
Rajan Singh
Company Secretary
Membership No. : A35350

Date: October 25, 2026
Place: Kolkata

GOVERNMENT OF HIMACHAL PRADESH

Department of Revenue

Himachal Pradesh Disaster Risk Reduction & Preparedness (HPDRRP) Program, Program Management Unit (PMU) Shanti Niwas, Phase3, Kangnadhar, Shimla – 171009
e-mail: hpdrrp-afd@hp.gov.in

NOTICE INVITING REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS (RFP)

The Himachal Pradesh State Disaster Management Authority (HPSDMA), under the HPDRRP Program assisted by the Agence Française de Développement (AFD), invites online proposals on the hp e-tender Portal for: Empanelment of Companies/Firms/Agencies for International / National / Domestic Exposure Visits, PeertoPeer Knowledge Exchange Programmes and Associated Travel Logistics.

RFP Ref. No.: Rev (DMC)(F)1150/2023DRRP(AFDIII) Exposure Visit/Workshops

Method of Selection: QCBS as per HP Financial Rules, 2009 (amended)
RFP Document: Available at https://hptenders.gov.in
Submission Deadline: 18.11.2026 up to 2:00 PM
Opening of Proposals: As per schedule in RFP

Note: Interested bidders are advised to visit the etender portal regularly for updates, corrigenda, or amendments. The Undersigned reserves the right to accept or reject any or all proposals without assigning any reason thereof.

Sd/-
Nishant Thakur
Program Director
HPDRRP Program

No.1171/HP

International

MONDAY, OCTOBER 26, 2026

Machado returns to Venezuela

BLOOMBERG
OCTOBER 25

VENEZUELAN OPPOSITION LEADER María Corina Machado returned to Caracas in a surprise move that could pose the biggest test yet to acting President Delcy Rodríguez's political opening and the Trump administration's strategy for post-Maduro Venezuela.

"I'm here, with you," Machado posted on X on Sunday, confirming her return after months abroad.

She gave no details on how she entered Venezuela or her whereabouts.

Machado also thanked President Donald Trump and Secretary of State Marco Rubio for their support, signaling an effort to underscore her ties with Washington even as her return risks complicating the administration's Venezuela strategy.

Trump, speaking to reporters as he left the White House, said he didn't know about Machado's return.

KYIV REJECTS CLAIM ITS MILITARY BREACHED STARLINK TERMS

Ukraine misused Starlink to kill people, says Musk

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, October 25

UKRAINIAN OFFICIALS HAVE disputed claims by SpaceX CEO Elon Musk that the country's military violated Starlink's terms of service by using the civilian satellite internet network for offensive drone strikes.

Serhii Beskrestnov, a defence technology adviser to President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, said long-standing restrictions on the civilian system in Ukraine made such offensive use impossible.

"It's very strange that Elon Musk doesn't know about the restrictions on Starlink's operation in Ukraine," he wrote in an online post.

SpaceX's Starlink and its military-focused Starshield service are critical to Ukraine's wartime connectivity. Earlier this month, Ukrainian drones connected to Starshield lost connectivity at high speeds, disrupting air defenses during daily Russian air attacks. Officials said the so-called speed caps were lifted on Saturday, and the service was restored.

Still, questions have persisted about who ordered the interruptions to satellite internet system that Kyiv has relied on for years to counter Moscow's attacks.

Musk acknowledged on Saturday that SpaceX had throttled Starlink in Ukraine. "Using Starlink, a civilian commercial service, for offensive drone strikes to kill people has never been allowed, nor should it be," Musk wrote.

"Ukraine military violated Starlink terms of service and used it for offensive drone strikes to kill people.

"That loophole was closed last week." But he maintained that the US government controlled whatever changes happened with Starshield, the military-grade version of Starlink that is the backbone of Ukraine's drone operations and communication.

US President Donald Trump has maintained that he didn't make that call, while Vice President JD Vance has hinted at White House coordination with Musk.

Restrictions imposed last week on Starshield alarmed the Ukrainian military and government officials, with commanders reporting lost drones and disrupted missions.

They also added to tensions between Kyiv and Washington, a relationship already strained by Trump's reported deal with Moscow to import diesel from Russia that Ukraine viewed as a betrayal.

The restoration of Starlink service followed a new US diplomatic push to end the war.

DRONE WARFARE

- Musk acknowledged SpaceX had throttled Starlink in Ukraine
- Starlink, Starshield critical to Ukraine's wartime communications, drone ops
- Curbs on Starshield disrupted drone missions and air defence ops



ELON MUSK, SPACE X CEO

"Using Starlink for offensive drone strikes to kill people has never been allowed

Riyadh airport reopens

BLOOMBERG
October 25

RIYADH'S MAIN AIRPORT reopened to global air traffic after a two-week shutdown, despite sustained Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia's capital over the weekend.

Dozens of flights departed King Khalid International Airport early on Sunday to destinations including London, Dubai and Beijing, according to the airport's website.

Local carriers Saudia and Flynas operated flights, while international airlines including Air India and Emirates were also on the schedule. Many global carriers still have a suspension in place, meaning air traffic into and out of Riyadh is heavily limited.

The airport, which suspended operations following Houthi attacks on Oct. 10-11 that killed more than a dozen people and injured hundreds, is operating at least two of its five terminals. Terminal 3, which sustained damages in the strikes this month, remains non-operational.

The reopening coincides with a weekend of heavy Houthi strikes on Riyadh. The Saudi-led coalition battling the militant group in Yemen said it intercepted a ballistic missile and drone launched toward the capital on Sunday, while also fighting off a barrage of projectiles in southern areas close to the Yemeni border.

Saudi stocks fell as much as 3.4% on Sunday and are on course for their worst monthly performance since 2022 as investors price in more geopolitical risk.

Dozens of people have been killed this month in attacks on Saudi Arabia by the Houthis, including on an airport in the Eastern Province and oil fields operated by Saudi Aramco. The Houthis continue to claim they're targeting Riyadh's airport, in addition to critical energy infrastructure in the kingdom.

The US ordered the departure of some diplomatic staff from Saudi Arabia as a result of the growing risk and also adjusted staffing at embassies across West Asia.

Trump says decision time nears on Iran: Deal or 'finish it off'

PRESIDENT DONALD TRUMP said it's "getting to be decision time" on whether he will make a deal with Tehran or resume attacks as Iranian and Houthi threats against Americans in West Asia continue to grow. "I have a decision to make: Do I finish it off, which would be very easy to do, or do I make a deal? That's all," Trump said in an interview "We don't play games." vTrump has suggested that US strikes on Iran could resume after the November 3 midterm elections and he has sent additional forces.



Officials warn the period between the poll and the new Congress taking office could be particularly dangerous, with a negotiated deal seen as the most likely way to end the conflict.

BLOOMBERG

FROM THE FRONT PAGE

Cyber risks fuel...



LAST WEEK, STATE Bank of India, the country's largest lender, acknowledged that nearly 375,000 records were available on the dark web. These included 3,897 customer records containing personally identifiable information such as registered mobile numbers, dates of birth, names, gender, email addresses and residential addresses. Bank of Baroda, ICICI Bank and Star Health Insurance have also faced cyber incidents or ransomware threats in recent years.

Demand is extending beyond large organisations to individuals seeking protection against online fraud.

"Even individual customers are now seeking protection from various cyber scams and phishing attacks. We are seeing a shift in customer behaviour, moving from being reactive to being proactive," says Arti Mulik, chief technical officer, Universal Sompo General Insurance.

BFSI, technology, telecom, healthcare and e-commerce are among the biggest buyers of cyber insurance, industry executives say, given their large volumes of customer data and exposure to cyber incidents.

Businesses should assess whether their policies adequately cover losses from ransomware, data breaches, payment-system disruptions, attacks on technology vendors and business email compromise, says Vibhaw Kumar, executive vice-president – financial lines & liability, Anand Rathi Insurance Broking. "Most importantly, organisations should examine policy exclusions, sub-limits, waiting periods, notification requirements and the treatment of social-engineering fraud, system outages and third-party service-provider incidents," he adds.

Cyber insurance limits have risen significantly, with some large banks seeking coverage of $50–100 million or more, depending on their exposure, industry estimates suggest.

Yet the domestic market remains relatively small. Annual cyber insurance premiums are estimated at ₹900–1,100 crore, against a general insurance industry worth more than ₹3 lakh crore.

"Industry experience indicates that the Indian cyber insurance market has been growing at approximately 25–30% annually," Solanki says.

He estimates annual premiums at $65–70 million, reflecting the market's relatively low penetration.

George says India accounts for well under 1% of the global cyber insurance premium pool, estimated at $14–16 billion.

Cancer drug prices can rise...



The NPPA's latest clarifications state that companies revising their MRP under the order can increase prices under the annual hike provision from the date the revised MRP takes effect, provided the revised prices are implemented by November 9. But drugmakers that leave their MRP unchanged become eligible only after 12 months have passed since the last revision.

This does not mean companies will automatically raise prices by 10%. However, future increases could partly offset the initial savings for patients, depending on the price reduction and subsequent revisions. The government has estimated that the price cap on 137 non-scheduled anti-cancer drugs could reduce their MRPs by up to 70%, generating annual savings of around ₹2,500 crore for patients.

An official at a leading pharma association told FE that the scale of trade mark-ups on non-scheduled anti-cancer medicines had prompted the government's intervention. Retailers typically earn a 16% margin on scheduled drugs under the government's pricing formula, compared with a usual 20% on non-scheduled medicines. However, an NPPA analysis in October found that trade mark-ups on non-scheduled anti-cancer medicines averaged around 170%, reaching 700% in some cases. Drugmakers have no fixed prescribed profit margin for either category. Established pharma companies typically report gross margins of 50-80% and operating margins of 15-30%.

Another clarification from the NPPA relates to existing stocks of medicines already supplied to pharmacies and hospitals. In such cases, manufacturers are not required to recall these packs or replace their labels, provided they ensure that retailers charge the revised MRP.

"Recalling, re-labelling or re-stickering on the label of container or pack of stocks released in the market prior to implementation of revised MRP is not mandatory, if manufacturer is able to ensure price compliance at the retailer level," the authority said.

Experts said the move would avoid the cost and logistical challenges of recalling and relabelling existing stocks. However, effective monitoring will be essential to ensure that retailers charge the revised MRP rather than the higher price printed on older packs.

Since the latest cap also covers certain medicines used to treat conditions other than cancer, the NPPA has said the price limit will apply to formulations containing drugs listed in the government order, regardless of their strength, form — such as tablets or injections — or method of administration, potentially extending the benefits of price control to more patients.

The authority has also clarified that companies cannot deduct the value of returned medicines from sales when setting the prices at which stockists and distributors buy medicines. This could prevent companies from lowering their reported sales by accounting for returns, although the impact on stockists' margins and the prices patients pay will depend on how the pricing formula uses these figures.

PM: Must shield banks...

IN HIS SPEECH, the PM also alleged mismanagement of the banking sector by the previous Congress governments. He said the Congress' policies had pushed the banking system to the brink of collapse and led to mounting non-performing assets (NPA).

"Before 2014, a completely different era of 'phone banking' existed. For certain privileged people in Delhi who had connections with the Congress, bank loans worth thousands of crores of rupees were sanctioned over phone calls. While poor and middle-class families required a guarantor just to open a bank account, thousands of crores were available anytime for the wealthy under Congress's phone banking scheme," he said.

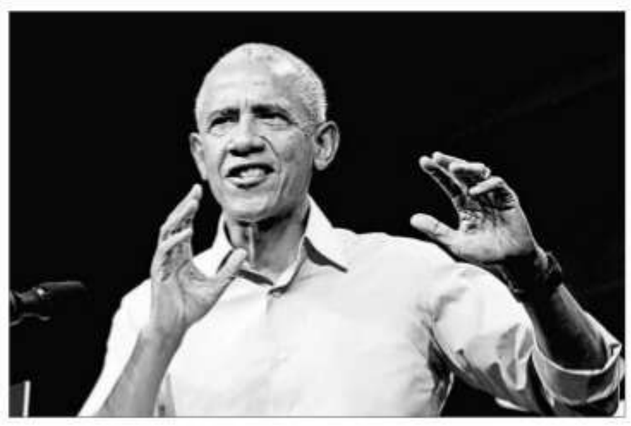
Modi said that while the nationalisation of banks was done in the name of the poor, more than half the country's population remained outside the banking ecosystem until 2014.

"The banking sector was an example of how ordinary families, the poor and middle class, were deprived of basic necessities for decades," he said.

In contrast, he said, his government had brought banking "to every citizen". "Today, India's banking sector stands as one of the strongest banking sectors in the world... Today, through digital banking, every family in the country has become a beneficiary," Modi said.

He said that while debit and credit cards were once limited to the wealthy, they are now accessible to every citizen.

Obama unloads on Trump in midterm elections campaign



REUTERS
October 25

US PRESIDENT DONALD Trump has been telling voters to view the midterm elections as if he were on the ballot, and on Saturday one of his Democratic predecessors did just that.

Ten days out from the elections that will determine control of the closely divided Congress, Barack Obama took to the campaign trail to accuse the Republican president of corruption, deride his strategy for Iran and skewer the gilded aesthetic he has applied to White House renovations.

Obama stumped for Democratic candidates at rallies in Cleveland and Detroit, lampooning the Trump administration. Campaigning in Michigan for US Senate candidate Abdul El-Sayed, Obama framed the November 3 vote as a "circuit breaker" to "at least rein in some of the foolishness" of Trump's presidency.

"We got to flip that circuit breaker, bring some accountability to this government," Obama said.

Obama, president from 2009 until Trump began his first term in 2017, remains one of the most popular ?figures among Democrats. They hope that bringing him into the race can fire up their supporters for a tight US Senate race in which El-Sayed faces Republican Mike Rogers, a former US representative.

The former president obliged the Michigan crowd by ?playing to Democrats' frequently repeated criticisms of Trump and of Republicans' willingness to go along with him.

"We have never seen a president excel in straight-up grifting, on your dime, like this," Obama said. "Never seen a president so intent on selling favors like this... Now the party seems to stand for corrupt government, or inept government, or no government."

The White House did not immediately respond to a request for comment. But in a Truth Social post on early Sunday morning, Trump called Obama a "grossly incompetent President."

Festive rush fails to boost gig jobs...

COMPANIES ARE INCREASINGLY linking daily earnings to order volumes instead of adding workers on fixed monthly pay. Under these arrangements, a worker could earn ₹900-1,100 on a peak day but only ₹400-500 on a lean day, Narayanan said. Dark-store workers in quick commerce are seeing a similar trend, with base pay remaining flat despite increased hiring.

Delivery partners face a different set of pressures. With e-commerce volumes weakening, per-shipment payouts on horizontal platforms have fallen to ₹12-15 from ₹25-28 last year, Gupta said. In quick commerce, per-order payouts are ₹20-30, with peak-period additions of ₹8-15, broadly unchanged from the ₹22-30 average last festive season.

The pressure reflects a wider imbalance between the supply of delivery partners and order growth, limiting the need for platforms to raise base rates. Workers say uncertain order volumes also make incentive targets harder to meet, forcing them to spend more time online to earn the same amount.

"When orders are uncertain, incentive targets become harder to meet, forcing riders to stay online longer," said Shaik Salauddin, founder-president of the Telangana Gig and Platform Workers' Union and national general secretary of the Indian Federation of App-Based Transport Workers.

The squeeze predates the current festive season. Quick-commerce payouts fell from ₹34-42 per order in early 2024 to ₹22-30 by the 2025 festive season, while e-commerce shipment payouts had dropped to ₹15-16 in the six months to April this year, FE had reported.

AI revenue surges, but Q2 IT...



"EXPECTATIONS FOR AI-led productivity commitments are increasing competitive intensity and reshaping commercial models," Infosys CFO Jayesh Sanghrajka said during an earnings call. The communications segment, Sanghrajka added, was facing a challenging demand environment, with clients maintaining tight control over discretionary spending and prioritising cost efficiency.

Another factor is that not all AI-related revenue represents fresh spending. Some of it comes from transforming existing engagements, rather than winning entirely new business. At the same time, AI tools allow clients to automate tasks and complete projects with fewer billable hours, potentially reducing the revenue that service providers earn from conventional software development, testing, maintenance and support.

Gaurav Vasu, founder and CEO of intelligence firm UnearthInsight, said Indian IT companies lacked a strong AI applications business, leaving enterprise customers to direct much of their spending towards hyperscalers, AI-native firms and startups. Unless service providers build applications and solutions that capture a larger share of this spending, the sector could continue to grow at less than 4% over the next couple of years, he said.

The pressure is expected to intensify over the next two to three years as AI-led revenue deflation reshapes the traditional services business, particularly in North America, a major market for Indian IT companies.

Other regions, including Europe, West Asia and India, could see growth as AI adoption progresses at a different pace, Vasu said.

The shift is also visible in the industry's profitability trends. HfS Research has found that five of seven leading IT services providers improved operating margins despite relatively modest revenue growth.

AI-driven productivity, better utilisation and restructuring are helping companies protect margins, but the savings are not consistently translating into new revenue streams, Ghosh said.

The cautious outlook offered by companies for FY27 reflects these pressures. Infosys cut its revenue growth guidance to 1-2% from 1.5-3%, citing intense pricing pressure and weakness in North American retail and hi-tech segments. Wipro guided for sequential revenue growth of minus 1.5% to 0.5% in the December quarter, warning of seasonal weakness. HCLTech narrowed its FY27 revenue growth guidance to 2.5-4% from 1-4%, while also lowering the upper end of its services revenue growth outlook.

The industry's ability to convert AI capabilities into scalable applications and new revenue streams will determine whether the technology becomes a sustained growth driver or primarily a means of delivering existing services more efficiently. In the near term, profitability could improve faster than revenue, Ghosh said, although the impact will vary across companies.

VW plans Audi plant in Georgia

BLOOMBERG
October 25

VOLKSWAGEN PLANS TO build a new $4 billion factory for its premium Audi brand in the southern US state of Georgia, expecting the move will yield potential relief from tariffs that have severely eroded profits.

The German manufacturer will build a new plant in Macon, central Georgia, to make large SUVs including the new Q9 and Q5 that's currently manufactured in Mexico, Audi said Saturday. Construction of the greenfield project will start next year with a capacity to produce about 200,000 vehicles per year.

President Donald Trump on Saturday called the plan "incredible," saying it was a testament to the impact tariffs levied by the US on auto imports are having.

The move, set to create 4,500 jobs, heralds a political win for Trump in the final stretch of the midterm election cycle.

Unlike competitors BMW AG and Mercedes-Benz Group AG, Audi relies exclusively on imports from Europe and Mexico into the US, making it subject to Trump's punishing tariffs.

Its top-selling Q5 SUV is hit particularly hard because it doesn't comply with the USMCA.



BHARAT FORGE LIMITED

KALYANI

CIN : L25209PN1961PLC012046
Regd. Office : Mundhwa, Pune Cantonment,
Pune-411 036, Maharashtra, India
Ph. No.: 91-20-6704 2777 / 2476 Fax No.: 91-20-2682 2163
E-mail.: secretarial@bharatforge.com Website : www.bharatforge.com

NOTICE OF SPECIAL WINDOW FOR TRANSFER AND DEMATERIALISATION OF PHYSICAL SECURITIES

In continuation to SEBI Circular No. SEBI/HO/MIRSD/MIRSD-PoD/P/CIR/2025/97 dated July 02, 2025, notice is hereby given to inform that in order to facilitate ease of investing for investors and to secure their rights in the securities purchased by them and to further facilitate the investors to get rightful access to their securities, SEBI vide its Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-POD/I/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026 has opened another special window only for transfer and dematerialisation ("demat") of physical securities which were sold / purchased prior to April 01, 2019 for a period of one year from **February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027.** The special window shall also be available for such transfer requests which were submitted earlier and were rejected/returned/not attended to due to deficiency in the documents/process/or otherwise.

Eligible shareholders are requested to contact company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent ("RTA") MUFG Intime India Private Limited at email investor.helpdesk@in.mpms.mufg.com or at their office address at C-101, Embassy 247, LBS Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai - 400083 Tel. 022 49186270 / +91 8108116767 or the Company at secretarial@bharatforge.com.

During this period, the securities so transferred shall be mandatorily credited to the transferee only in demat mode once all the documents are found to be in order by RTA and shall be under lock-in for a period of one year from the date of registration of transfer. Such securities shall not be transferred / lien-marked/ pledged during the said lock-in period. Due process shall be followed for such transfer cum-demat requests. The Company and the RTA have formed focused teams to attend such requests.

This is for your information.

For Bharat Forge Limited
Tejaswini Chaudhari
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No. A18907

Place : Pune
Date : October 25, 2026

AKIKO GLOBAL SERVICES LIMITED

CIN No: L74999DL2018PLC335272
Registered Office: 11th Floor, OfficeNo-8/4-D, Vishwadeep Building, District Centre, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058
Telephone: 011-40104241; **Website:** www.themoneyfair.com
Email: accounting@akiko.co.in

NOTICE OF THE EXTRA ORDINARY GENERAL MEETING (EOGM) OF THE COMPANY AND E-VOTING:

NOTICE is hereby given, that the **Extra Ordinary General Meeting (EOGM)** of the Members of **Akiko Global Services Limited** be held on **Tuesday, November 17, 2026 at 12:30 P.M. IST** through Video Conferencing ("VC") / Other Audio Visual Means ("OAVM") to transact the Business as set out in the notice of EOGM.

Pursuant to The Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA") circular Ministry of Corporate Affairs issued Circular No. 14/2020 dated April 08, 2020, and subsequent circulars issued in this regard, latest being General Circular No. 3/2025 dated September 22, 2025 (collectively referred to as "MCA Circulars") and Circular no. SEBI/HO/ CFD/CMD1/CIR/P/2020/79 dated May 12, 2020 Circular No. SEBI/HO/CFD/CMD2/CIR/P/2021/11 dated January 15, 2021, SEBI vide circular no. SEBI/ HO/ CFD/ CFDPoD-2/ P/ CIR/ 2024/ 133 dated October 3, 2024 and subsequent circulars issued in this regard, ("SEBI Circular") the Notice of EGM has been sent through electronic mode only to those Members whose email addresses are registered with the Company/ Depositories. Member may note that Notice will be uploaded on the website of the Company at www.themoneyfair.com, website of NSE Limited at www.nseindia.com and website of National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) i.e. www.evoting.nsdl.com.

In light of the MCA Circulars, the shareholders whether holding equity shares in Demat form or physical form and who have not submitted their email addresses and in consequence to whom the notice of EOGM could not be serviced, may temporarily get their e-mail addresses registered by following the procedure given below:

1. In case shares are held in physical mode, please provide Folio No., Name of shareholder, scanned copy of the share certificate (front and back), PAN (self-attested scanned copy of PAN card), AADHAR (self-attested scanned copy of Aadhar Card) by email to accounting@akiko.co.in.
2. In case shares are held in DEMAT mode, please provide DPID-CLID (16-digit DPID + CLID or 16-digit beneficiary ID), Name, client master or copy of Consolidated Account statement, PAN (self-attested scanned copy of PAN card), AADHAR (self-attested scanned copy of Aadhar Card) to accounting@akiko.co.in.
3. Alternatively, member may send an e-mail request to evoting@nsdl.com for obtaining User ID and Password by proving the details mentioned in Point (1) or (2) as the case may be.

Post successful registration of the e-mail address, the shareholder would get the user-id and the password to enable e-voting for EOGM.

In case of any queries, shareholder may write to the Company at accounting@akiko.co.in. Shareholders are requested to register/ update their Email Ids with their Depository Participant(s) with whom they maintain their DEMAT accounts if shares are held in dematerialized mode by submitting the requisite documents.

There being no physical shareholders in the Company, the Register of members and share transfer books of the Company is not closed. Members whose names are recorded in the Register of Members or in the Register of Beneficial Owners maintained by the Depositories as on Tuesday, November 10, 2026 ("Cut-off date"), shall only be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting as well as e-voting on the Extra Ordinary General Meeting.

Pursuant to the provisions of Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Rules made thereunder (as amended) and Regulation 44 of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015 (as amended) and above-mentioned MCA Circulars, the Company is providing facility of remote e-voting on the date of the EOGM to its Members in respect of the businesses to be transacted at the EOGM. For this purpose, the Company has entered into an agreement with NSDL for facilitating voting through electronic means.

The remote e-voting will commence Saturday, November 14, 2026 at 09:00 A.M. (IST) and ends on Monday, November 16, 2026 at 05:00 P.M. (IST). During this period, the members of the Company holding shares as on Cut-off date may cast their vote electronically (Remote E-Voting). Members may note that (a) the remote e-voting module shall be disabled by NSDL after the aforesaid date and time for voting and once the vote on a resolution is cast by the member, the member shall not be allowed to change it subsequently; (b) the facility of e-voting shall be made available at the EOGM; and (c) the members who have cast their vote by remote e-voting prior to the EOGM may also attend the EOGM but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again. Detailed procedure for remote e-voting/ e-voting is provided in the Notice of the Extra Ordinary General Meeting.

Any person, who acquires shares of the Company and become member of the Company after dispatch of the Notice of EOGM and holding shares as on the cut-off date i.e. **Tuesday, November 10, 2026**, may obtain the login ID and password by sending a request at evoting@nsdl.com or accounting@akiko.co.in . However, if you are already registered with NSDL for remote e-voting then you can use your existing user ID and password for casting your vote. If you forgot your password, you can reset your password by using "Forgot Password" option available on www.evoting.nsdl.com.

In case of any queries for e-voting, you may refer the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) for Shareholders and e-voting user manual for Shareholders available at the download section of www.evoting.nsdl.com or call on toll free no.: 1800-222-990 or send a request at evoting@nsdl.com.

MEMBERS CAN ATTEND AND PARTICIPATE IN THE EXTRA ORDINARY GENERAL MEETING THROUGH VC/OAVM FACILITY. THE INSTRUCTIONS FOR JOINING THE EXTRA ORDINARY GENERAL MEETING THROUGH VC/OAVM ARE PROVIDED IN THE NOTICE OF THE EXTRA ORDINARY GENERAL MEETING. IN CASE THE SHAREHOLDERS/ MEMBERS HAVE ANY QUERIES OR ISSUES REGARDING PARTICIPATION IN THE EGM, YOU CAN WRITE AN EMAIL TO EVOTING@NSDL.COM OR CALL: 1800-222-990. MEMBERS ATTENDING THE MEETING THROUGH VC/OAVM SHALL BE COUNTED FOR THE PURPOSES OF RECKONING THE QUORUM UNDER SECTION 103 OF THE COMPANIES ACT, 2013.

For, Akiko Global Services Limited
Sd/-
Priyanka Dutta
Director
DIN: 08475220

Place: Delhi
Date: October 22, 2026

BEFORE THE HON'BLE NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL, AHMEDABAD BENCH

FORM NO. CAA-2
C.A.(CAA)/41(AHM)/2026

In the matter of the Companies Act, 2013;
AND
In the matter of Sections 230 to 232 and other applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013;
AND
In the matter of Scheme of Arrangement between R World Leisure Limited ("Demerged Company") and Chandra Exhibitor Private Limited ("Resulting Company") and their respective shareholders and creditors ("Scheme").

R World Leisure Limited (CIN: U42110GJ1996PLC030454)
A Company incorporated under the Companies Act, 1956 having its registered office at 2nd Floor, Plot No.400, Sector-16, Gandhinagar-382016, Gujarat, India.
.....Demerged Company

Chandra Exhibitor Private Limited (CIN: U74999GJ2018PTC100989)
A company incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013 having its registered office at 2nd Floor, Plot No.400, Sector-16, Gandhinagar-382016, Gujarat, India.
.....Resulting Company

NOTICE AND ADVERTISEMENT OF THE MEETING OF UNSECURED CREDITORS OF BOTH THE APPLICANT COMPANIES AND SECURED CREDITORS OF THE DEMERGED COMPANY

NOTICE is hereby given that by an order dated 9th October, 2026 ("the Order"), the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal, Ahmedabad Bench **("Hon'ble NCLT")** has directed for convening separate meetings of Secured and Unsecured Creditors of Demerged Company; and Unsecured Creditors of the Resulting Company for the purpose of considering, and if thought fit, approving, with or without modification(s), the Scheme of Arrangement between R World Leisure Limited **("Demerged Company")** and Chandra Exhibitor Private Limited ("**Resulting Company**") and their respective shareholders and creditors **("Scheme").**

In pursuance of the said order and as directed therein, further notice is hereby given that the separate meetings of the Secured and Unsecured Creditors of the respective applicant companies will be held as follows:

Sr. No.	Name of the Applicant Company	Class of Meetings	Day & Date of Meeting	Time (IST)	Venue
1	**R World Leisure Limited** (Demerged Company)	Secured Creditors	Saturday 28th November, 2026	10:30 AM	2nd Floor, Plot No. 400, Sector-16, Gandhinagar-382016, Gujarat, India.
		Unsecured Creditors		11:00 AM	
2	**Chandra Exhibitor Private Limited** (Resulting Company)	Unsecured Creditors		12:30 PM	

Copies of the said Scheme of Arrangement, notice along with Explanatory Statement and other Annexure as stated in the Index of the Notice under section 230 of the Companies Act, 2013 can be obtained free of charge from the registered office of the Applicant Companies during business hours (i.e. between 10:00 A.M. to 6:00 P.M.)

The Hon'ble NCLT has appointed Advocate Mr. K. P. S. Dhillon, as the Chairman of the aforesaid meetings. Advocate Mr. Vishawjeet Singh has been appointed as the Scrutinizer for the said meetings for conduct of voting in a fair and transparent manner. In case of the aforesaid meeting, the voting shall be carried out through the Ballot/Polling paper at the venue of the meeting. The Scheme, if approved in the said meetings, will be subject to the subsequent approval of the Hon'ble NCLT.

TAKE FURTHER NOTICE that:

1. The Secured and Unsecured Creditors standing as on cut-off date i.e. 31st July, 2026 will be entitled to vote. The voting rights as well as value of the vote of the Secured and Unsecured Creditors shall be in proportion to outstanding amount due to them as on cut - off date i.e. 31st July, 2026.
2. In line with the Order of Hon'ble NCLT, provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and MCA circulars, the Notice calling the meeting along with the Explanatory Statement is being sent through electronic mode to the Secured and Unsecured Creditors whose e-mail addresses are registered with the Company for communication purpose and through approved physical mode to such other Secured and Unsecured Creditors whose email addresses are not registered with the Company.
3. The Persons entitled to attend and vote at the respective meetings may vote in person or by proxy or through authorised representative, provided that all proxies in the prescribed form are deposited at the registered office of the Applicant Companies, not later than 48 hours before the meeting. Forms of proxy can be obtained from the registered office of the Applicant Companies.

Sd/-
Advocate Mr. K. P. S. Dhillon
Chairman appointed for the meeting by Hon'ble NCLT, Ahmedabad Bench

Date: 24th October, 2026
Place: Chandigarh

OFFER OPENING ADVERTISMENT FOR THE BUY BACK EQUITY SHARES THROUGH THE TENDER OFFER ROUTE UNDER THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (BUY-BACK OF SECURITIES) REGULATIONS, 2018, AS AMENDED, ("SEBI BUYBACK REGULATIONS") FOR THE ATTENTION OF THE ELIGIBLE SHAREHOLDERS/ BENEFICIAL OWNERS OF THE EQUITY SHARES OF VRL LOGISTICS LIMITED.

VRL LOGISTICS LIMITED

CIN: L60210KA1983PLC005247
Registered Office: RSNO.351/1, Varur Post Chabbi, Taluk, Hubli Dist. Dharwad, Hubli– 581207, Karnataka,
Tel: 0836-2237511, **Website**: www.vrlgroup.in, **E-mail**: investors@vrllogistics.com
Contact Person: Aniruddha Phadnavis, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT FOR THE ATTENTION OF EQUITY SHARESHOLDERS/ BENEFICIAL OWNERS OF EQUITY SHARES OF VRL LOGISTICS LIMITED IN CONNECTION WITH THE BUYBACK OF EQUITY SHARES THROUGH THE TENDER OFFER ROUTE UNDER THE SEBI BUYBACK REGULATIONS.

OFFER TO BUY-BACK UP 87,50,000 (EIGHTY SEVEN LAKHS FIFTY THOUSAND ONLY) FULLY PAID-UP EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 (RUPEE TEN) EACH OF VRL LOGISTICS LIMITED, REPRESENTING 5% OF THE TOTAL NUMBER OF EQUITY SHARES IN THE PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF THE COMPANY AS ON MARCH 31, 2026 FROM ALL THE ELIGIBLE SHAREHOLDERS OF EQUITY SHARES OF THE COMPANY AS ON OCTOBER 22, 2026 (RECORD DATE) AS PER THE RECORDS MADE AVAILABLE TO THE COMPANY BY DEPOSITORIES AS ON THE RECORD DATE, ON A PROPORTIONATE BASIS (SUBJECT TO SMALL SHAREHOLDER RESERVATION), THROUGH THE "TENDER OFFER" ROUTE AT A PRICE OF ₹ 320 (RUPEES THREE HUNDRED AND TWENTY ONLY) PER EQUITY SHARE PAYABLE IN CASH FOR AN AGGREGATE CONSIDERATION OF UP TO ₹28,000 LAKHS (RUPEES TWENTY EIGHT THOUSAND LAKHS ONLY) ("BUYBACK").

This Offer Opening Advertisement is to be read together with:

a. The Public Announcement, made in accordance with the SEBI Buyback Regulations, dated October 07, 2026 and published on October 08, 2026 in all editions of the Financial Express (English national daily), Jansatta (Hindi national daily) and the Vijayavani (Kannada regional daily - Karnataka), Kannada being the local language of the state in which the Registered Office of the Company is situated, each with wide circulation ("**Original Public Announcement**");
b. The Corrigendum to the Public Announcement dated October 16, 2026, in respect of the revision of the Record Date and the related activities for the Buyback, published on October 17, 2026, in the same newspapers in which the original Public Announcement with respect to the Buyback published (**"Corrigendum to the Public Announcement"**); and
c. The Letter of Offer dated October 24, 2026 **("Letter of Offer")**.

In terms of Regulation 8(i)(a) of the SEBI Buyback Regulations, the Letter of Offer was submitted to SEBI on October 24, 2026. The dispatch of the Letter of Offer to the Eligible Shareholders of the Company holding Equity Shares on the Record Date i.e. Thursday, October 22, 2026 has been completed by October 24, 2026, through electronic mode to the Eligible Shareholders whose email ids are available with their respective depositories and will be sent through speed post/courier to the Shareholders from whom a request to receive a copy of letter of offer in physical form is received.

The schedule of activities for the Buyback is as follows:

Sr. No.	Activity	Date	Day
1.	Buyback Window Opening Date	October 27, 2026	Tuesday
2.	Buyback Window Closing Date	November 02, 2026	Monday
3.	Last date of receipt of completed Tender Forms and other specified documents including physical share certificates (if and as applicable) by the Registrar	November 02, 2026	Monday

Note:
(i) For detailed activity schedule, terms and conditions for the Buyback, please refer to the Letter of Offer; and
(ii) Where last dates are mentioned for certain activities, such activities may happen on or before the respective last dates.

The details of the Buy-back Entitlement in each category are as follows:

Category of Eligible Shareholder	Ratio of Buyback (i.e. Buyback Entitlement)
Reserved category for Small Shareholders	14 Equity Shares for every 99 Equity Shares held on the Record Date
General category for all other Eligible Shareholders	19 Equity Shares for every 154 Equity Shares held on the Record Date

Note: The above ratio of Buyback is approximate and provides indicative Buyback Entitlement. Any computation of the Buyback Entitlement using the above Buyback ratio may provide a slightly different number than the actual entitlement due to rounding-off. The actual Buyback Entitlement factor for Small Shareholders under the Reserved Category is 14.1428922403203 % and for other shareholders under the General Category is 12.3393258021333 %. Also, the numbers arrived at using the actual Buyback Entitlement may not conform exactly to the Buyback Entitlement printed in the Tender Form due to rounding-off of the factor. For further information on ratio of Buyback as per the Buyback Entitlement in each Category, please refer to *"Process and Methodology for the Buyback – Record Date and Ratio of Buyback as per the Buyback Entitlement in each Category"* on page 31 of the Letter of Offer.

ELIGIBLE SHAREHOLDERS CAN ALSO CHECK THEIR ENTITLEMENT ON THE WEBSITE OF THE REGISTRAR TO THE BUYBACK BY FOLLOWING THE STEPS GIVEN BELOW:

1) Click on https://kosmic.kfintech.com/karisma/buybackacceptancequeryv2.aspx
2) Select the name of the Company – VRL Logistics Limited – Buyback – 2026
3) Select holding type - "Physical" or "NSDL" or "CDSL"
4) Based on the option selected above, enter your "Folio Number" or "NSDL DPID/Client ID" or "CDSL Client ID"
5) Enter the Security code and click on Submit
6) ***The entitlement will be provided in the pre-filled 'FORM OF ACCEPTANCE-CUM ACKNOWLEDGEMENT'***

For the purpose of this Buyback, BSE Limited is the Designated Stock Exchange. All Eligible Shareholders may place orders in the Acquisition Window, through their respective stockbrokers (**"Shareholder Broker"**) during normal trading hours of the secondary market.

In the event a Shareholder Broker(s) of the Eligible Shareholder is not registered with BSE, then such Eligible Shareholders can approach any BSE registered stockbroker and can register themselves by using quick unique client code (**"UCC"**) facility through the BSE registered stock broker (after submitting all details as may be required by such BSE registered stock broker in compliance with applicable law). In case the Eligible Shareholders are unable to register using UCC facility through any other BSE registered broker, Eligible Shareholders may approach Company's Broker i.e. Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited to place their bids.

For details of the procedure for tender and settlement, please refer to the "***Procedure for Tender Offer and Settlement***" on page 34 of the Letter of Offer.

In case you have not received the Letter of Offer and Tender Form, the same are also available on the website of the Company, the Securities and Exchange Board of India, the Registrar to the Buy-back, the Stock Exchanges and the Manager to the Buyback at https://vrlgroup.in/Resources/InvestorsDesk/2026; www.sebi.gov.in; on https://kosmic.kfintech.com/karisma/buybackacceptancequeryv2.aspx; www.nseindia.com; www.bseindia.com and www.motilaloswal.com respectively.

MANAGER TO THE BUYBACK	REGISTRAR TO THE BUYBACK
Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited Motilal Oswal Tower, Rahimtullah Sayani Road, Opposite Parel ST Depot, Prabhadevi, Mumbai- 400 025, Maharashtra, India **Tel. No.:** +91 22 7193 4380 **E-mail:** vrl.buyback@motilaloswal.com **Website:** www.motilaloswal.com **Contact Person:** Ritu Sharma **SEBI Registration No.:** INM000011005 **CIN:** U67190MH2006PLC160583	**KFin Technologies Limited** Selenium Tower B, Plot 31-32, Financial District, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally, Hyderabad - 500 032 **Tel. No.:** +91 40 6716 2222 /18003094001 **E-mail:** vrllogistics.buyback26@kfintech.com **Website:** www.kfintech.com **Investor Grievance E-mail:** einward.ris@kfintech.com **Contact Person:** Mr. Williams R **SEBI Registration No.:** INR000000221 **CIN:** L72400MH2017PLC444072

Capitalized terms used but not defined in this Offer Opening Advertisement shall have the meaning assigned to such terms in the Letter of Offer.

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors of VRL Logistics Limited
Sd/-
Aniruddha Phadnavis
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
ICSI Membership No.: A20456

Date: October 24, 2026
Place: Hubballi

Adfactors 495/26

SBFC Finance Limited

SBFC Loans Made Easy

CIN : L67190MH2008PLC178270

[Regulation 47(1) and Regulation 52 (8) read with Regulation 52 (4) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015]

Extract of Financial Results for the quarter and half year ended September 30, 2026

(₹ in Million)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter ended			Half year ended		Year ended
		Sept 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	June 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	Sept 30, 2025 (Unaudited)	Sept 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	Sept 30, 2025 (Unaudited)	Mar 31, 2026 (Audited)
1	Total income from operations	5,463.87	4,914.64	4,107.84	10,378.51	7,992.22	16,788.21
2	Net profit for the period (before tax, exceptional and/or extraordinary items)	1,857.79	1,741.22	1,458.84	3,599.01	2,815.94	6,035.93
3	Net profit for the period before tax (after exceptional and/or extraordinary items)	1,857.79	1,741.22	1,458.84	3,599.01	2,815.94	6,035.93
4	Net profit for the period after tax (after exceptional and/or extraordinary items)	1,388.74	1,301.23	1,091.35	2,689.97	2,100.26	4,508.33
5	Total comprehensive income for the period [comprising profit for the period (after tax) and other comprehensive income (after tax)]	1,503.04	1,380.87	1,142.02	2,883.91	2,119.58	4,445.81
6	Paid up equity share capital (Face value of ₹ 10/- each)	11,083.13	11,065.97	10,924.87	11,083.13	10,924.87	11,057.04
7	Reserve (excluding revaluation reserves)	-	-	-	-	-	26,194.48
8	Securities premium account	-	-	-	-	-	11,983.49
9	Net worth	40,490.97	38,731.77	34,342.50	40,490.97	34,342.50	37,251.52
10	Paid up debt capital/ outstanding debt	93,382.01	88,577.71	61,756.52	93,382.01	61,756.52	71,617.13
11	Outstanding redeemable preference shares	-	-	-	-	-	-
12	Debt equity ratio	2.31	2.29	1.80	2.31	1.80	1.92
13	Earnings Per share (of ₹ 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations):-						
	(a) Basic (not annualized)	1.25	1.18	1.00	2.43	1.93	4.13
	(b) Diluted (not annualized)	1.25	1.17	0.99	2.42	1.90	4.10
14	Capital redemption reserve	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
15	Debenture redemption reserve	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
16	Debt service coverage ratio	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
17	Interest service coverage ratio	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
18	Total debts to total assets ratio	0.68	0.68	0.63	0.68	0.63	0.65
19	Net profit margin	25.40%	26.47%	26.55%	25.91%	26.27%	26.84%

Notes:

1) The above is an extract of the detailed format financial results for the quarter and half year ended September 30, 2026, filed with the Stock Exchange(s) under Regulation 33 and Regulation 52 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 as amended. The full format of the said 'Financial Results' are available on the website of Stock Exchanges "www.bseindia.com", "www.nseindia.com" and on the Company's website viz. "www.sbfc.com" .The said financial results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee, subsequently approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at its meeting held on October 24, 2026 and subjected to limited review by the Statutory Auditors.
2) The pertinent disclosure have been made to BSE Limited and the National Stock Exchange of India Limited as per Regulation 52 (4) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 and can be accessed on "www.bseindia.com" and "www.nseindia.com".

Date : October 24, 2026
Place : Mumbai

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors of
SBFC Finance Limited
sd/-
Mahesh Dayani
Managing Director & CEO
DIN: 06561389

Regd. Office: 103, 1st Floor, C&B Square, Sangam Complex, Andheri Kurla Road, Village Chakala, Andheri (East), Mumbai - 400059
Telephone No.: 022-67875300 Website: www.sbfc.com Email: complianceofficer@sbfc.com

FORM NO. INC-26

[Pursuant to Rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014]

Advertisement to be published in the newspaper for change of Registered Office of the Company from one State to another

BEFORE THE CENTRAL GOVERNMENT REGIONAL DIRECTOR, SOUTHERN REGION, CHENNAI

In the matter of Sub-section (4) of Section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 and Clause (a) of Sub-rule (5) of Rule 30 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014

AND

In the matter of **SWITCHING TECHNOLOGIES GUNTHER LIMITED (CIN:** L10790TN1988PLC015647), having its Registered Office at **714A, Spencer Plaza, Phase II, 7th Floor, Anna Salai, Anna Road, Chennai, Tamil Nadu-600002**

.....Applicant

Notice is hereby given to the General Public that the Company proposes to make an application to the Central Government under Section 13 of the Companies Act, 2013 seeking confirmation of alteration of the Memorandum of Association of the Company in terms of the Special Resolution passed at the Annual General Meeting held on **Thursday, 24th September 2026** to enable the Company to change its Registered Office from the **"State of Tamil Nadu"** to the **"State of Rajasthan"**.

Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the Registered Office of the Company may deliver **either on the MCA-21 portal (www.mca.gov.in) by filing Investor Complaint form** or cause to be delivered or send by registered post of his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and grounds of opposition to the **Regional Director, Southern Region, Ministry of Corporate Affairs, 5th Floor, Shastri Bhavan, 26, Haddows Road, Chennai-600006**, within **fourteen days** from the date of publication of this notice, with a copy to the Applicant Company at its Registered Office at the address mentioned below:

714A, Spencer Plaza, Phase II, 7th Floor, Anna Salai, Anna Road, Chennai, Tamil Nadu-600002

E-mail: cs@stg-india.com

For and on behalf of
SWITCHING TECHNOLOGIES GUNTHER LIMITED
Sd/-
Nikhil Pujari
Whole-time Director
DIN: 11224770

Date: 26.10.2026
Place: Chennai

EAST COAST RAILWAY

Tender Notice No. 39/ET/SBP/ENGG/2026-27, Dated : 15.10.2026

(1) e-Tender No. 16-eT-SDENS-SBP-26

NAME OF WORK : EXECUTION OF P.WAY WORKS SUCH AS 1.TRR(P)- 8.003 TKMS 2.TBR-8.340 KMS 3.TFR- 55.475 TKMS UNDER THE JURISDICTION OF ASSISTANT DIVISIONAL ENGINEER / TITILAGARH (TIG) IN SAMBALPUR DIVISION.

Approximate Cost of the Work : ₹2,08,07,501.87, **Bid Security :** ₹4,16,200/-, **Completion Period for the Work :** 12 (Twelve) Months.

(2) e-Tender No.17-eT-SDENS-SBP-26

NAME OF WORK : EXECUTION OF P.WAY WORKS SUCH AS 1.TRR(P)- 15.080 TKMS, 2.TBR-15.339 KMS 3.TFR- 28.897 TKMS UNDER THE JURISDICTION OF ASSISTANT DIVISIONAL ENGINEER / MUNIGUDA (MNGD) IN SAMBALPUR DIVISION.

Approximate Cost of the Work : ₹3,06,63,618.91, **Bid Security :** ₹6,13,300/-, **Completion Period for the Work :** 12 (Twelve) Months.

(3) e-Tender No.24-eT-DENE-SBP-26

NAME OF WORK : MISCELLANEOUS REPAIRS TO STAFF QUARTERS SUCH AS FLOORING, ROOF LEAKAGE, DOOR AND WINDOW REPAIR, COLLAPSIBLE GRILL GATE, OVERHEAD TANK CLEANING AND REPLACEMENT, PIPELINE, SEWAGE AND SANITARY, DRAIN REPAIR AND CLEANING, DUSTBIN PROVISION TO COLONIES, PLINTH PROTECTION AND PATHWAY REPAIR TO STAFF QUARTERS, SANITARY FITTINGS, JUNGLE CLEANING AT COLONIES ETC. UNDER THE JURISDICTION OF ASSISTANT DIVISIONAL ENGINEER /SAMBALPUR.

Approximate Cost of the Work : ₹1,04,94,766.40, **Bid Security :** ₹2,09,900/-, **Completion Period for the Work :** 03 (Three) Months.

(4) e-Tender No.25-eT-DENE-SBP-26

NAME OF WORK : MISCELLANEOUS REPAIR TO STAFF QUARTERS, COLONY CIRCULATING AREA, DRAINS, SEPTIC TANKS, REPAIR AND REPLACEMENT OF PVC DOORS, STEEL DOORS & WINDOWS, REPAIR TO PIPELINES, REPLACEMENT OF DAMAGED WATER TANKS, PATHWAY & PLINTH PROTECTION, WALL PLASTER AND FLOORING, COLOUR WASHING, WHITE WASHING, ETC., BETWEEN CHARMAL AND JARAPADA SECTION UNDER JURISDICTION OF ASSISTANT DIVISIONAL ENGINEER /RAIRAKHOL (RAIR) IN SAMBALPUR DIVISION.

Approximate Cost of the Work : ₹1,98,28,367.98, **Bid Security :** ₹3,96,600/-, **Completion Period for the Work :** 03 (Three) Months.

(5) e-Tender No.26-eT-DENE-SBP-26

NAME OF WORK : MISCELLANEOUS REPAIRS TO SERVICE BUILDINGS, PF SURFACE, NAME BOARDS, WAITING HALLS, FOBS, PF SHELTERS, CIRCULATING AREA, DRAINS, SEPTIC TANKS, REPAIR AND REPLACEMENT OF PVC DOORS, STEEL DOORS AND WINDOWS, REPAIRS TO PIPELINES, REPLACEMENT OF DAMAGED WATER STORAGE TANK, PATHWAYS AND PLINTH PROTECTION, WALL PLASTER AND FLOORINGS, ETC., OF SERVICE BUILDINGS, ALONG WITH WHITE WASHING, COLOR WASHING, DISTEMPERING, AND PAINTING TO ALL SERVICE BUILDINGS, FOBS, PF BENCHES, OVERHEAD TANK STAGING, BOUNDARY WALL, ETC. FROM SAMBALPUR CITY (SBPY)–JARAPADA (JRPD) SECTION UNDER SENIOR DIVISIONAL ENGINEER (EAST)/ SAMBALPUR.

Approximate Cost of the Work : ₹1,76,21,758.50, **Bid Security :** ₹3,52,500/-, **Completion Period for the Work :** 03 (Three) Months.

(6) e-Tender No.27-eT-DENE-SBP-26

NAME OF WORK : REPAIR TO COLONY ROADS WITH CIRCULATING AREA BETWEEN SECTIONS CHARMAL (CHAR) - JARAPADA (JRPD) STATIONS UNDER JURISDICTION OF SENIOR DIVISIONAL ENGINEER (EAST) IN SAMBALPUR DIVISION.

Approximate Cost of the Work : ₹1,12,98,071.70, **Bid Security :** ₹2,26,000/-, **Completion Period for the Work :** 03 (Three) Months.

Tender Closing Date and Time : At 1500 Hrs. of 09.11.2026 (for all Tenders).

No manual offers sent by Post / Courier / Fax or in person accepted against such e-tenders even if these are submitted on firm's letter head and received in time. All such manual offers shall be considered invalid and shall be rejected summarily without any consideration.

Complete information including e-tender documents of the above e-tender is available in website : **www.ireps.gov.in**

Note : The prospective tenderers are advised to revisit the website 15 (Fifteen) days before the date of closing of tender to note any changes / corrigenda issued for this tender. The tenderers/bidders must have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate and must be registered on IREPS Portal. Only registered tenderer/ bidder can participate on e-tendering.

Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.)/ Sambalpur

PR- 503/R/26-27

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given that the below mentioned Authorised Person is no longer affiliated as Authorised Person of Kotak Securities Limited.

Authorised Person Name	Trade Name	Exchange Registration Numbers of Authorised Person	Address of Authorised Person
ALBIN JOSEPH	ALBIN JOSEPH	NSE - AP0291571061 BSE - AP01067301174456 MCX - 173974	ROOM NO 1054 SECOND FLOOR OPPOSITE MODERN CLINIC KATTAPPANA PULIYANAMAL ROAD KATTAPPANA PO IDUKKI 685508

Please note that above mention Authorised Person (AP) is no longer associated with us. Any person henceforth dealing with above mention AP should do so, at their own risk. Kotak Securities Ltd. shall not be liable for any such dealing. In case of any queries for the transactions till date, Investors are requested to inform Kotak Securities Ltd. within 15 days from the date of this notification, failing which it shall be deemed that there exists no queries against the above mentioned AP.

kotak neo Kotak Securities Limited. Registered Office: 27 BKC, C 27, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai 400051. CIN: U99999MH1994PLC134051, Telephone No.: +22 43360000, Fax No.: +22 67132430. Website: www.kotakneo.com. Correspondence Address: Infinity IT Park, Bldg. No 21, Opp. Film City Road, A K Vaidya Marg, Malad (East), Mumbai 400097. Telephone No: 42856825. SEBI Registration No: INZ000200137 (Member of NSE, BSE, MSE, MCX & NCDEX), AMFI ARN 0164, PMS INP000000258, and Research Analyst INH000000586. NSDL/CDSL: IN-IN-DP-629-2021. Compliance Officer Details: Mr. Hiren Thakkar Call: 022 - 4285 8484, or Email: ks.compliance@kotak.com.

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given that the below mentioned Authorised Person is no longer affiliated as Authorised Person of Kotak Securities Limited.

Authorised Person Name	Trade Name	Exchange Registration Numbers of Authorised Person	Address of Authorised Person
Anish Krishnan Punnakuzhiyil	Anish Krishnan Punnakuzhiyil	NSE - AP0291572271	POOKKOTTUMPADAM PO PARAKKAPADAM AMARAMBALAM MALAPPURAM MALAPPURAM 679332

Please note that above mention Authorised Person (AP) is no longer associated with us. Any person henceforth dealing with above mention AP should do so, at their own risk. Kotak Securities Ltd. shall not be liable for any such dealing. In case of any queries for the transactions till date, Investors are requested to inform Kotak Securities Ltd. within 15 days from the date of this notification, failing which it shall be deemed that there exists no queries against the above mentioned AP.

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MANAMADURAI MUNICIPALITY

NOTICE FOR INVITING RE-TENDER (ONLINE ONLY)

Swachh Bharat Mission 2025-26

(Roc.No. 271/2026/E1 Dated.23.10.2026)

1. Tenders are invited from the eligible bidders for the work of Swachh Bharat Mission 2025-26 in Manamadurai Municipality.
2. The value of a single work is Rs.145.00 Lakhs
3. The details for the tender shall be obtained from web portal: **www.tntenders.gov.in**
4. The tender document shall be downloaded from **26.10.2026** from the portal **www.tntenders.gov.in**
5. The last date for downloading the tender document and the last date for uploading/ submission of filled up tender document is up to **3.00 pm** on **13.11.2026.**
6. The received tenders will be opened at **3.30 pm** on **13.11.2026** at the office of Manamadurai Municipality.
7. The details of earnest money deposit (EMD) and the eligible interior are given in the concern work tender document.

DIPR/ 3212 /TENDER/2026

Commissioner, Manamadurai Municipality

L B PUBLISHERS AND DISTRIBUTORS LLP

LLPIN: ACA-8577

No. 10, 1st Main, 6th Cross Versova Layout, C V Raman Nagar, Bangalore – 560 093 Karnataka, India
Mobile: +91 9886026130 | Email: SREEDHAR@LBPD.CO.IN

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice Of Shifting Of Registered Office From One State To Another State

Notice is hereby given to the General Public that pursuant to sub-section (3) of Section 13 of Limited Liability Partnership Act, 2008 read with Rule 17 of the Limited Liability Partnership Rules, 2009, the L B PUBLISHERS AND DISTRIBUTORS LLP (LLPIN: ACA-8577), having its registered office at No. 10, 1st Main, 6th Cross, Versova Layout, C V Raman Nagar, Bangalore, Karnataka, 560093 proposes to make an application to Registrar of Companies, Bangalore seeking permission to change its Registered office from the state of **"Karnataka"** to the state of **"Maharashtra"**.

Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the registered office of the LLP may deliver or cause to be delivered or send by Registered post of his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and grounds of opposition supported by an affidavit to the Registrar of Companies, Bangalore, within 21 (Twenty-One) days from the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the LLP at its registered office at the address mentioned above.

Date : 26/10/2026
Place : Bangalore

For and on behalf of
L B PUBLISHERS AND DISTRIBUTORS LLP
Sd/-
Name: Neeta Shrenik Shah
Designated partner
DPIN: 07925447

Address: Flat No. 901, 9th Floor, Plot No -55, Plaza Heights,N.S. Patkar Marg, Near Dharam Palace, Huges Road Mumbai, Grant Road, Mumbai - 400007, Maharashtra

INDIA SME ASSET RECONSTRUCTION CO. LTD.

Regd. Off. : The Ruby 11th Floor, North – West Wing, Plot No 29, Senapati Bapat Marg, Dadar (West) Mumbai – 400028.

POSSESSION NOTICE

As per Rule 8(1) of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002

The borrowers/co-borrowers/guarantors/mortgagors mentioned hereunder had availed financial assistance/loan from Fedbank Financial Services Limited ("Original Lender"). The said loan, together with all underlying security interest and all rights, title and interest of the Original Lender therein, was assigned by the Original Lender under the provisions of the SARFAESI Act, 2002, in favour of India SME Asset Reconstruction Company Limited("ISARC"), acting in its capacity as the Trustee of ISARC- 2025-2026-3 Trust, vide Assignment Agreement dated 26th September 2025.

Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorised officer of India SME Asset Reconstruction Company Limited("ISARC") under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of Powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued a Demand Notices dated 28.10.2025 calling upon the borrowers/co-borrowers/ guarantors/ mortgagors **Ravi P (Borrower), Balamaheswari R (Co-Borrower)** to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being **Rs. 11,58,541.53/- (Rupees Eleven Lakhs Fifty Eight Thousand Five Hundred Forty One and Fifty Three Paisa Only)** with further interest & costs within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notices.

The borrowers/co-borrowers/guarantors/mortgagors having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to them and the public in general that the undersigned has taken **Physical Possession** of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under sub-section (4) of section 13 of the Act read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 rules on this **24th day of October of the year 2026.**

The borrowers'/co-borrowers'/guarantors'/mortgagors' attention is invited to provisions of sub -section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem secured assets

The borrowers/co-borrowers/guarantors/mortgagors in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of India SME Asset Reconstruction Company Limited("ISARC") for an amount of **Rs. 14,33,291/- as on dated 31-10-2026 (Rupees Forteen Lakh Thirty Three Thousand Two Hundred and Ninety One Only)** and interest thereon.

Description of immovable Property

SCHEDULE "A":-All that piece and parcel of (Sub District of Tirunelveli- District : Tirunelveli) of land situated at Sankar Nagar Town Panchayat Limit in Survey No. 449/1 Part of Naranammalpuram Village, marked as plot No. 1888 MIG in the sanctioned plan at Tirunelveli at Naranammalpuram Phase II and measuring 180.00 Sqm. & there abouts **bounded as follows: North By** :Prime Commercial. **East By :** Plot No. 1887, **South By :** 7 Metre Road,**West By :** Plot No. 1889. measuring on the North 10.00 Metre On the East 18.00 Metre on the South 10.00 Metre and on the West 18.00 Metre, and on in all measuring 180.00 Square Meter. situated within the Registration District of Tirunelveli.

Date : 24.10.2026
Place : Chennai

Authorised Officer
India SME Asset Reconstruction Company Limited

L.B.PUBLISHERS AND DISTRIBUTORS (BANGALORE) LLP

LLPIN: ACA-0699

No. 10, 1st Main, 6th Cross Versova Layout, C V Raman Nagar, Bangalore – 560 093 Karnataka, India
Mobile: +91 9886026130 | Email: SREEDHAR@LBPD.CO.IN

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice Of Shifting Of Registered Office From One State To Another State

Notice is hereby given to the General Public that pursuant to sub-section (3) of Section 13 of Limited Liability Partnership Act, 2008 read with Rule 17 of the Limited Liability Partnership Rules, 2009, the L.B.PUBLISHERS AND DISTRIBUTORS (BANGALORE) LLP (LLPIN: ACA-0699) having its registered office at No. 10, 1st Main, 6th Cross, Versova Layout, C V Raman Nagar, Bangalore, Karnataka, 560093 proposes to make an application to Registrar of Companies, Bangalore seeking permission to change its Registered office from the state of **"Karnataka"** to the state of **"Maharashtra"**.

Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change of the registered office of the LLP may deliver or cause to be delivered or send by Registered post of his/her objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his/her interest and grounds of opposition supported by an affidavit to the Registrar of Companies, Bangalore, within 21 (Twenty-One) days from the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the LLP at its registered office at the address mentioned above.

Date : 26/10/2026
Place : Bangalore

For and on behalf of
L.B.PUBLISHERS AND DISTRIBUTORS (BANGALORE) LLP
Sd/-
Name: Neeta Shrenik Shah
Designated partner
DPIN: 07925447

Address: Flat No. 901, 9th Floor, Plot No -55, Plaza Heights,N.S. Patkar Marg, Near Dharam Palace, Huges Road Mumbai, Grant Road, Mumbai - 400007, Maharashtra

CHOLAMANDALAM INVESTMENT AND FINANCE COMPANY LIMITED

Chola Enter a better life

Corporate office address:- Chola Crest,Super B, C54 & C55,4, Thiru Vi Ka Industrial Estate, Guindy, Chennai – 600 032

POSSESSION NOTICE

[(APPENDIX IV) [Under Rule 8(1)]

WHEREAS the undersigned being the Authorised Officer of M/s. Cholamandalam Investment And Finance Company Limited , under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002), and in exercise of the powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 9 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued Demand Notice dated mentioned below under Section 13(2) of the said Act calling upon you being the borrowers (names and addresses mentioned below) to repay the amount mentioned in the said notice and interest thereon within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrowers mentioned herein below having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrowers mentioned herein below and to the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on me under sub-section (4) of Section 13 of the Act read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The borrowers mentioned here in above in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with said property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of M/s. Cholamandalam Investment And Finance Company Limited for an amount as mentioned herein under and interest thereon. The borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Sl. No.	Name and Address of the Borrowers & Loan A/c no.	Date of Demand Notice	O/S AMT	Description Of The Property Possessed	Date Of Possession
1.	**Loan Account Nos.:HL25NUK000091448** **Mr/Mrs. KALANGI SIVAKUMARI** (Known Legal heir, Co-borrower as well as Wife of Late Shri Kalangi Satyanarayana) **Mr/Mrs. KALANGI ANUSHA** (Known Legal heir as well as Daughter of Late Shri Kalangi Satyanarayana) **Mr/Mrs. KALANGI ARAVIND** (Known Legal heir as well as Son of Late Shri Kalangi Satyanarayana) **All Are R/o.At**: Door No 34-143/4, Revenue Ward 1, Srinivasa Nagar, Vinukonda, Palnadu, Near Tank Bazar Guntur-522647 **Also At**: Revenue ward1 srinivasanagr Neartankbazaar Guntur 522647	31-07-2026	**Rs. 20,11,634/-** (Rupees Twenty Lakh Eleven Thousand Six Hundred Thirty Four Only)as on **31-07-2026**	All that piece and parcel of Land and Building bearing Door.No. 34-144, Situated in Vinukonda Municipality, VinukondaTown, Palnadu District, Comprised in S.No. 401/2, Land measurement an extent of 75.55 Sq.yards and bounded by; East:10 Ft Width Bazar Ft.17.0; West:Site belongs to Pasupuleti raghavaiah Ft.17.0; North:Site of Paruchuri Kasi Viswanadham Ft.40.0; South:Site of Rathikinda Subba Rao Ft.40.0. With all easement rights.	**Possession Date: 23-10-2026**

Date: 23-10-2026
Place: Palnadu

AUTHORIZED OFFICER
CHOLAMANDALAM INVESTMENT AND FINANCE COMPANY LIMITED

"IMPORTANT

Whilst care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever. Registered letters are not accepted in response to box number advertisement."

L.B.PUBLISHERS & DISTRIBUTORS (MADRAS) LLP

LLPIN: ABZ-9832

No. 10, 1st Main, 6th Cross Versova Layout, C V Raman Nagar, Bangalore – 560 093 Karnataka, India
Mobile: +91 9886026130 | Email: SREEDHAR@LBPD.CO.IN

PUBLIC NOTICE

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Notice is hereby given to the General Public that pursuant to sub-section (3) of Section 13 of Limited Liability Partnership Act, 2008 read with Rule 17 of the Limited Liability Partnership Rules, 2009, the L.B.PUBLISHERS & DISTRIBUTORS (MADRAS) LLP (LLPIN: ABZ-9832), having its registered office at No. 10, 1st Main, 6th Cross, Versova Layout, C V Raman Nagar, Bangalore, Karnataka, 560093 proposes to make an application to Registrar of Companies, Bangalore seeking permission to change its Registered office from the state of **"Karnataka"** to the state of **"Maharashtra"**.

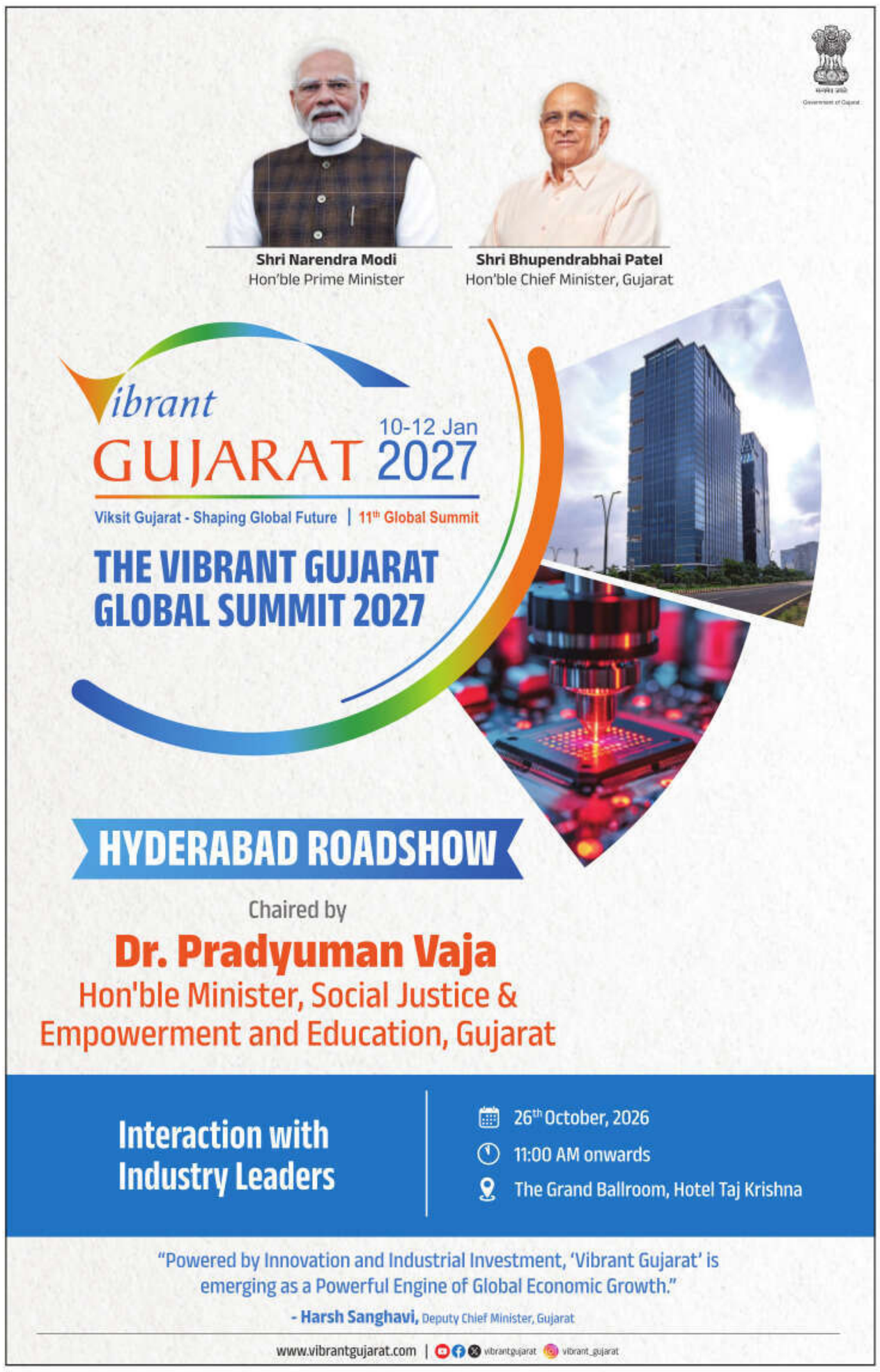
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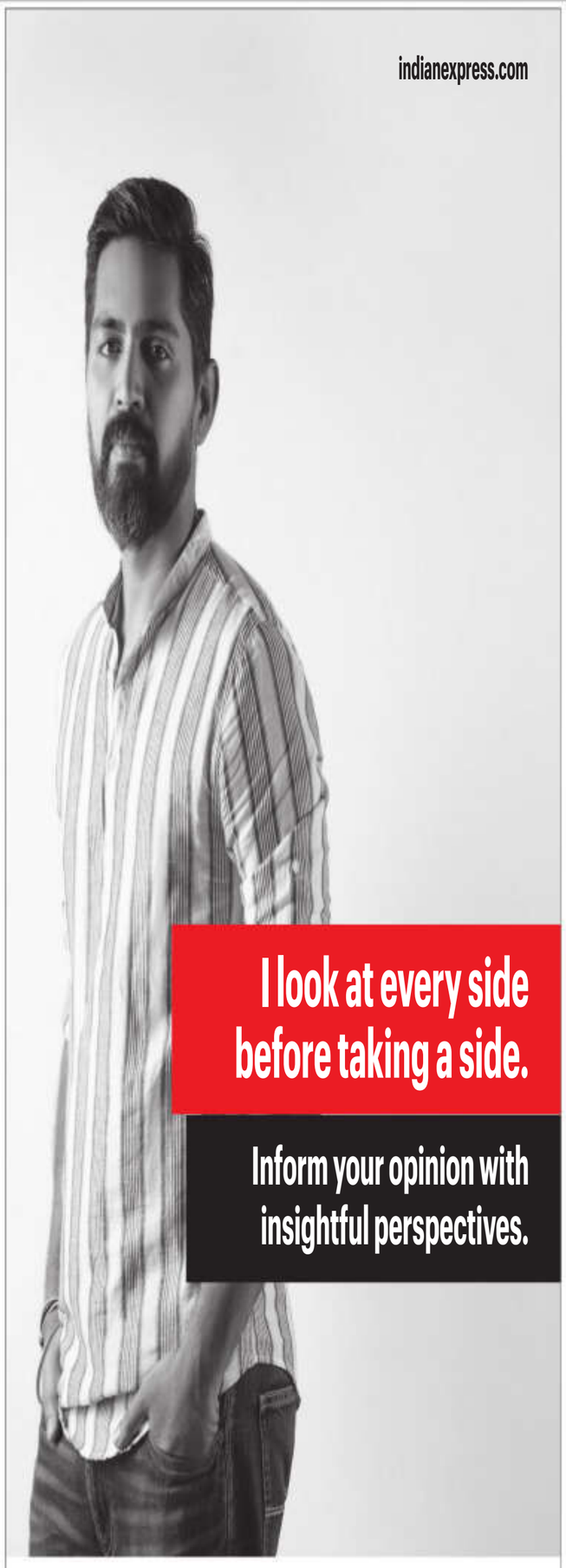
Date : 26/10/2026
Place : Bangalore

For and on behalf of
L.B.PUBLISHERS & DISTRIBUTORS (MADRAS) LLP
Sd/-
Name: Neeta Shrenik Shah
Designated partner
DPIN: 07925447

Address: Flat No. 901, 9th Floor, Plot No -55, Plaza Heights,N.S. Patkar Marg, Near Dharam Palace, Huges Road Mumbai, Grant Road, Mumbai - 400007, Maharashtra







EXPRESS Careers

IIM MUMBAI
भारतीय प्रबंधन संस्थान मुंबई
Indian Institute of Management Mumbai
(Ministry of Education, Government of India)
Azadi ka Amrit Mahotsav
VIKSIT BHARAT @2047

Advertisement for Teaching & Non-Teaching Positions

IIM Mumbai invites applications for Teaching & Non-Teaching positions from eligible candidates.

Advt. Number & Date	Post
Admn/Rectt/Faculty/2026/02 Date: 13.10.2026	▶ Associate Professor ▶ Assistant Professor (Grade-I) ▶ Assistant Professor (Grade-II)
Admn/Rectt/2026/41 dated 19.10.2026	▶ Deputy General Manager (Career Development Services) ▶ Medical Officer ▶ Manager (Civil) ▶ Manager (Electrical)

For detailed advertisements and other vacancies, please visit https://iimmumbai.ac.in/careers

Chief Administrative Officer

MPA An ISPS Code Compliant Port
Gati Shakti SAGARMALA

MORMUGAO PORT AUTHORITY
GENERAL ADMINISTRATION DEPARTMENT

Brief Advertisement notice No. GAD/PC-A/151/2026/07351 Date: 19/10/2026

APPOINTMENT ON DEPUTATION BASIS

Mormugao Port Authority, Headland, Sada invites applications for filling up the post of Deputy Chief Vigilance Officer on deputation basis from Central Government/State Government/PSUs/Autonomous Bodies. The last date for receipt of application is **04.12.2026.**

For further details, visit MPA website https://www.mormugaoport.gov.in.

Sd/-
SECRETARY

MUMBAI PORT AUTHORITY

RECRUITMENT NOTICE – ENGAGEMENT OF FINANCIAL ANALYST ON CONTRACT BASIS

Applications are invited from eligible Indian Nationals for engagement as Financial Analyst purely on contract basis.

Last date of receiving applications is **10.11.2026**.

For details regarding educational qualifications, age, experience, application fomat etc., please visit our website **www.mumbaiport.gov.in** (people & career/ jobs/).

Financial Adviser & Chief Accounts Officer
Mumbai Port Authority

CORPORATE BRIEFS

Eram Holding Expands Into Africa



ERAM Holding announced its entry into the African market with the inauguration of its new office in Windhoek, Namibia - a strategic milestone that reinforces our global growth ambitions and establishes a strong foundation for long-term engagement across the African continent. This expansion marks more than a new geographical presence. It reflects our commitment to building lasting partnerships, developing local capabilities, and delivering integrated solutions that support Africa's evolving industrial, infrastructure, and human capital needs. ERAM Holding aims to expand its footprint into Mozambique, Angola, Nigeria, and Egypt, advancing a regional growth strategy built around four key service areas: Human Capital Management - Connecting talent with opportunity & business needs Inspection Services - Supporting quality, safety & operational excellence Skill Development - Strengthening workforce capabilities for sustainable growth Power Electronics Systems - Enabling advanced technological & industrial solutions.

The inauguration in Windhoek was attended by ERAM Holding's senior leadership and valued strategic partners in Namibia, whose support and collaboration are integral to establishing a strong foundation for our African journey. There is also a meaningful connection in our choice of destination: Namib is understood to mean "vast place" in Khoekhoegowab, reflecting a sense of scale & possibility. ERAM Holding is looking forward to forging strategic alliances, empowering local talent, and contributing to sustainable economic and industrial development across Africa.

ICL Group launches 'ICL Academy' to mark a new chapter in education;



Building on a legacy of excellence and the trust of millions, leading business conglomerate ICL Group announced its entry into the education sector with the launch of 'ICL Academy' in Thrissur, with plans to expand nationwide. The academy is being established with the core vision of providing national and international-standard education and competitive exam coaching at affordable costs. To achieve this, the Academy brings together entrance coaching, national Olympiads, and international university admissions training under one roof. Additionally, the comprehensive facility offers extensive scholarship schemes, career guidance, and teacher empowerment programs. ICL Academy offers coaching for major national and state-level entrance examinations, including NEET, JEE Main, JEE Advanced, KEAM, and CUET. It also provides coaching for international standardized tests such as SAT and ACT for students aspiring to study abroad. In addition, ICL Academy will offer international university programs and degree pathways in collaboration with prestigious global universities for students worldwide.

Highlighting the vision behind ICL Academy, Adv. K. G. Anilkumar, CMD of ICL Group explains: "ICL Academy represents a significant, socially driven initiative for the ICL Group. We aspire to build an educational brand from Kerala that earns recognition across India and beyond. Through ICL Academy, we want to create opportunities for talented students to access world-class academic guidance without geographical or financial barriers. This is the beginning of a much larger commitment by ICL Group to the future of education. Starting from the cultural capital of Thrissur, our immediate focus is to expand services across India. Our long-term vision is to scale ICL Academy into a prominent international educational brand by establishing branches across India's major cities."

Keralam Tourism - ITB Asia in Singapore



Kerala Tourism's participation in ITB Asia 2026, the largest travel trade show on the continent that held in Singapore, generated significant excitement among visitors and business delegates eager to explore the state's diverse and unique tourism offerings and build lasting partnerships. Held at the Sands Expo and Convention Centre in Singapore, the three-day event positioned Keralam's pavilion as a key highlight amid the large gathering of tourism professionals and travel enthusiasts. PC Vishnunadh, Minister for Tourism, Culture and Cinema, Government of Keralam, led the Keralam delegation, which also included Sumit Kumar Thakur, IAS, Additional Director (General), Kerala Tourism. Vishnunadh, along with Sakina Masood Itoo, Minister for Health, Medical, School and Higher Education, and Social Welfare, Jammu and Kashmir, and Dr Shilpak Ambule, High Commissioner of India in Singapore, inaugurated the Kerala Tourism stand.

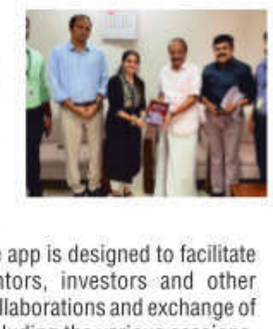
Spanning 27 square metres, the Kerala Tourism Pavilion (F130) features the evocative theme "Your Nearest Faraway," capturing the essence of Keralam's breathtaking landscapes that define the state as a premier experiential tourism hub. The visuals highlight Kerala's tranquil backwaters, Ayurveda, and iconic houseboats, immersing visitors in the state's rich offerings through engaging imagery and informative panels. Vishnunadh said "the distinctive offerings that Keralam presents, now further enriched by the introduction of experiential tourism, have been gaining substantial traction and interest from global tour planners. This includes a deeper engagement with the cultural heritage and natural beauty of our state." The delegation engaged with stakeholders, including trade buyers, airlines, and media, to build connections and explore opportunities to promote Kerala as a premier travel destination. Kairali- The Ayurvedic Healing Village and Somatheeram Ayurveda group joined Kerala Tourism at the event as co-exhibitors, emphasising their commitment to wellness tourism.

HLL eStore: All Products and Services of HLL Now on One Platform

Central Public Sector Enterprise HLL Lifecare Limited (HLL) has launched its digital platform 'HLL eStore' with the primary objective of ensuring access to HLL's products and services for a wider community. The eStore marks a step forward in HLL's transformation from its traditional business ways to a modern and digitalised platform where customers, partners and healthcare institutions can connect with HLL from anywhere anytime. The platform is accessible at www.hllestore.in The platform features healthcare and wellness products at affordable rates, including contraceptives, hospital supplies, women's healthcare products, wellness solutions and other essential items. Designed as a one-stop destination for healthcare and wellness solutions, HLL eStore connects people and products and seek partnerships on a single platform, making healthcare more seamless and more connected than ever before. As a Mini Ratna Public Sector Enterprise under the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India, HLL has played a pioneering role in strengthening India's healthcare system and with the introduction of an eStore, the company has now extended its trusted legacy into the digital space, said an HLL official.

HLL eStore strengthens HLL's direct business engagement through D2C (Direct to Consumers), B2B (Business to Business), Business to Institutions and HLL for the global market. Companies and institutions can join hands with HLL as business associates. HLL eStore has been designed to serve three key groups. For customers, it offers a convenient and reliable online experience. For partners, including retailers, distributors, dealers and healthcare entrepreneurs, it creates opportunities to expand the reach of quality healthcare products. For institutions and organisations, including hospitals, healthcare providers and corporate bodies, HLL eStore offers a space for collaboration, procurement and long-term partnerships that support better healthcare delivery across the country.

Keralam's Industries Minister PK Kunhalikutty launches Huddle Global 2026 app and AI Chatbot



Minister for Industries, IT and AI P. K. Kunhalikutty launched an exclusive app and AI chatbot for the Huddle Global 2026, Asia's largest beachside startup festival being organized by Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) from November 12 to 14 at Kovalam here. Kunhalikutty launched the app in the presence of Seeram Sambasiva Rao, IAS, Special Secretary, Department of Electronics & IT, Government of Keralam, KSUM CEO Shri Anoop Ambika, Nisarudeen Rawther, Secretary and Registrar, KSUM, Ashok Kurian Panjikaran Head - Business Linkages and other KSUM officials. The app is designed to facilitate smooth and seamless networking among entrepreneurs, mentors, investors and other participants of the Huddle Global, besides scaling up the business collaborations and exchange of ideas. The app has all the information about Huddle Global 2026 including the various sessions, venues, services and products of the participating start-ups. The app also provides profiles of mentors, investors, speakers, exhibitors, startups and their products. Participants can book time slots to meet with investors and mentors through the app.

The AI Chatbot named 'Nila' will provide quick and convenient access to event-related information, helping delegates find answers to their queries and navigate the event more efficiently. Now into its 8th edition, Huddle Global 2026, will see convergence of founders, investors, social entrepreneurs, innovators, policymakers and industry leaders to shape the future of technology and entrepreneurship, imparting an added thrust to innovation and growth. More than 4000 startups, 200 HNI's (High Net worth Individuals), 300 plus startup mentors, 200 plus corporates, 150 plus exhibitors, over 150 investors and 300 eminent speakers will attend Huddle Global 2026.

Naturals ADFT Launches in Adyar, Chennai

Naturals ADFT (Academy of Design, Fashion & Technology), a creative education initiative by IntelliNXT Learning & Technologies Pvt. Ltd., backed by the legacy of Naturals Salon, was officially launched in Gandhi Nagar, Adyar, Chennai, marking a new milestone in industry-oriented creative education. The grand launch was graced by C. K. Kumaravel, CMD of Naturals Salons, as Chief Guest; S. Karaiadiselvan, Mentor, Naturals Salon and IntelliNXT, as Guest of Honour; and T. Kavitha, Additional Director – Operations, Apparel, Made-Ups & Home Furnishing Sector Skill Council. Naturals ADFT aims to nurture creative talent and help aspiring designers transform their passion into a profession through studio-first learning, industry-integrated training, AI-enabled learning, and a dedicated AI-assisted Learning Management System (LMS). The academy offers programmes across three creative disciplines: Fashion & Costume Design, Interior & Spatial Design, and Digital & Creative Media. Speaking on the occasion, Kumaravel, CMD of Naturals Salons, said, "As technology transforms industries, skills will matter more than ever. The future belongs to those who think critically, adapt continuously, and apply their knowledge creatively. Naturals ADFT aims to bridge the gap between education and industry by equipping young people with practical skills and creative confidence."

Genrobotics bags ISRO robotics development contract

In a significant milestone in its journey from building robots for hazardous underground environments to precise engineering systems for space applications, Kerala-based Genrobotics Innovations has secured a robotics development project from the U R Rao Satellite Centre (URSC), a key centre of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO). As part of the contract, Genrobotics Innovations will be developing a high-precision articulated boom arm system for satellite missions of ISRO. The project involves designing and developing an indigenous mechanism for reflector deployment and pointing on satellite decks. Under the URSC project, the company's Space & Advanced Robotics division will develop a multi-link articulated boom arm system designed to withstand the mechanical stresses of launch and operate under the extreme thermal and vacuum conditions of space. Launched in 2017, Genrobotics gained recognition for Bandicoot, the world's first robotic system designed to eliminate manual scavenging and protect health and dignity of sanitation workers. Developing robots for toxic, confined and corrosive environments helped the company build expertise in advanced actuator control, materials engineering, precision motion systems and artificial intelligence-driven robotics.

The company subsequently expanded its capabilities into healthcare, heavy industry and defence. Its portfolio includes G-Gaiter, a robotic rehabilitation platform, and GENBOT, designed for heavy-duty manipulation and mobility across defence, oil and gas, and industrial operations. Genrobotics has also integrated Physical AI and reinforcement learning into its robotic platforms to enhance adaptability, motion control and operational precision. To strengthen its presence in space robotics, Genrobotics has established a dedicated production and R&D facility at KINFRA in Thumba, Thiruvananthapuram. The facility houses specialised testing infrastructure, clean room assembly areas and engineering laboratories intended to support the development and qualification of space-grade hardware. "Our journey began in hazardous underground manholes, where our mission was to save lives and restore human dignity," said Vimal Govind M.K., co-founder and CEO of Genrobotics. "Developing systems capable of operating under corrosive conditions, high torque and extreme environmental stress helped us build a strong engineering foundation. Transitioning into space mechanisms is a natural progression, and ISRO's trust in our team validates the capabilities we have developed over the years."

SBI Offers Digital Ticketing Kiosk At Historic Chennai Museum



In a significant initiative to promote digital payments and enhance public convenience, State Bank of India (SBI), Chennai Circle, offered a first-of-its-kind Digital Ticketing Kiosk at the historic Chennai Museum, Egmore, which was inaugurated by Rajmohan, Minister for School Education, Tamil Development, Information and Publicity. The event was attended by Baskara Pandiyan, IAS, Director, Chennai Museums; Vivekananda Choubey, Chief General Manager, SBI, Chennai Circle; Sanjeev Kumar, General Manager, SBI, Chennai Circle; and Digital Team of State bank of India and museum staff. Established in 1851, Chennai Museum is one of India's oldest museums and a celebrated repository of art, archaeology and cultural heritage. The new kiosk, offered by SBI, will facilitate hassle-free ticket booking through cashless digital payments, reducing queues and providing visitors with a faster and more convenient entry experience. The initiative underscores SBI's commitment to digital innovation, customer convenience and public service, extending the benefits of digital payment solutions beyond conventional banking. By supporting the digital transformation of a landmark cultural institution, SBI continues to demonstrate how technology can improve public services while contributing to the preservation and promotion of India's rich heritage.

VIT – Applications opened

The Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT) has opened applications for VITEEE 2027, inviting aspiring engineers to take the next step toward their dream careers. According to a press release, students can now apply online at https://viteee.vit.ac.in for admission to VIT's flagship engineering programs offered across its campuses in Vellore, Chennai, Amaravati (AP) and Bhopal (MP). The VITEEE 2027 will be conducted in a single phase, scheduled from April 28 - May 2, 2027. The exam will be held in 133 test cities across India and at 9 international centres, providing opportunities for candidates from India and abroad to appear for the entrance exam, the release said.

THE BIG IDEA
OFBUSINESS

Three needs, one business

HOW A THREE-PRONGED MODEL ADDRESSED MARKET ACCESS GAPS FACING MANUFACTURING SMEs

S SHANTHI

THE IDEA FOR OfBusiness took shape in late 2014, when Asish Mohapatra was working as a venture capitalist at Matrix Partners, now Z47. He was watching capital and entrepreneurial talent flow into business-to-business (B2B) startups spanning financing, procurement and logistics. But his experience of running a small business, investing in one and interacting with small and medium enterprises (SMEs) had shown him that an important gap remained. While many entrepreneurs were attempting to solve individual problems, few were building an integrated business around the needs of manufacturing and infrastructure companies.

"There was a lot of talent going there, a lot of capital being invested," Mohapatra recalled. The opportunity, however, was not simply to create another B2B marketplace. The founders wanted to build a business that could help SMEs source raw materials at competitive prices, secure financing to buy them and find customers for their output. They also made an early decision to focus on sizeable manufacturing and infrastructure SMEs rather than smaller businesses or intermediaries, a choice that continues to define the company's approach.

Mohapatra, who was 35 when the venture took shape, worked on the idea with co-founders Bhuvan Gupta, group chief technology officer, Ruchi Kalra, chief executive of its financial services arm Oxyzo, and Vasant Sridhar, chief sales officer. Their first attempt, in the finished-goods healthcare segment, was abandoned within weeks. Instead, they spent time researching the problems SMEs faced and identified three interconnected requirements: procurement, working capital and revenue generation. OfBusiness was incorporated in February 2016 as a technology-led B2B platform combining raw material sourcing with supply chain financing.

The company began with 30 employees in a 3,000-square-foot office in Gurugram. The immediate priority was to establish a revenue-generating business, followed by profitability and cash flow generation. With margins in the business inherently thin, the founders kept operating costs low. Within a year, OfBusiness had scaled to around ₹50 crore in monthly business. "Frugality became one of our key drivers," Mohapatra said.



THE COMPANY'S CORE BET IS THAT SMEs GROW BETTER WHEN ESSENTIAL SERVICES ARE INTEGRATED

Asish Mohapatra, co-founder and CEO, OfBusiness

The emphasis on keeping costs under control was important because the company was building a business in which scale alone would not guarantee profitability. OfBusiness has since expanded well beyond its initial aggregation model, adding financing and private-label products while retaining raw material procurement as its core activity. Its operating revenue reached ₹20,000 crore in FY26, according to the company. The scale of the business also reflects the breadth of its operations, which bring together commerce and financial services rather than treating them as separate offerings.

The founders had secured their first round of funding from Matrix Partners before the launch. The company subsequently attracted investors including SoftBank, Norwest Venture Partners, Tiger Global and Alpha Wave Global. Yet the evolution of the business was not without missteps. Mohapatra believes financing should have been introduced earlier, given how closely it was linked to procurement. The company also started with too many products and took longer than it should have to bring experienced professionals into the organisation.

"We should have probably started in a smaller set," he said, adding that the founders had relied on their own judgement for too long instead of bringing in people who had already encountered similar business challenges.

The Covid-19 pandemic became a defining milestone. OfBusiness grew around 2.5 times during the pandemic year across both its financing and raw material commerce businesses. The experience reinforced the founders' belief that SMEs needed more than access to suppliers. They needed a combination of lower input costs, working capital and opportunities to generate revenue. The company also helps businesses access government tenders, widening their potential customer base.

The model's distinguishing feature, Mohapatra argues, is that its three components support one another. Procurement gives SMEs access to raw materials, financing helps them pay for those supplies, and access to tenders can create demand for their products. Each activity can therefore strengthen the others, rather than operating as an isolated service.

"Our USP remains the same. We believe in holistic improvement for the SME," he said. While individual companies have attempted to address procurement, financing or market access separately, OfBusiness has built its model around bringing all three together.

Nearly a decade after its launch, the underlying idea has changed a little. The company has added products and expanded its scale, but its original bet remains that manufacturing SMEs are better served when the services they need to operate and grow are connected within a single business.

Emirates seeks India growth through premiumisation

SUKALP SHARMA
New Delhi, October 25

EMIRATES HAS STEPPED up its product premiumisation effort in the Indian market. From Sunday (October 25), the airline has expanded its premium economy offering to all flights to and from Delhi and Kolkata. It is also introducing its flagship Airbus A380 aircraft for the first time on one of its four daily frequencies from Delhi, making the capital the third Indian city to be served by the superjumbo. The remaining three daily flights will be upgraded to refurbished Boeing 777 aircraft, featuring a four-class cabin configuration — first, business, premium economy and economy — compared with the earlier three-class offering of first, business and economy.

In addition to Delhi, the premium economy cabin will also be available on all 12 of the airline's weekly Kolkata-Dubai flights, up from the five a week at present. With this, the premium economy product will be available on flight to and from six of nine Indian cities that Emirates operates to, and will cover about half of its 168 weekly departures from India.

As per Essa Sulaiman Ahmad, Emirates' senior vice president of commercial operations for West Asia and Indian Ocean, the Indian market — widely perceived as a price-sensitive market — has matured and there is "extremely high demand" for travel, including rising demand for premium cabin seats. Ahmad said that offering premium economy seats on a number of its India flights also works well from the perspective of passengers travelling with the airline beyond Dubai to markets like Europe and North America, where the cabin class is widely offered.

The carrier's focus on premiumisation is evidently aimed at attracting flyers willing to pay more for better comfort and experience from a key geography for the Dubai-based mega carrier. Apart from reinforcing its premium positioning and commanding higher fares than competition, offering more premium class seats is one way for Emirates to grow the revenue from its India flights, given that it can't expand seat capacity to and from India, according to industry watchers.

Premiumisation gives the airline a way to extract more value from this connectivity.

ESSA SULAIMAN AHMAD, SENIOR VICE PRESIDENT, COMMERCIAL OPERATIONS FOR WEST ASIA & INDIAN OCEAN, EMIRATES

"Indian market has matured and there is "extremely high demand" for travel, including rising demand for premium cabin seats"



Will take action if Karnataka citizens sidelined in jobs: CM

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Bengaluru, October 25

KARNATAKA CHIEF MINISTER D K Shivakumar on Sunday said the state government would take appropriate action if private institutions were found to be deliberately sidelining Kannadigas in job opportunities.

In a post on X, Shivakumar said the government had taken seriously the concerns over Kannadigas being overlooked and asserted that their rights, dignity and opportunities would not be compromised.

"It is disheartening to hear complaints that Kannadigas are being denied job opportunities in Bengaluru's IT companies. The government has taken seriously the issue of native Kannada speakers being sidelined," he said. "In Karnataka, the Kannadiga is sovereign. The government will not allow the rights, dignity, and opportunities of Kannadigas to be disregarded for any reason," he said.



Karnataka Chief Minister D K Shivakumar

Noting that Bengaluru was recognised globally as India's technology capital, he said the state took immense pride in the talent, skills and capabilities of Kannadigas.

"If it is found that any private institution has deliberately sidelined Kannadigas, the government will take appropriate action," he said.

He emphasised that the government remained committed to addressing concerns relating to the interests of Kannadigas.

Isro to have four launch pads by 2029: Narayanan

ISRO CHAIRMAN V Narayanan has said that India will expand its space operations significantly with four functional launch pads by 2029. He outlined the agency's roadmap, which includes a 2,000-acre dedicated Small Satellite Launch Vehicle (SSLV) complex at Kulasekarapattinam in Tuticorin district to meet the global demand for satellite deployment.

Clarifying that the national space agency will not be privatised, Narayanan emphasised that partnering with private firms was essential to meet surging global and domestic demands for thousands of satellites. "To handle this expanding ecosystem, Isro will handhold startups and private enterprises, transferring technological expertise to foster economic growth and generate thousands of high-tech jobs," he said while speaking at a graduation ceremony at a private university here on Saturday.

"India will expand its space operations significantly with four functional launch pads by 2029, supported by an increasing reliance on private industry partnerships to handle commercial operations," he said.

The Isro chief said that the upcoming Kulasekarapattinam spaceport facility will feature crucial infrastructure such as integration buildings, launch pads, rail-track systems, telemetry, tracking, and command systems. —PTI

GUJARAT AMBUJA EXPORTS LIMITED

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EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER & HALF YEAR ENDED 30TH SEPTEMBER, 2026 (₹ in Crores)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended			Half Year Ended		Year Ended
		30.09.2026 Unaudited	30.06.2026 Unaudited	30.09.2025 Unaudited	30.09.2026 Unaudited	30.09.2025 Unaudited	31.03.2026 Audited
1.	Total income from operations	1467.70	1633.35	1505.87	3101.05	2827.46	5835.77
2.	Net Profit / (Loss) from ordinary activities for the period (before tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	177.19	235.28	50.79	412.47	136.46	408.38
3.	Net Profit / (Loss) from ordinary activities for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	177.19	235.28	50.79	412.47	136.46	404.41
4.	Net Profit / (Loss) from ordinary activities for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	131.79	176.77	38.02	308.56	103.04	304.28
5.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	131.99	176.98	37.07	308.97	102.41	304.19
6.	Equity Share Capital (Face Value of ₹ 1/- each)	45.87	45.87	45.87	45.87	45.87	45.87
7.	Earnings Per Share (Face Value of ₹ 1/- each) (not annualised)						
	(i) Basic :	2.87	3.85	0.83	6.73	2.25	6.63
	(ii) Diluted :	2.87	3.85	0.83	6.73	2.25	6.63

EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED STANDALONE FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER & HALF YEAR ENDED 30TH SEPTEMBER, 2026 (₹ in Crores)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended			Half Year Ended		Year Ended
		30.09.2026 Unaudited	30.06.2026 Unaudited	30.09.2025 Unaudited	30.09.2026 Unaudited	30.09.2025 Unaudited	31.03.2026 Audited
1.	Total income from operations	1468.30	1633.40	1505.87	3101.70	2827.68	5835.99
2.	Net Profit / (Loss) from ordinary activities for the period (before tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	177.39	235.44	50.85	412.83	136.90	409.09
3.	Net Profit / (Loss) from ordinary activities for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	177.39	235.44	50.85	412.83	136.90	405.12
4.	Net Profit / (Loss) from ordinary activities for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	131.99	176.93	38.08	308.92	103.48	304.99
5.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	132.19	177.14	37.13	309.33	102.85	304.90
6.	Equity Share Capital (Face Value of ₹ 1/- each)	45.87	45.87	45.87	45.87	45.87	45.87
7.	Earnings Per Share (Face Value of ₹ 1/- each) (not annualised)						
	(i) Basic :	2.88	3.86	0.83	6.73	2.26	6.65
	(ii) Diluted :	2.88	3.86	0.83	6.73	2.26	6.65

NOTES:
1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarter / Half Yearly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligation and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly / Half Yearly Financial Results are available on the Company's website at www.ambujagroup.com and the Stock Exchanges websites at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com

For GUJARAT AMBUJA EXPORTS LIMITED
Manish Gupta
Chairman & Managing Director
(DIN : 00028196)

Place : Ahmedabad
Date : 24th October, 2026

Committed to Growth

